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Its Sullen Sound



The hum and buzz of the writhing entoman swarm abates as each and every one twists to face your group in a flash of movement. While an immature galeaper can be described as “small”, that’s more of a relative attribution, as mature galeaper stand about as tall as an adult human. A single Rover stands good odds against two or three, but even then it’s considered a fraught effort. It’s no small blessing that galeaper don’t swarm in vast numbers once they leave the nest—competition for resources is too fierce for more than a few to claim the same territory at once. They prefer smaller hunting pods for the sake of efficiency.

This particular swarm of immature, zusag-sized galeaper are unfortunately yet to depart their makeshift nest. This is an excellent opportunity... if you don’t stop to consider what it means to be found at a galeaper’s nest to begin with. For now you should focus on the task at hand, but be wary of both what they primarily feed upon—ether-rich silvan flora that have evolved to try and contend against giant entoman creatures such as the galeaper—and what led to their nesting here in the first place.

Adversary Rules



Adversary Rules: Now that we’ve completed the Rover phase, it’s time for the adversaries to act during the adversary phase (pg. 59). Each adversary unit will get a turn. They activate in the order they are printed in the adversary book, from left to right, top to bottom. When a unit type is activated, the individual units a part of that unit type activate in standee number order, from least to greatest.

During the first round of any given encounter, adversaries always perform their first ability, the ability printed on the left side of their statistic block in the adversary book (pg. 46). This means the galelings will perform their Scything Strike ability. This ability contains two actions, a action and a action, separated by an action separator icon.

Adversaries follow a simple logic pattern depending on the primary action they are performing. For Scything Strike, the primary action is the single target action. Because of this, the galelings will follow the single target attack logic (pg. 47). The galelings will use their action that precedes their action to move into range of their nearest



enemy who also has the most hit points to attack them.

Adversaries will use the fewest number of movement points required to get to their intended target. Double check the rules for the jump action, difficult terrain, and objects. A unit that jumps ignores the extra movement cost of difficult terrain and the dash blocking nature of objects.

Adversaries resolve damage the same way Rovers do, rolling the damage dice and comparing it to their ether affinity.

Below is a new **Codex Link**.

Codex Links



After all adversaries have taken their turns, the adversary phase is over. With all phases completed the round ends, read “Now With Rising Knell”, 2.

Now With Rising Knell



Silky taps a claw loudly against an antler. “Galeaper carapace is very sharp but also quite brittle. They are an entoman species evolved to harness Air ether to traverse their environment at high speeds, disorient their prey, and escape danger when necessary. One well-placed strike is often all it takes to leave the creatures incapacitated. Conversely, one well-placed strike from a galeaper can also spell a swift end. This is the core of their predatory instincts. Fortunately, the young examples before us aren’t well-attuned to their natural affinity for Air yet.

“Consider how you might best emulate the methodology of a galeaper pod. One individual to draw attention, another to attack, another to disorient, and so forth. Discern when, as a group, members should be moving toward or away from your prey to maximize the effectiveness of your abilities.”

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More Abilities



Be sure to refresh your abilities, by sliding all of your ability tokens so that the green check is visible, indicating they are available to be used. In the previous round we stuck to just the abilities that allowed you to move and attack, but Rovers have several interesting tricks they can perform. Let's look at the other abilities each Rover has access to.

True Scale: The True Scale can heal  themselves with the Take Stock ability (pg. 37). Take Stock can only target the True Scale because of its limited range. Also, the True Scale can force an enemy to dash in a path of their choosing with their Seize ability.

Shadow Piercer: The Shadow Piercer can activate their Reknit ability, with its heal  action, to heal their allies near to themselves, as denoted by the limited range (pg. 21). to heal their allies, as denoted by the limited range. Also, the Shadow Piercer can activate the Brace ability, which adds range to their next range attack .

Flash: The Flash has two attack abilities, Sear and Gale. For now let's focus on the Gale ability with its range attack  action that has a push  effect (pg. 30). Pushing an enemy is a powerful effect which will become more apparent as we get further into this quest, but for now let's read about impact damage (pg. 31).

The Flash also has the unique ability Channel which allows you to modify the ether dice in your ether pools. We will go over this in more detail next round. For now, focus on your Gale ability and try to push a galeling into a tree stump.

Sophist: The Sophist has some unique abilities with Manifest and Inspire. Manifest allows the Sophist to place one of their Luminescent Hyperbola glyphs onto the map. Glyphs follow the conjuration rules (pg 38). Double check the ally card for Luminescent Hyperbola, as the glyph has a unique trait that affects enemies that occupy the same space as the glyph.

Inspire is an ability that allows the Sophist to grant a  3 action to their allies or one of their glyphs. Speak with your allies to see if the granted



Q 2

movement might allow them to get into a position they normally couldn't on their own turn. If you grant the dash action to one of your glyphs, you control the action. Do this to get a glyph into the same space as an enemy.

Dune Dancer: The Dune Dancer has two abilities that contain an attack action, Carve and Erosion. Take note that these abilities have a qualifier before them. You can't use both Carve and Erosion within the same turn.

The Dune Dancer also has access to the Barter ability. Barter allows you to use the Trade action (pg. 38), a useful ability that allows you to trade one of your ether dice from your personal pool with an ether dice from the personal pool of one of your Rover allies. We'll cover ether dice in more detail next round, for now trading an ether dice with an ally can be useful if you wish to allow them a chance to recover  (pg. 37) some of their hit points.

We covered a lot of new actions and effects. For this round, move, attack, recover hit points, push, and otherwise strike back at your enemy, using the two abilities of your choice.

Codex Links



Q 3

After the Rover phase ends, read "Some Little Cheering",  3.

Some Little Cheering

Q 3

"One of the most potent weapons of the galeaper is their massive and piercing tarsal claws. Easily able to shear through wood, to say nothing of flesh, whereafter their sharp mandibles can consume the innards of their given target. Silvan life has developed a number of different defensive features to deal with the constant threat of the proverbial blade and lance of the entoman that would feast upon them.

"People, too, have developed myriad means to contend with predators. Don't let their numbers overwhelm you.



You are not a rooted plant; you are a highly intelligent being. Put distance between yourself and the enemy as needed, minimize their advantages by utilizing your own, and consider how you might deal with the habits that your enemies exhibit,” chimes Silky.

Rending Talons

Rending Talons: For this round we will keep determining the adversary ability simple by advancing their ability token forward one space (pg. 34) to the Rending Talons ability.

If you look at Rending Talons it has a target  line, with a value of 2. This means that galeling can attack up to 2 different enemies with this action, both of which must be within range. Adversaries follow different logic for multiple target attacks (pg. 31) where they prioritize maximizing targets attacked.

Adversaries will revert to single-target attack logic if they can't attack more than one target with their multi-target attacks.

It's good to be aware that adversaries have competing movement logic when attacking multiple targets. Adversaries prioritize attacking multiple targets over moving fewer spaces.

When resolving damage for multi-target attacks, the damage dice is rolled and attack resolution is followed for each target separately (pg. 47).

That's enough for now, resolve the adversary phase and good luck weathering their attacks.

Codex Links

4

After the adversary phase ends, read “**Though Restless Still Themselves**”,  4.

Though Restless Still Themselves

4

Silky's aerios circles around him as he continues to observe your battle. “Most every living thing on Chorus has some affinity to ether; one thing that sets you apart as Rovers is how you've learned to channel it. The focus and acumen required to wield the energies of the world

and still keep your head about you in single combat is something few people have the opportunity, or desire, to actualize. Today we put to proof the name proffered to our world and cast aside the “single” of your combat—we bring your abilities to bear in concert,” Silky says.

“I advise starting with simple maneuvers to build your momentum. It is important that you not disregard energy you lack the affinity for; your training has prepared you to exercise your abilities even in... let's call them suboptimal circumstances. You are a conduit of power and need not be incumbent to that which escapes your direct control.”

Rally Skill Cards

Rally Skill Cards: You've done well so far, but it's time to tap into the ether of your surroundings if you're going to clear out this nest. Ether is the magic of Chorus (pg. 20), a metaphysical energy that brings the elements of the world to life. Your skill cards are how you will both generate and spend the ether you need to win the fights ahead of you.

First, let's read about ether dice (pg. 20). This very important game component represents the primary resource system of the game. For this round play a rally skill card (pg. 40) to generate an ether dice and add it to your personal pool on the left side of your player board (pg. 21). Don't forget to flip your skill card after playing it (pg. 42).

Some things to keep in mind, you can activate two abilities and play one skill card during each of your turns (pg. 58-59). If the rally skill card you play has this icon , the ether dice you generate is random. Some rally skill cards generate a specific ether dice, if this is the case, the specific ether icon will be present (pg. 38).

Skill cards can have action separator icons and or action flow icons. If the actions are separated by an action flow icon, the preceding action must be performed in order to perform the following action. You will notice the majority of ether generating icons are preceded by an action flow icon, meaning you'll have to do something in order to generate that ether dice.

With rally skill cards several new actions, effects, and icons are made available to you.

There are positive and negative action icons (pg. 28). A positive action can target yourself and or an ally, depending on range restrictions. A negative action targets your enemies.

Some positive and healing actions have the defense  X effect (pg. 37). A unit targeted with the  effect gains a number of defense tokens  denoted by the value of X.  is used during damage resolution. The damage of an attack is reduced by the defense of the target. A unit that has  token removes them at the start of their turn.

Many of your skills can also place ether field tiles (pg. 26), which are placed onto the map and have a variety of effects. Be sure to read the timing statement and effects of each ether field carefully. Check your player board to learn what your  and or  do when triggered. Adversaries will be able to place these two ether fields later in the campaign. Check the campaign sheet (pg. 61) to learn what adversary  and  fields do.

Codex Links



Q 5

After the Rover phase ends, read “The Last, Last Purple Streaks of the Day”,  5.

The Last, Last Purple Streaks Of The Day Q 5

Not one to keep still, Silky paces and begins to stretch while continuing his speech. “Prepare yourselves, for now you have truly kicked the hive. Part of your training to become Rovers was honing your reactions to a spear’s edge; a swathe of immature galeaper are nothing compared to what I’m sure such training entailed. Despite that you mustn’t allow your concentration to wane. We have yet to solve the questions of immortality and it would be quite embarrassing to become a mere cobblestone on that path here and now.

“Galeaper are simple creatures that we’re all quite familiar with by now—let’s use that to our advantage. Nothing they could come up with should be too surprising. Keep them separated from one another, try not to let them skirt their way out of your reach, and perhaps most obviously, watch for their claws.”

Ability Dice and Reactions !

The swarm is becoming frenzied. For this round to determine which ability the galelings will perform, roll the ability dice (pg. 46), and advance their ability token the number of spaces equal to the result of the ability dice. If the ability token would advance past the galelings fourth ability, it wraps around to their first ability instead.

Be aware that for all encounters after this one, at the start of the adversary phase during round 2 and each round after that, you will roll the ability dice to determine what ability adversaries perform. The ability dice is rolled separately for each adversary type.

If the ability rolled was Rending Swoop, this introduces the Ignore Defense  effect (pg. 37). This is an attack effect where the damage of an attack ignores the defense  value of the target.

If the Fleeing Shot ability was rolled, this introduces a special logic mechanic (pg. 47). Adversaries have a standard list of logic that they will follow for most of their actions, however, sometimes adversaries may operate in unexpected ways, and this is noted by the “Logic” qualifier. In the case of Fleeing Shot, if a galeling performs their ranged attack, they will want to retreat from their enemies (pg. 47), meaning they want to use their movement to maximize the distance from the most enemies that they can.

Rovers have another trick in their toolkit, reaction cards. During each round, Rovers can perform one reaction. Use the reaction token as a reminder aid to keep track of if you’ve performed your reaction or not.

Pay special attention to your reaction timing statements. Reaction cards can be used any time during their timing statement (as long as your

reaction activation is available), which can occur during almost any phase of the game.

Your reaction activation refreshes during the start phase of a round. This means that at the beginning of the round, flip your reaction token to its available side.

Weather one last round of adversary attacks and try your best to use your reactions.

Codex Links



6

After the adversary phase ends, read “**In Echo Sweet Replies**”, 6.

In Echo Sweet Replies

6

“Now is the time to really stretch your legs! While you can’t quite control the energy you draw upon, you certainly can control the environment as you wield it. With every action follows response—and your power will no doubt create several. Whether you leave behind roiling flame, distressing miasma, energizing blossoms, or any other expression of ether, each act you take will frequently change your field of battle in one way or another.”

Silky nods to you all enthusiastically as he delivers his axiom. “Be wary that such alterations will affect yourself as much as it will your adversaries. Conversely, the changing environment will afford your foes as much benefit as it may tax your allies. Mobile beasts may cover their retreat with the very flames you wrought, and creatures that fight at distance will care little for your attempts to stymie their movements. Communicate with your team and utilize your unique strengths! It is through cooperation that we flourish.”

Rave Skill Cards



Now that you’ve generated some ether dice, it’s time to play one of your Rave skill cards (pg. 41). Raves are powerful skill cards that require you to infuse a number of ether dice equal to the number of pips at the top center of the card. To do this, move the dice from your personal pool to the skill card, perform the actions on the skill card, move the dice used to play the skill to your infusion pool (pg. 21), then flip the skill card over. Be sure not to flip the dice during this, keep the facing the same from your personal pool to the infusion pool.

The Shadow Piercer’s transform Raves are especially powerful and taxing, thus require you to spend an ability activation to use. To represent this, slide one of your abilities revealing the red X without performing the ability when paying for the Rave.

Some skill cards have special flip instructions . You must execute these mandatory instructions when you flip the card with the special instruction.

This is a good time to discuss the summon action (pg. 39). With the Dune Dancer’s Dearest Friend rave they can summon the ardorok. Summons take their turn during their creator’s turn, performing the ability on their summon card. It’s worth mentioning here that actions are discrete moments in the game. What this means is the Dune Dancer can’t command their summons to act during the middle of an action.

Many actions will have augments that can be earned. The most common augment for rave skill cards is the ether check. What this cost means is if you infused the listed ether dice when paying for the Rave skill card, you gain the bonus.

The most common augment for abilities and rallies is ether drain. What this cost means is you must return the listed ether dice from your personal pool to the general pool and replace it with a dim dice to gain the bonus. You can still use dim dice to pay for typeless costs, such as the common cost to play Rave skill cards.

Many attack actions have a target pattern (pg. 34). Target patterns allow an action to affect many units at once. actions with a target pattern have



Q 6

a gray hex to indicate where the performer is. ↗ actions with a target pattern have a primary space indicator. The primary space of a target pattern must be within the range of the action.

Pay attention to any other target restrictions. For Rovers, a target pattern can often only affect up to 3 different targets within the pattern.

This is a good time to discuss effect resolution order (pg. 36). Some actions, especially attack actions found within Raves, can have multiple layered effects. The damage of an attack is resolved first, then push or pull effects are resolved, then ether fields are placed, then all other effects are resolved. If the target of an attack with an ether field effect is slain due to damage dealt, the ether field is still placed in the space that the target occupied.

Codex Links



Q 7

Immediately after the Rover phase ends, or if all adversaries are slain, read “**The Joy of Young Ideas**”, 7.

The Joy Of Young Ideas

Q 7

Conclusion

Slowly, the energy in the air draws to a still... occasionally punctuated by not-so-distant peals of thunder reverberating throughout the valley. With a flash of wings and irate hissing, the rest of the entoman swarm disperses—retreating back towards where their queen has built her nest. With a tinkling chuckle, Silky’s aeries takes flight after them. “Come now, we shall finish what we started! Let it not be said we were unreasonable guests within this venerated abode.”

While none of you are certain that Uzem would care particularly about your conduct in this place, it’s impossible to deny that the sight of silvan overgrowth and entoman infestation is unusual and likely unappreciated. If Uzem isn’t here to take care of it, it falls entirely within your domain as Rovers to do so instead. For now, you can only continue onwards and upwards along the grooves within the trunk of the Seat of Storms.



Victory!



Reward

Congratulations on your first victory! Rovers gain 10*R . Lyst is the currency of Rove. R stands for the number of Rovers (pg. 62). That means R will equal 2, 3, or 4. Many things in the game can reference the value of R. Record the you earned on your campaign sheet (pg. 61).

Campaign Link



Encounter 0.2 - “**When Each Thing Joy Supplied**”



Favors Court Thy Smile

Q 8

Makaal waves excitedly from his hidey-hole. “Any of the smaller containers are yours to keep! Part of this chaos is my trying to carry too much between visits to clan settlements, so I think we both benefit from you all trying to lighten the load!” The curled up arkenyn chuffs loudly following the merchant’s proclamation.

Fortunately, most of the smaller boxes scattered about contain stores of lyst; the favored form of currency across Lalos. Ether comes in many forms throughout the world but one of the most common is crystallized chunks of rock which vary wildly in size. Lyst is one of the smallest sizes of crystallized ether, often used in a variety of crafting disciplines both practical and cosmetic, and in some cases considered a valuable energizing vittle for starlings in particular.

Reward



Rovers gain 5 .

And Shake The Blooms



Silky circles around the terrace within the gargantuan shrine, studying the scene as carefully as his conjuration will allow. “How strange...” he ponders. He returns to floating nearby, reporting on his findings. It seems that the normally aggressive dekaha have become protective of their natural predators. Somehow the silvan entities have become a living screen for the nesting grounds of the galeaper; unusual indeed.

Silky expresses concern and confusion as this is a deeply unnatural arrangement for the creatures in an unaltered habitat. Whether this is the influence of the queen or some other force is unknown, but it does mean that your fight just became much more complicated than it otherwise should be!

Adversary Healing



Some adversaries can perform the heal action. If the action can only target one unit, the adversary follows single-target healing logic (pg. 47), which has the adversary healing the most damaged unit they are allied with or themselves, within range of the action. Keep in mind, this is the most damaged unit, which is not necessarily the unit with the fewest . If there are no damaged units within range of the action, the adversary will target themselves. This is because adversary heal actions will often place ether fields.

Remember, this is the first round of the encounter, adversaries will perform the first ability within their ability track. For galelings that's Scything Strike and for dekahas that's Water Spout.

Codex Links



After the adversary phase ends, read “Perchance Her Acorn-Cups to Fill”, 9.

And Steal Their Sweets



Nektari are a well-regarded sight throughout Lalos. Keb rasska alchemists value their pollen dearly as both the raw powder and mixed nektar are incredibly versatile catalysts. Nektari gather residue from all kinds of floral and silvan life which can be put to use as a sort of... multipurpose ether substitute. Harvesting their hives is something clans perform regularly, as a nektari colony left to their own devices for too long can produce massive, noxious clouds of choking ether-tinged spores that become dangerous in such large quantities. These sporeclouds are easily carried across the wind and can trouble settlements over rather large distances.

The nektari in this hive mistook a key to one of the merchants' lockboxes as an article of foodstuffs. Though sticky and coated in miscellaneous residue, it seems no worse for wear. However, the entomans now seem quite annoyed at you having stolen their shiny article of not-food!

Reward



Make a note on the backside of the campaign sheet that the Rover that destroyed the Nektari Hive “has the metal key”.

Then spawn R nektari swarms within 0-1 of the destroyed hive.

Certain game events can spawn adversaries (pg. 51), which places new enemies onto the map.

Codex Links



At the end of the round, if the Rover with “the metal key” is within 1 of the treasure chest, read “That Slumbrous Influence Kest”, 10.

Perchance Her Acorn-Cups To Fill



Mo “watches” as the Rovers continue their battle against the creatures gnashing their way through Uzem’s home. While starlings can grow true “eyes” and view the world as other people did, and Mo’s core aspect of Morph would make the process easier, Mo prefers to rely on the flow of ether itself to perceive the world. It felt more natural; traditional vision would never have been useful in their nascent growth as a being borne under the currents of the sea—by the time Mo found civilization, their innate sense of the world around themselves was well suited for their future as a crafter within the keb rasska clan that found them. In virtually every instance it was indistinguishable from having eyes as others understood it, but they wouldn’t be able to understand. Not like Nu did.

It was with this unique perspective of the Rovers’ battle that Mo finally understood what their work was truly meant for. When the Rovers channeled their ether, it lingered, moved through their equipment, primed itself for more... reaction.

Infused Ether and Equipment



So far so good. It’s the start of a new round which means your abilities and reaction refresh. Hopefully you’ve had a chance to generate some ether. It may be a good idea to infuse some ether from your personal pool into your infusion pool in order to play a rave skill card this round. If you do, you could use your equipment (pg. 43).

When you infuse ether from your personal pool (the slot on the top left side of your player board), you place that ether into your infusion pool (the slot on the bottom left side of your player board). From there you may spend the ether dice to activate your equipment. Most equipment will have a timing statement that includes an ether cost, if you spend the indicated ether from your infusion pool (return ether dice to the general pool) during the timing window of the equipment, you gain the effect of that equipment.

When you use your equipment it becomes exhausted. To indicate this, turn the item 90 degrees. Exhausted equipment refreshes during the start phase of a round, along with your abilities and reaction token.

Ether Limit



Each class can store a limited number of ether dice in their ether pool or infusion pool. Your ether limit is written on your class board. An ether check is performed at the end of your turn and each pool of ether is checked separately. For most classes, they can store up to 3 dice in either their personal pool or infusion pool. The Flash, a being composed of pure ether, can store 4 ether in their personal pool and infusion pool.

Consumables



You have access to consumables  (pg. 44). These are one time use items that usually don’t require ether to use and have a powerful effect. Just like equipment, consumables have a timing statement for when they can be used. When you use a consumable item, flip it over. At the end of the encounter, if you won the encounter, return the consumable to the store (more about the store in a later encounter). If however the encounter was failed, all used consumables are flipped face up and stay with their owners (pg. 60).

Revive



Roving is a dangerous profession and you may need to be picked back up by a friend. If a Rover’s  is brought to 0, they are downed (pg. 38). If this happens, an ally can use a Powdered Drakaen consumable to gain access to the Revive action (pg. 37). A recently revived Rover can still take their full turn. Because of this powerful effect, it’s best if each Rover carries at least one Powdered Drakaen on them at all times.

That’s enough for now. Keep climbing the tree and make your way to those  spaces.

Codex Links



After the Rover phase ends, read “Well thy Gold and Purple Wing”,  10.

Well Thy Gold And Purple Wing

Q 12

Makaal watches as each Rover fluidly executes their martial arts, skills he could never hope to achieve, and reevaluates his immediate goals. He turns towards the fluttering avian, confident that the Rovers had the situation under control. "I don't think I caught your name, friend."

With as much pomp as a large, gleaming, winged being can manage, Silky's aerios mimes something of an arm-crossed (or wing-crossed) bow. "Silky, Fundamentalist and presider of Tuor, at your service. Well, as long as the service includes observation of some fashion."

The clan settlement built into the northern mountains? Had the zusag finally discovered a way to create intelligent autonomos? Then put one in charge of a clan? A chilling thought. The aerios let out a chuckle. "Your expression dances more than the fins of a rasska. This is just a projection of my own making. After all, I'm rather old to be climbing to the peak of The Seat of Storms."

Other Adversary Logic

!

It's the beginning of the adversary phase during round 2. That means you need to roll the ability dice for each adversary type and advance their ability token a number of spaces equal to the result on the ability dice. This will be the ability that each adversary will perform this round. Each of the dekahas other three abilities introduce something new.

Adversary Pushing and Pulling

!

Adversaries can push and pull their enemies too (pg. 47). The Dekahas Hydraulic Whip ability has an attack action with a push ➡ 2 effect. Adversaries are aware of traps, dangerous terrain, and the impact damage rule. They will try to push you into these areas in such a way to maximize damage. Otherwise, if adversaries can't maximize damage by pushing or pulling you, they'll push or pull you to maximize distance.

▶

Traps

!

Both adversaries and Rovers can place traps onto the map. Rovers that can place traps have special trap tiles in their class box, while adversaries share the same trap tile. Traps are a tile, so be sure you're familiar with the tile placement rules (pg. 27). The action that places the trap explains any restrictions to placement and the effects of the trap. You can place damage chits onto the trap tile as a reminder of how much damage it does.

Multi-Target Healing

!

The last bit of logic we will cover is multi-target healing (pg. 47). Adversaries want to heal as many damaged targets as possible, preferring closer targets over further targets. If there aren't enough damaged targets to choose from to maximize targets healed, adversaries will target the closest adversary units, even if they're at maximum ♥.

That's enough new rules for now. Remember, there is a 5 Round Limit for this encounter. Spend the remainder of the rounds leveraging all the mechanics you've learned and try to make it to the ◀ space on time!

Codex Links

Q

Q 14

Immediately when all Rovers occupy an ◀ space, read "Close Dungeon of Innumerable Boughs", 11.

That Slumbrous Influence Kest

Q 13

Makaal's jubilant clapping echoes around the wooden enclosure. "I honestly thought that coffer was lost for good! Help yourself to the stores inside; I was expecting to leave it behind when we escaped. Not only would I have never guessed the nektari took off with the key, but you could not pay me to try and wrest anything from one of their hives."

The merchant's willingness to part with so much of his supply seems odd, but perhaps he truly had lost hope of leaving this place alive. His hurried whispers and gestures to placate his starling partner are

▶

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suspicious, but his hushed reasoning seems to pass muster as the starling's posture relaxes after their quiet discussion.

Reward



Rovers gain 10 .

Close Dungeon Of Innumerable Boughs 14

Conclusion

The last of you manages to press into the recess that the two merchants and their draught beast were hidden away within. As you prepare to clear a path for the escort-and-retreat, the starling Mo motions to you and Silky. "Rovers, perhaps you would like to discuss... an extended partnership?" Makaal cracks a smile and nods along with the suggestion.

He motions to the equipment each of you brought along. "While those seem like... fine weapons for dealing with young galeaper and pesky silvans, perhaps you would be more interested in exchanging them for something crafted by expert keb rasska technique and starling proficiency?" He excitedly slaps a box strapped to Grandpaw, eliciting a low bark from the arkenyn.

"Really, this setback has changed our plans quite a bit. What say you let us tag along for a time? We can offer our services; Mo's expert crafting, my own keen eye for opportunity, and Grandpaw's enduring sten—strength, to carry all of your supplies!" Makaal proclaims with a gleam to his eyes and a smile to match.

Victory!



Reward

Congratulations, you found Mo and Makaal! Rovers gain 10*R .

Mo and Makaal will help you in your fight against the galeapers, for the right price! M&Ms shop is now open. Open the Merchant level 1 deck. This deck forms the basis of the shop. You can now buy and sell items (pg. 45). Remember, items sell for half of their cost (rounded up).

Campaign Link



Encounter 0.3 - "The Storms Hath Bound",  10.

Borne In Heedless Hum

Conclusion

The viscous fluids of the galeaper queen and her brood mixes with the rain, dripping heavily from your bodies. As the queen exhales her last, the remnants of her swarm scatter as quickly as they can. Without the cohesion of a pod they'll likely fall prey to something more threatening. No matter where they end up, it's for the best that they are no longer able to defend a queen bolstering their numbers.

A loud crunch disrupts the still scene—Grandpaw holds aloft one of the queen's forewings victoriously clutched between his jaws. Curled over the arkenyn's head is Mo, running their limbs over the carapace of the wing and attaching various small bits of metal and leather to it. "I think this could serve as suitable reward for your efforts, and the beginnings of a proper partnership between us, Rovers. This is quite the opportunity for us both!" they exclaim.

Victory!



Reward

Congratulations! You've cleared out the galeaper nest, restored peace to the Uzem shrine, and saved Mo and Makaal. Rovers gain 10*R  and one "Cutting Galewing" item (pull this item from the reward deck).

Don't forget you can buy and sell from Mo and Makaal's shop.



Q 15

Rovers are now level 2! Rovers can now take one upgrade card with them into an encounter. Remember, when you start an encounter you form a hand of five cards (pg. 56-57). At the start of each encounter you'll want to replace one of your basic cards with an upgrade card. Since this isn't a permanent choice you're making, you can replace which card you take for each encounter. Try any of your skills that look interesting, or select an upgrade card that will help you overcome a challenge you'll face in the encounter.

For more information on leveling up, read page 63.

Campaign Link



Chapter 1 - "A Choice",  12.

Silvan Theory

Q 16

Days prior, as the party breaches the outer edge of the forest.

Mo inspects the sheaf of wood once more while carefully tracing over the engravings with their tendrils. "Relax, Mo. This is simple work for you now!" Makaal encourages. Silky's aerios whistles in admiration as he inspects the wooden plate. Set into the center of the engravings is a bevel that contains a small chunk of crystallized Earth.

"I can see that the engravings are meant to direct a catalytic process from the ether, but to what end?" he inquires.

Mo twists their attention to the aerios in surprise. "Is this something that you've seen before?" they ask, tilting their head. "To answer your question, it's designed to capture some of the properties of a grovetender, relying on the Earth crystal to keep part of it alive on the shield. I've never tested this design on an Earth-aspected silvan specifically, but I'm confident it will result in a sturdy buckler in the end. Unfortunately, we'll need to wait until we find quite a strong specimen for the framework to properly attach to."

Conclusion

You haven't even finished wiping the pond scum off before an echoing screech pierces the treeline. It is unlike anything you have ever heard.

When the noise subsides, a person slowly drags themselves out of the trees, the bark creaking and cracking around them. It looks to be a tihfur of the Yanshif, but something is wrong... Their features are distorted and pitch-colored. It gazes toward your party, prompting everyone to move back defensively. Its face, half-formed into a beak, peels back into a crazed grin.

"GIVE ME YOUR HIDE.

GIVE ME YOUR FLESH.

GIVE ME YOUR WING.

CAN THERE BE ANOTHER ONE?"

With one more body-rattling screech the menacing tihfur disappears back into the treeline, leaving a trail of dark, sticky ichor. The forest falls deathly quiet except for the gurgling sounds of the strange fluid staining the ground and trees. Even from a distance it emits a presence of sorts; a tangible discomfort and need to repel even the space around it. Identifiably Morphic, but not in the ways that any of you have come to understand. When Morph is expressed it normally comes with a purer sort of desire: to grow, to host, to build. Whatever this is, it is not simply condensed Morph, but something... bitter.

Grandpaw passes slowly around the substance, keeping a wide berth. Makaal seems lost in thought. Even Mo's tendrils try to pull themselves away from the grime, completely unbidden. The aerios hops down from its perch to inspect the substance by dipping a small portion of a wing into the gurgling muck. In the blink of an eye he wrenches back just as the tip makes contact; a streak of black energy had burrowed its way through much of the wing from the brief touch. "That, ostensibly masked, plea of the Yanshif messenger may have been even more desperate than we suspected," Silky intones.



Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R

Each Rover begins the next encounter with one additional dice in their personal pool.

Campaign Link



Go to - **"Then Came too Late the Warning"**, 18.

Creeping Darkness

The twisted tihfur clutches at its body—black ichor oozing from its wounds. Confusion spreads over its face, beginning at the rapid movements of its third eye, and twitching down every other feature on its head. Its beak opens and closes as if searching for words, but none are found; instead a stream of ichor pours forth.

It twists in on itself and falls to the ground—splashing into its own puddle of filth. "Rest now, brother. The flock is less without you," the tihfur woman plucks a feather from her wing and drops it over his head. A vague hissing reveals that the very blood of the monstrous tihfur you have slain has taken on a corrosive property. Everywhere the fluids touch leaves behind an odd crackling sound as decay sets in. Your attention is pulled away as another voice, one full of phlegm, begins crying out from the forest's depths.

"BIRDS OF A FEATHER! BIRDS OF A FEATHER!"

Another similarly disturbed voice joins in with the crowing.

"AGAIN AGAIN AGAIN AGAIN AGAIN AGAIN—"

The tihfur woman drags one of her shifted legs through the dirt, leaving behind deep grooves from the length of her talons. Most tihfur out of shift are lithe, but a better description for the woman whose fight you have joined would be 'gaunt'. Her entire left side, from head to foot, is covered in an elaborate runic scrawl. Black lettering stretches across her shifted left wing. She allows everyone to inspect her for a few moments before offering a slight



bow, causing another feather to fall loose and join the small piles strewn in the grass. She introduces herself as Zeepurah, and sadly emphasizes being the “lone” leader of the Yanshif clan. Before she can explain further, more screeching breaks through the trees.

“ANOTHER. ANOTHER! MORE. MORE! GATHER. GATHER!”

Zeepurah’s features darken—a troubling scowl spilling over her face.

Unnatural Stillness

Conclusion

A blood-chilling shriek floods the forest, drowning all other noise. Crashes as if entire tree trunks were being cleaved follow after the clamor. Large talons erupt from the treeline and snap through a wide trunk—a mature and hulking tihfur, in full shift, emerges from within the forest.

“EEENOUGH!”

That single word is enough to send every other creature scattering back into the forest. It lets out a deafening shrieking roar before springing into the sky and flying into the murky dusk—its heavy wingbeats disturbing the forest in its wake. “I certainly think not! I’ll be the judge of whether we’ve had enough!” Silky’s aerios squawks before taking off after it in a flurry of glimmering wingbeats.

“Skin me alive! That’s the direction of my flock’s roost. Forgiveness asked, Rovers, but I need your help for more than was prescribed. They will poison the bodies and spirits of my remaining family—this cannot be allowed.”

Triumphant baying from Grandpaw heralds his emergence from the trees with Mo and Makaal in tow on his back. Makaal grins and extends both hands to help you on. “We’ll meet you there!”

Zeepurah nods and takes off skyward. Her other wing bursts forth in an eruption of ragged feathers—each flap casting off wads of frayed pinions that further darken the treetops beneath her.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R , plus an additional 10xN , where N equals the number of Nahoot that were slain.

Campaign Link



Encounter 1.2 - “Then Came too Late the Warning”
 18.

Knock On Wood

Upon entering the nest-home, the darkness and silence surrounding you is broken by the sound of talons trembling against the floor. Huddled in the corner is a young boy draped in a dark feather cloak. He stiffens at your approaching footsteps. As another distant cry further in the village pierces the solitude, he leaps out with his talons drawn. Before fully closing the distance, he realizes you’re not here to hurt him and stumbles across the floor, falling to his knees with a quiet sob.

While helping the boy from his home he mentions how he alone stalked a terranape through the forest, waiting for an opportunity to steal a bloom from the beast. He proudly explains that he escaped the vise-grip of the beast by snapping off one of his own finger bones to slip from its grasp. If he was so brave then, why was that courage so far from his reach now?—such was the child’s lament.

After a brief search of the boy’s home tree, a lockbox is spotted within a hollow. A few practiced lunges up the side of the tree and a quick twist of the box’s clasp reveals its hidden bounty. Found within is a pristine terranape mallow, and a claw still pulsing with Morphic energy—just as the boy had described.



20

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R

The Rover that collected the hoard tile gains one “**Imbuing Potion**” item and one “**Tihfur Claw**” item. They may equip these items. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Into the Tainted Air

21

An exultant screech echoes through the village, gleeful and gurgling. Strange energy flows through the trees and chokes the air. There is no still water found in a raging river—you have even less time than you previously thought.

Pillars of dusk open through the treetops as dozens of claws tear their way through the leaves. Wingbeats fill the air from all directions as they descend from the trees—hissing Galeaper cleave their way through the village, followed by another imposing Nahoot. The Zaghan scans the remnants of the village, slowly swiveling his head around completely with disturbing crunches punctuating it every few degrees, before spinning back and stopping to lock all three eyes with Zeepurah.

“HE MISSES YOU. WE NEED YOU. WHY WON’T YOU STAY WITH US?”

Zeepurah snarls and whips a slab of broken wood with shocking speed at the fallen tihfur, who disappears back into the trees with a hissing screech. “I DID STAY—OUR HOME IS HERE!” she screams in reply.

Taken a Toll

22

Conclusion

Grandpaw can be heard chasing the rest of the beasts and remaining Nah, the title Zeepurah labeled the twisted tihfur with, out of the village grounds. His deep growls and howls surprisingly bring some calm back to the area. Zeepurah collapses to one knee and buries her talons in the dirt for support. The gleam of Silky’s aerios can be seen just overhead—watching patiently.

“He was lost to us in the mires at the edge of the Taharik. We took great pride in keeping the forest free of predators. It was a game for us—to compete between one another to bring home the greatest quarry. There was a dawn where he didn’t return. Then... something happened. I felt it... I felt him succumb. He always thought so highly of himself...”

After a few beats of her wings and steady breaths, Zeepurah rises and faces away from the turmoil of the village. “I hadn’t imagined he would root himself so deeply and so quickly. Forgiveness asked, Rovers, for I still require your assistance.” She rips at the dirt, casting up clods of dark soil and shredded foliage. “Please. There aren’t enough of us to stop it.” She wipes the tears from her eyes and tries to collect herself. “We must stop him from tainting this place any further.”

Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 3! Rovers can now take two upgrade cards with them into an encounter.

Reward

Rovers gain 15*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 1.4 - “**The River of Black Bile Flows**”
 22.

Marsh Mallow

Q 23

Notes from Tuor's bestiary—

Terranapes are strange beasts by all accounts. Massive, territorial, and... selectively clever? They know well enough how to use their strength to control the nesting grounds. Some even tie vines to trees as makeshift traps! However, they never seem willing to allow more than a few others of their species into claimed territory. Young pups are sent into the wilderness after they're strong enough to hunt for their own food. Should they return after that time they are met with the same rancor held for any other perceived invader. Or held for their own siblings or mates. Or for random rocks and trees. They're an outrageously dangerous and volatile presence if they take root anywhere near a clan's home.

Something unique to the terranape is their incredibly potent healing. It seems their bodies are host to a special kind of plant that feeds on their elemental affinities and provides heightened recovery in return. Those brave enough to try and rend these from the bodies of the felled (or still-living for the truly fearless) will find themselves with an amazing reagent for recovery.

Not-so-Sweet Nektar

Q 24

An eruption of ichor bursts forth from the hive! Whatever the colorful spores dusting the outside of the hive may have led one to believe, the inside is naught but a solid pod of pitch. The disturbed nektari within are also much paler than their usual cousins. With each flap of their wings flecks of the black syrup are cast about through the air and along the trees.

Rather than the bright and effervescent Arcana-infused nektar that is usually produced in a hive like this, it seems their diet has consisted heavily of Anima-infused essences. The nektar congeals and scabs quickly now that it has been exposed to the open air. It still seems useful as a catalyst regardless of its strange transformation.



Reward



Rovers gain 5*R

The Rover that destroyed the Nektari Hive gains one “**Captured Anima**” item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed. Then spawn R Nektari Swarms within 1 of the destroyed hive.

Midst Of Black Waters

Q 25

Conclusion

As the last bit of the giant silvan's trunk is splintered and obliterated, Hokmala turns to face the dark stream and unleashes a torrent of black bile back into it. A swarm of pale nektari erupt from his fronds and take flight, crossing far to the other side of the stream. It takes one step forward into the churning ichor, the tainted fluid saturating its leg. Another leg, another foul splatter of liquid across a root-like paw and into the massive wounds in its trunk.

Whatever properties the stream now contains, they don't seem to be beneficial to the creature. It struggles to move any further and finally succumbs to its wounds. It falls over completely, its body creating a makeshift bridge across the black water. Zeepurah takes a deep breath before moving to a nearby tree and biting down on her finger. When she pulls it away from her mouth, a glowing substance mixed with her blood comes with it. She shifts the finger into a talon, which she uses to carve a glowing mural into the tree's trunk.

Mo rushes over to the fallen grovetender, thrusting a wooden plate into one of the larger wounds, careful to avoid the dark fluids that splash out. Zeepurah squints at the scene playing out, but says nothing. A bright green flash erupts from the cleaved trunk that the plate was nestled in, and many of Hokmala's flowers and vines recede into its body. With the effort of many tendrils along with their claws, Mo wrenches out a shield coated in writhing vines—those of a grovetender's.

“Hokmala's death can be dignified like this. This



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25

shield shall carry forward as a memory of the forest.”
Mo explains. Zeepurah’s eyes widen before she nods in acceptance.

With the memorial complete, you all cross Hokmala’s body into the inky blackness that stretches across the other side of the polluted river.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 10*R and one “Tendervine Ward” item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 1.5 - “There is Always a Bigger Beast”
 24.

Just Desserts

26

As the tar-like sludge the hive was producing recedes, the solid crystal of Morph ether can finally be reached. Whatever powers the Ahma has, they at least in some part have been stored within these Morphic growths. His head whips to face you and a deep snarl travels across the swamp.

With a moist crackling, like that of an egg hatching, a swarm of darkly-colored and slime-coated nektari are released from the remnants of the hive. They float and buzz angrily— mirroring the emotions on display from the Ahma.

Special Rules



Spawn R Corrupted Nektari Swarms within 1 of the destroyed hive.

Tast of Morphic Paradise

27

“LEAVE US ROVERS,
I ONLY WISH TO SING,
YOU WILL NOT TAKE MY HOME!”

Hasayon’s wings go rigid as he launches himself out of the grove and into the blackened trees to the south. You hear his requiem begin again, though much weaker than before. The air hums with his foul energy.

“He retreats to find succor and convalesce; this is a verse he used to sing to me when treating my wounds. It... There is a part of me that believes I can still reach him—the part that remembers these songs. Forgiveness asked, Rovers. I do not think Man and Haya are too far gone for me to bring them back to balance. Let me try and save my beloved.”

It seems Hasayon’s song is more than just for his own peace of body and mind, however. Gray and colorless nektari can be seen fluttering through the blackened trees, back towards his roost.

Special Rules



Black Grove

The Ahma has consumed all the corruption in the environment.

The Ahma now uses the Ahma Wretched statistic block, recovering its current to maximum. Move the Ahma Corrupter ability token to the same ability number on the Ahma Wretched statistic block.

Remove all dice from all nodes and place them on the Ahma Wretched statistic block.

The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to defeat the Ahma Wretched.

Codex Links



28

Immediately when the Ahma Wretched is slain, read “Compulsions” 18.

Compulsions

Q 28

Conclusion

Zeepurah rushes to Hasayon's side, her body practically in full shift as she does her best to wrap the shivering behemoth with her limbs and wings. His ragged breathing fills the tepid grove. The creaking of his bones grows quieter—replaced with the ruffling of feathers. Suddenly, the runes that paint Zeepurah's body glow with a soft light. Slowly but surely the same runes can be seen faintly tracing their way around Hasayon's diminished form, cast in that same glow.

A deep and distorted voice forces its way out of Hasayon. "My muse, you can't. I can't. How much damage I've wrought, nothing could—"

"Be silent and follow your Dominant," Zeepurah interrupts him. Before long, the runes finish forming along Hasayon's many wings. As the last rune etches itself into existence Hasayon collapses violently to the ground, writhing in agony.

Zeepurah shakes the pity from her gaze as she turns to your group. "Forgiveness asked, Rovers. This may take some time."

Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 4! All Rovers evolve into a Prime class.

 *Note: For more information on leveling up, read page 63 of the rule book.*

Reward

Rovers gain 25*R  and one "Ahma Cowl"  item. Mark the milestone "Subdued the Ahma" on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Q 29

Read quest conclusion, "Nevermore",  18.

Nevermore

Q 29

Conclusion

Dawn claws its way through the grove, chasing away the torpor that had fallen over the swamp. Beasts and bugs can be heard calling out to the sun as though it were any other sunrise. As if they hadn't spent the night listening to Hasayon's sorrowful wails and choked-out apologies.

The runes painted over Hasayon's reduced and disfigured body ceased glowing when whatever treatment Zeepurah imparted had run its course. Unable to fully restore him to his natural state but having helped bring him closer to the original balance. Left behind from the process is the molted husk of the Ahma—a parody of the creature that Hasayon once was, composed out of feather and bone, held together by tears and blood. Mo has collected the refuse, muttering excitedly about its "residual potency".

Zeepurah briefly explains about the process. "Our union was more than love or duty, Rovers; it was a binding wrought in the Morph. Essences inextricably joined. When Hasayon began to fall, so too did I. His transformation broke the union. We both suffered for it, and that accelerated his descent into madness. We are indebted to you for helping to reunite us before I suffered the same fate and we both destroyed the Taharik entirely."

Guilt is but one of the many emotions still plaguing Hasayon as he weakly tries to sing. Zeepurah handles him tenderly, doing her best to smooth his feathers and keep him steady. She has assured everyone that this was the best possible outcome. There is nothing more but for them and their clan to rebuild and convalesce.

Campaign Link



Chapter 2 - "A Choice",  38.

The Bush Is The Obstacle

Q 30

As with many therans that have an affinity for Earth, the zinix is host to a unique kind of flora that has grown symbiotically with it. Cladrind is a hearty flower that sprouts from the vines that root in and around the zinix's shell. When consumed raw, as the zinix is prone to, it confers an immediate boost to endurance. When used as a reagent it allows for the hardening and binding of most material—including flesh and bone.

As you shift your weight along the narrow mountain pass, the shrubbery that had resided on either end suddenly wrenches themselves free from the slopes. Zinix that were comfortably sunbathing—now angered by your assault. Their many long claws find easy purchase on the slopes and crag littered about. Where a precarious boulder might obstruct a regular person, Zinix have no trouble scaling over and around such obstacles.

Dust Endures No Restraint

Q 31

Conclusion

With a screech and rattling of its scaly coat, the massive beast succumbs to its wounds and falls over, quaking the earth with the force of its collapse. Moments later, the clattering of the armored queens of the clan announce their arrival to the scene. The rasska queen stalks her way over to the corpse, inspecting it from a few angles before rearing back with her tail and punting it in the direction of the keb queen who was still mounted atop her own, even larger, crystal-clad gruv. Such a feat speaks to outrageous strength hidden within the frame of the rasska queen.

With an alien stillness to her body the keb queen is carried over to the corpse by her curious mount. The mount sniffs the discarded corpse a few times before its myriad tongues shoot out and quickly begin lapping at the wounds. The rasska queen whip-cracks her tail to get everyone's attention, to which the keb queen shows no reaction at all.

"So, a delicious surprise. Call me Marii of Ezmen, Rovers," the rasska croaks, with surprising articulateness, wearing a predator's grin.



Q 31

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 10*R  and one "Gruv Scale-Mail" item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 2.2 - "A Visit to a Mine",  30.

Crystalline Depression

Q 32

While the main passages of the cave are illuminated by the glowing mushrooms and blazing wrathbone, tucked away at the other ends of the compact and winding corridors everything instead seems to be cast in a violent haze of pinks, purples, and blues. Myriad chunks of what seems to be the same crystals that emblazon the armor and weapons of the keb rasska army are littered throughout the deeper arteries of the cave system.

Kelo and Saras wave you off when prompted about them. Apparently the crystals quickly lose potency when not harvested from the live entomans that produce them. As they are now the crystals are merely just the usual, perhaps slightly more valuable, lyst. Both of the siblings are more than happy for you to keep it for Mo and Makaal as their own crafters have no use for the material.

Reward



Rovers gain 10 

Such A Fuss

33

Onisski are large entomans that stalk the subterranean depths in search of a place to grow their homes. Their only instinct to cultivate the glowing fungus that roots in and shakes free from their carapace. For a variety of reasons the so-called onisski finds itself as the custodian of many such deep and dark places. The phosphorescent mushrooms they cultivate are quick to bloom and rich with Water Ether, which supplies sustenance for other life they share their environments with. Clans that preside deep within Chorus rely upon the trails that onisski develop as a way to create fertile grounds for farming and irrigation.

While the glow from an onisski's fungal colony may seem welcoming... it marks a kind of danger as well. Not only are the entomans driven into a frenzy when anything approaches their colonies, but the tendrils of these mushrooms can punch through anything when they're taking root. Soil, rock, carapace, and especially flesh. A natural death for these creatures is when their personal spore colony has literally torn through their own bodies.

The Crystal And Its Story

34

Conclusion

The stale air hangs heavy within this recessed chamber of the cavern. After slaying the rest of the wild creatures, it becomes more apparent why they were collected here. Pulsing with a strange energy is a veritable wall of crystals that match the equipment of Kelo and Saras' clan. With a subdued reverence weighing on their faces the pair approach the gleaming mass. Kelo leaps from Saras and presses his horns against the crystals for a few moments. He turns back with a serious expression.

Suddenly, a sonorous ringing cuts through the tension; Saras has swung one of her daggers at the crystal formation. Both the dagger and the crystals are vibrating in harmony. A grin spreads across her face. "There is a request I have," she says cryptically.



34

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 2.3 - "Description of a Struggle", 32.

It Must Catch Fire

35

Chorus' underground is no less vibrant, nor more safe, than its surface. Evolutionary competition fueled by magic is just as fierce. An easy example is the wrathbone, named by humans who live on the borders of caves, which wields its affinity for Fire in a surprising show of ingenuity.

While naturally blind, these large reptiles are profoundly sensitive to temperature, and use that sensitivity as a sense nearly as effective as the sight they lack. In the depths of caves and other poorly lit regions it makes sense for a creature to evolve a more sophisticated means of navigation. They seek their prey with goutts of flame and smaller embers cast from and along their bodies. They attack their targets with blistering heat and knife-like spines—the natural weapons from where their name was drawn—then greedily feast on the pre-cooked remains.

Agreement Is The Best Weapon

36

Sek fighters are known for their strength and endurance above all. Together with the young keb charges they bring to help instill combat experience, a combat unit is formed that serves as the vanguard for many clan settlements. Zisafi, however, are a specialized unit. An agile and furtive rasska paired with a potent Morph-channeling keb that draws attention away from the stealthy attacker. Mix them in with a complement of sek and their effectiveness is that much more pronounced.

Higher ranking officials gain the title of "Principal" and frequently garner positions as commanders and quartermasters. They become responsible for



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organizing and educating those beneath them in the clan's wider affairs—the army of the Ezmen is no different.

By dispatching the quartermaster you gain the key to access whatever cache this particular camp was left in charge of. Clans with keb rasska members often have a streak of paranoia and so the creation of lockboxes is a venerated practice therein. Saras suggests the cache is likely to contain standby weapons set aside when the principal was promoted and gained an ezmenite weapon.

Reward

Make a note that the Rover that slew the Zisafi Principle **“has the Quartermaster's key”**. If Kelo & Saras slew the Zisafi Principle, the Rover that is controlling Kelo & Saras has the Quartermaster's key.

Codex Links

37

At the end of the round, if the Rover with **“Quartermaster's key”** is within 1 of the treasure chest , read **“Better to Have”**,  21.

Better To Have

Inside of the camp's stores you find an allowance of lyst, a discarded weapon as Saras predicted, and emergency medical supplies. The lyst is yours now—liberated from the clawed grip of slavers.

Medical tinctures are a common product crafted and traded by keb rasska alchemists and merchants. As such, poultices and other supplies are a common sight in subterranean enclave clans. The species of keb and rasska are at two ends of a particularly ironic spectrum. Where rasska are full of vitality and able to regenerate most wounds from a near-death state, their robust bodies come at the cost of a metabolism so potent it can shorten their already comparatively short lives. On the other end a keb that keeps out of danger can live for generations, but despite their natural alignment with the power of Morph, their bodies often have extreme difficulty healing through natural means.

Reward

Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that unlocked treasure chest  gains both one **“Vigor Juice”** item and one **“Slagblade”** item. They may equip these items. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Hot And Dreadful

38

Conclusion

In the chaotic scramble and stress of the explosion-aided escape Mo and Makaal's most prominent skills appear to be getting themselves into trouble. “Leave it to a starling to come up with a strategem that sees a stash of inert silvan pods erupt with the power to shake a mountain!” Silky squawks, the aerios fleeing much further into the caves.

“Can't deny its effectiveness!” Makaal shouts back, a grin spread across his face. Kelo and Saras share a grimace as they pull ahead of your group and lead everyone away from the outpost and into the passages they had marked.

After gaining enough distance from the camp the siblings motion for a reprieve. “This is far enough,” Saras croaks. She pulls out the roughly-sketched map that was acquired from the clan and checks it over. “Just beyond this bend,” she says, motioning for you to follow yet deeper into the cavern.

Victory!

Level Up

Rovers are now level 3! Rovers can now take two upgrade cards with them into an encounter.

Reward

Rovers gain 15*R .

Campaign Link

Encounter 2.4 - **“The Burrow”**,  34.

Ready To Release

Q 39

One should think that flowers and vines, by and large, would be one of the less threatening inhabitants of Chorus. Unfortunately this is false, and quite dangerous to believe. Silvans on average may be even fiercer than therans. Certainly not to be trifled with unless you know what you are dealing with.

Tihfur were (and still are) usually the first to categorize the more dangerous plants one encounters across the lands, thus many derive their labels from tihfur convention. Ashemak were among the most feared for their sheer intensity—a silvan that had somehow adopted an affinity for Fire. It uses flame to ignite their seeds and launch them at speeds faster than any amount of eyes can hope to track. It will puncture through rock just as easily as flesh, taking root wherever the seeds find themselves embedded.

For this reason it has spread far and wide, and the hazardous ashemak eventually found itself being used as a form of natural defense by more enterprising clans throughout Lalos.

Absorption Without Assimilation

Q 40

Days prior, Mo speaks as the party begins their hike through the valley—

“Rovers, I expect that throughout these mountains we will encounter several urns. They are irritating pests that consume every last thing around them. The only value they create is much of what they digest becomes converted into small bits of ether that is secreted through their shells—producing those crystals they are so known for. Excellent sources of lyst, but usually a disaster for anything that lives close.

“Starlings, myself as well, view this process as somewhat perplexing... but can’t help but be envious still. Freely converting active energy into inactive energy has potent implications, but their process is exceedingly wasteful. It is also all they do. Powerful creatures that hold so much potential within them. Yet, slowly, ceaselessly, stupidly, they store all of that energy to never be felt or experienced. I think you will find that Makaal and myself will put that lyst to far better use should you bring it back with you!”

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that slayed the urn gains one “**Arcana Pigment**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Truth Cannot Know Itself

Q 41

The skara grub suddenly slams itself against the too-thin passage. It begins trying to claw and chew its way through furiously, as if possessed. Kelo and Saras show no reaction to the skara’s sudden change in behavior, instead turning to face your group with a new despondence bearing on their expressions. They each draw their ezmenite blades and stalk toward you.

“Apologies, Rovers. This ruse was necessary.” Kelo drones. “Suddenly showing yourselves... this complicated matters. As the instrument of Femii’s accords, this must be completed.” He assumes a combat stance and presses intangibly against your minds, conveying emotions equal parts guilt for the siblings’ deception and obligation to their clan. Saras casts one last glance at him, then turns away with a hiss, flashing her blade towards you.

Another wave of emotion crashes over you all, this one coming from the passage obscured by the skara.

ELATION

PRIDE

SUPERIORITY

Each one hammering brutally against your psyche. Above all follows a demand for obedience. Your queen will see you kneel.



41

Special Rules



Double Cross

Kelo & Saras have revealed their true allegiance to you; discard their ally card. They are now enemies to the Rovers and use the Sek Principle statistic block. Set their current to their new maximum . Kelo & Saras immediately perform their “Coordinated Assault” ability. You have 4 rounds to defeat them.

Victory Condition



The victory condition has changed!
Slay Kelo & Saras.

Codex Links



42

Immediately when Kelo & Saras are slain, read “Don’t Touch my Chains”, 23.

Don’t Touch my Chains

42

Conclusion

DISAPPOINTMENT**INDIGNATION****FEAR**

Femii’s emotional outbursts continue and send the rest of the soldiers in the corridors to scatter, likely afraid of retribution should they too fail to live up to their queen’s expectations. Grandpaw trods alongside Mo and Makaal, with Silky’s aerios perched upon Mo’s shoulder.

Kelo and Saras lay sprawled across the ground, equipment shattered against the rocks, the debt of loyalty paid in full. Grandpaw sniffs carefully around the bodies. “Some shards of the ezmenite carry significant residual Earth ether to be drawn upon, but otherwise the remaining material is only good as lyst.” Mo explains.

Helpless against Femii’s bidding, the skara has successfully managed to tunnel its way into the deep chamber that the two leaders of the Ezmen clan now hide within. The only choice now is to follow and dethrone the oppressive queens.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R . Each Rover begins the next encounter with one additional dice in their personal pool.

Campaign Link



Encounter 2.5 - “Kenyn and Keb”, 36.

Usurpation

43

JUBILATION

FREEDOM

DISGUST

regret

You can't know the service you've accomplished for me, Rovers. Marii was a burden—**WEAK PITIFUL IRRELEVANT**—the last vestige of a life I've long since wished to erase. Now I'm free—**I'M FREE I'M FREE I'M FREE**—to wield the clan as I've truly desired and usher order unto Chorus.

Femii's head snaps over to gaze upon Marii's body. She chuckles to herself, the hisses and rasps of the laugh echoing off of the chamber walls. Her skara stalks toward the body ever so slowly. In a blink it impales Marii on a limb and drags it back to its endless maw—grinding, crushing, pulverizing the former queen.

Femii tilts her head back and emits a shriek that echoes through what feels like the entire mountain. Within moments a stream of enthralled soldiers and therans scramble into the chamber from the entry tunnel.

Special Rules



Gambit

Proceed to page 23 of the adversary book.

Femii now uses the Femii Sovereign statistic block, recovering her current to maximum. Move the Femii ability token to the same ability number on the Femii Sovereign statistic block.

Move all crystalline spears (hoard tiles) from the Femii statistic block to the Femii Sovereign statistic block.

The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to defeat Femii Sovereign.



Special Rules



Earth Resonance

Place an dice on ether node . This is now:

Earth Node: Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Special Rules



Royalist Loyalist

Femii has called for reinforcements. Spawn adversaries in the following spaces according to R:

2: Spawn one zisafi in each space.

3: Spawn one zisafi in each space. Spawn one zinx in each and space.

4: Spawn one zisafi in each and space. Spawn one zinx in each and space.

Codex Links



44

Immediately when Femii is slain, read “**Communicate Something Incommunicable**”, 25.

Conclusion

FEAR

You would condemn Chorus? What gives you the right? You lack the necessary strength. What gives you the right? WHAT GIVES YOU THE RIGHT? WHAT GIVES YOU THE RIGHT?

Femii's psychic hysteria continues, seizing everything and everyone still within the mountain. With one final outburst she topples from her seat atop the dying skara—and her head slams against an awkwardly protruding chunk of ezmenite along the creature's carapace. A puncturing snap heralds a deathly quiet throughout the broodchamber. Heavy silence permeates the caverns as every directly enthralled by Femii shares in her fate.

"Rovers! By my horns, what is— Oh!" exclaims the aerios as it flutters into the chamber. "I was so absorbed in protecting our charges that... my word..." Silky trails off, for once struggling to find words.

After a few moments, Mo and Makaal rush in after Silky and stop just as quickly to take in the sight of destruction before them. Mo shakes their reverie quickly and begins an examination of the chamber and the felled skara, even going as far as to liberate a broken mail of ezmenite from its jaws.

Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 4! All Rovers evolve into a Prime class.



Note: For more information on leveling up, read page 63 of the rule book.

Reward

Rovers gain 25*R  and one "Ezmenite Plate" item. Mark the milestone "Dispatched the Sovereign" on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Read quest conclusion, "Still and Solitary",  27.

With a groan the skara enthralled by Femii collapses to the ground; the grinding of its legs and body against itself filling the chamber with a deafening clamor.

HORROR

FURY

REVULSION

YOU KNEW WHAT WAS AT STAKE MARI. YOU KNEW YOU KNEW YOU KNEW—

Femii's mental assault abates as she suddenly gags—an unsettling noise from a keb—and claws her way out from underneath the corpse of her mount. One limb after the other towards Marii, her cracked and bloodied face seized in an expression of utter contempt. Marii gives a sad shake of her head as she stares down at the pitiful form of her partner. A sudden, loud crack punctuates the end of Femii's shuffling along the cave floor. When Marii turns back to face you she raises her tail in challenge—now stained in blood and flecked with bits of white chitin.

"Sleep, sister. The burden of Chorus was so much for you. For us. There shall be vengeance, then there shall be rest. **SOLDIERS, ASSEMBLE!**"

Special Rules



Gambit

Proceed to page 22 of the adversary book.

Marii now uses the Marii Advocate statistic block, recovering her current  to maximum. Move the Marii ability token to the same ability number on the Marii Advocate statistic block.

Move all crystalline spears (hoard tiles) from the Marii statistic block to the Marii Advocate statistic block.

The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to defeat Marii Advocate.



Special Rules

Fire Resonance

Place a  dice on ether node . This is now:

Fire Node: Units that end their turn within  1 of this object suffer  1.

Special Rules

Royalist Loyalists

Marii has called for reinforcements. Spawn adversaries in the following spaces according to R:

- 2: Spawn one sek in each  space.
- 3: Spawn one sek in each  space. Spawn one ashemak in each  and  space.
- 4: Spawn one sek in each  and  space. Spawn one ashemak in each  and .

Codex Links

46

Immediately when Marii is slain, read “Explain Something Inexplicable”,  26.

Explain Something Inexplicable

46

Conclusion

Marii collapses to the ground in a heap, clutching at her various wounds and hissing in agony. She lifts a single claw above her and slowly forms a few signs before letting the limb fall to her side. The remaining Ezmen soldiers skulking at the edges of the chamber emit gentle clicking noises and collectively turn to leave.

“This fight is over. There is much regret, Rovers. Without Femii’s control, without enforcing the ranks, without the leadership... The Ezmen clan must dissolve. They shall find homes elsewhere—places without threats, without violence, without some force that controls them.

Femii... she wished for complete control. Of everything. Chorus becoming a sanctuary free of chaos... a sanctuary free of volition... such aspirations—the result is a swift death for us all.

Still, she required the support of a sister. There wasn’t another choice.” Having said her piece, Marii resigns herself to quiet groans and coughing. Mo and Makaal eventually come to collect your group and Silky. A gleaming spear of ezmenite is clutched in one of Mo’s limbs—likely gathered from one of the deserters.

Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 4! All Rovers evolve into a Prime class.



Note: For more information on leveling up, read page 63 of the rule book.

Reward

Rovers gain 25*R  and one “Ezmenite Lance” item. Mark the milestone “Dispatched the Advocate” on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



47

Read quest conclusion, “Still and Solitary”,  27.

Conclusion

“Fresh air has never before carried such relief!” Makaal exclaims as your party emerges from the depths of the mountain caves. Mo and Silky had kept everybody underground as they performed examinations and experiments upon the ezmenite, with the results of their tests coming up less than satisfactory. Ezmenite is a potent material and, with more time and resources, could contribute to some groundbreaking discoveries. Femii’s psychic abilities were already unprecedented—apparently large quantities of ezmenite could allow for a kind of augmentation to keb with potent psychic manifestation, if they were willing to dedicate years and years of their life to understanding the intricacies of “noetic resonance” and other esoteric properties as described by Silky. As far as the physical properties of the material are concerned its efficacy is already demonstrated but, according to Mo, is difficult to properly temper into equipment without training and specially crafted tools.

Given the apparent difficulty of doing anything more with the material in its current state, it will all have to wait until your mission for Silky is concluded. It is unclear how many clans and settlements the Ezmen Queens consumed or destroyed in their pursuit of their conquest. Any survivors will doubtless begin to spread fear and distrust of any who seek to collect and process ezmenite as a result of the army’s actions, so even if Mo and Makaal had their own designs on expanding their trade, it would almost certainly be met with reproach.

Roving throughout Lalos will allow other dreams, ideally ones less oppressive in nature, to flourish instead. Best to continue forward and let this particular iniquity stay buried.

Campaign Link



Chapter 2 - “A Choice”, 38.

In the distant past, stomaw were a proper therian of... some variety, before the Unsouled Barrens chewed them up and spat out whatever savage amalgamation of meat, tooth, and claw they now are. Or, perhaps more accurately, before the stomaw chewed each other up.

Few beasts are fool enough to make themselves prey for the whirlwinds of bone and death spread across the Barrens, and so the heinous creatures most frequently resort to cannibalism. Given that stomaw seem to be wrought by the region itself—strange and inexplicable hatcheries that form and gestate on their own—it might be something of a wider ecological balancing act conspired by the Barrens.

Filth within, filth without, as it were.

Whose Art Sublimely Shines

Mo detests the little therans. Haunts would be an uncommon sight for most throughout Lalos, but their travels with Makaal put them in the path of the greedy pests with surprising frequency. Nu’s core was always an attractive target for a haunt’s pilfering endeavors—it was only the additional wares kept with them that served as a better distraction.

Encountering a haunt in the Unsouled Barrens struck Mo as strange. Not only were they skilled at escaping detection, but their favorite locales were almost always the empty homes of forgotten clans. Had the Barrens stretched so far so quickly?

Reward



The Rover that slayed the haunt gains one “**Multifaceted Icon**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Conclusion

With a spray of red bile and a gurgling screech, the mound of bone and flesh collapses in on itself. The remaining stomaw scatter deeper into the Barrens, their violent hisses and sprays of red-tinged saliva disappearing into the distance.

Amazingly, an almost-calm descends upon the area. The distant screams haven't stopped, but there is far less wriggling in your immediate surroundings. A bit less squelching too! Reproducing this feat across the entire Barrens wouldn't be impossible, but the scale of it... there would need to be dozens of groups just like yours to spend the next year or more purging the region bit by bit. Assuming there weren't more important matters to attend to.

"A successful trial, by my estimate!" Silky comments cheerfully, not having to wade through the gore himself. "But you and I discussed something a little different—do you believe my suppositions now, Sentinel Ozendyn?"

Ozendyn folds his arms over his stomach and grits his teeth. "Your wisdom strikes me of those decades younger than you, but, what was it you said? Seeing is believing? I cannot argue with what your Rovers have shown me."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 3.2 - "Midst of Black Seas", 46.

Starlings are... beings of potential before anything else. That is why the nascent formations are referred to as 'vessels' and 'sprites'—they are unrefined forms simply waiting for their opportunity to develop. That assumes a natural genesis.

We know now that the starlings formed within and around the Unsouled Barrens are, at least seemingly, quite *unnatural*. Other starlings refer to them as "broken" for reasons only they seem to fully comprehend and the end result is a shocking lack of pity on their part for these lost souls.

Broken Vessels are exceedingly eager to merge their essence with anything sentient they come across. This manifests quite violently and is unwelcome by all, including other creatures akin to themselves. Perhaps they're acting on a twisted version of the base starling instinct to seek ether?

Capacity For Detachment

Transcribed excerpt from a presentation by "Silky," resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Ether takes on myriad forms, disciples. The snow that falls upon our mountain perch, the wind that cuts through the peaks and valleys, the conjurations we contemplate and manifest... but more commonly, it seems to take the inert form of crystals. While not immediately reactive, most crystals are but a single action from unleashing their latent, and often potent, energy. This is why lyst is exceedingly popular in bartering—and I might add you should always try to have at least some with you whilst journeying—popular because of its untapped potential as a reagent, material, or even a snack if you meet any starlings. A catalyst for any endeavor!

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R

The Rover that slayed the urn gains one "Arcana Pigment" item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Conclusion

Mo watches with a thrill as the giant monster of spike and bone collapses in on itself, the malicious glow of its ether slowly draining away. Having spent much of their life as far away from the Unsouled Barrens as possible, in and around the northern sea of Los, all Mo had to go on was hearsay and rumors that would reach the subterranean commune that shaped the starling. None of what had been described made sense at the time, but being here in person confirmed the wildest of claims the clan purported.

Not everything that had been spoken of was true, or even remotely accurate, but this place had certainly earned its reputation. What is surprising to Mo is that this place had taken on the name of “Barrens”. Frightening and dangerous as the area is, it is also absolutely replete with Anima ether. Morph obviously, but an interesting undercurrent of Crux is present amidst the rocks and soil.

Staying here longer than needed was far from any of Mo’s ideal futures, but there was no reason not to at least take the opportunity to see what could be fashioned from the materials on offer. The Rovers certainly seemed to appreciate the effort and it was exciting to see how they breathed life into the various creations. Hopefully enough of the equipment would prove valuable in pursuit of futures stolen from Mo and other starlings.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 10*R  and one “Scour Brand” item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 3.3 - “Paralyzed Memories”,  48.

Azoth are unique among all clades of living being. It is exceedingly rare for something living to be composed of both aspects of Anima in equal measure. Even with the successful fusion of the two energies within the silvan in question it seems... “volatile” at best. It sheds the semi-sentient zokolat fruits regularly which behave as a kind of defense. It’s believed that one out of every thousand of them carries the necessary properties to produce a new azoth sapling.

It’s theorized that this isn’t the only form of “reproduction” for the azoth, but regardless, even a ‘lesser’ zokolat is quite formidable as a lone entity. Their ether formulations are unique and quite valuable, to say nothing of the fact that they are fruit which will fight anything that draws near their “tree”. They don’t seem to survive long without access to Anima, and they putrefy quickly, leaving behind only a muddied puddle of that strange ether.

Reward



The Rover that collected the hoard tile gains one “**Sour Ichor**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot available, they may unequip items as needed.

Dyad have well-earned their reputations. Twin heads—each full of malice and hunger—with twin rows of fangs that span from snout to stomach. These clever creatures use their crests and Crux to captivate prey, before snapping forward to unleash their deadly venom. They make their homes just about anywhere warm without incident; other beasts prefer to find new dwellings rather than challenge a dyad. Handling dyads requires intense focus and care as one wrong move, or even just catching that strange bit of swaying movement from the corner of your eye, can spell disaster.

The giant silvan was likely viewed as a safe place for an injured mother to leave her hatchlings, relying on the shared properties of Anima to hide amongst the zokolati fruits which would otherwise make a meal of the young creatures. Given more time to mature, they’ll likely spread and begin to hunt the stomaw for food and territory, adding to the turmoil across the landscape.

Conclusion

Silky circles high above, looking down upon his charges and remaining wary of what was once the azoth's sphere of influence. He would have liked to stay and ponder the reason for the wild crown's shift in temperament. While they weren't far enough from Addax Uzem's Throne for its appearance to be unusual, bonding to an azoth was extremely out of the ordinary. Was it Morphic influence via the Barrens? Anima poisoning from the zokrat fruits? Both? No matter, they would be revisiting the King of Storms before long.

He glides down to Ozendyn. Silky hated that the human's potential legacy had been swept up in his own greater schemes, but he didn't think the clan would hold it against him if they successfully cleansed the Unsouled Barrens.

Silky cleared his throat, briefly wondering what the gesture sounded like when echoed through his aeries, and began to speak. "You wear your grief and resentment more solidly than the leathers protecting your body. Just as you have spent each day struggling to survive these experiences from within, I have not been idle upon my mountaintop. Yours is not the only tragedy, if you'll forgive me, but I do not carry mere platitudes. I aim to cultivate hope and spread it far and wide."

Ozendyn evaluates Silky, his expression flat. The old zusag could only feel pity for the human, robbed of his life by his duty to a dying clan and the ghosts of others. "Let us plan for our assault. Runecraft expires quickly, and I don't think we'll be coming across better reagents soon. I believe it all comes back to the Bonespire..."



Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 5! Rovers can now take one prime upgrade card with them into an encounter.



Note: For more information on leveling up, read page 63 of the rule book.

Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 3.4 - "Malign and Particular Suspension",  50.

Combined to Inculcate

Q 57

True connection. Sharing wavelengths. Synchronized thoughts. Who am I? Your pain is my pain. Our desire is your desire. Your wish is my command. Why can't I remember? You're always there for us. We are more than the sum of our parts. We can't pick sides. What does it all mean?

In The Dank Twilight I Climbed

Q 58

Special Rules



First Floor Complete

You climb the broken stairs and come to a T intersection. To the left reads Arboretum, to the right, Menagerie. You will have to choose your path.

If you picked Arboretum, proceed to page 32-33 of the adversary book, page 21 of the map book, and Q 59 "Arboretum", 31.

If you picked Menagerie, proceed to page 34-35 of the adversary book, page 24 of the map book, and Q 60 "Menagerie", 32.

Place Rovers in spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ally character , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within 1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 5 rounds to complete the next floor.

Arboretum

Q 59

Entry within The Barren Quire from "Mockhorn," Scribe of The Wake.

That we see azoth so frequently these days strikes me as something of a portent. The landscape must be changing. Perhaps the etheric balance is so heavily weighted towards the Major Anima that they can thrive in what should be a hostile environment. If only we had the resources to study the conditions here without the constant threat of death...



Q 59

Your rush to ascend the chambers of the Bonespire is halted by a realm of twisted verdure that mocks the natural order with otherworldly geometry. A massive, writhing azoth twists and undulates in the center of the chamber. Each swing of its boughs challenges your senses.

Time to cut your way through.

Floor Victory Condition



Slay the Hyperborea that guards the way.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a thick bramble space suffer 1.

Codex Links



Q 62

Immediately when the Hyperborea is slain, remove all other enemies from the map. Then complete the round. Then read "Scattered Petals", 33.

Menagerie

🔍 60

Entry within The Barren Quire from “Earlong”, Scribe of The Wake

Are they aware as their bodies undergo transformation? Does ether prompt something inherent to their biology? Or is it something they all hold within themselves and are just waiting for the right materials to call upon?

Do we all have that same template within ourselves? Do starlings represent the baseline, and it is we who are out of alignment?

Immediately as you crest the stairwell, a piercing screech assaults you. A particularly massive rakifa has turned this chamber into something of a personal domain, and is none too pleased with your intrusion. A small throng of kifa immediately flee through holes in the Bonespire into the outside world.

An unlimited food supply, freedom to disperse across the continent, and a disposition tempered by the violence inherent to the Barrens is not a recipe that anybody should be forced to sample.

Floor Victory Condition



Slay the Rakifa that guards the way.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a thick bramble space suffer ⚡ 1.

Codex Links



🔍 61

Immediately when the Rakifa is slain, remove all other enemies from the map. Then complete the round. Then read “Torn Fur”, 📖 32.

Torn Fur

🔍 61

Reward



Rovers gain one “Rakifa’s Garrote” item.

Special Rules



Second Floor Complete

You climb the broken stairs and come to a T intersection. To the left reads Laboratory, to the right, Vault. Pick a path.

If you picked Laboratory, proceed to page 36 of the adversary book, page 22 of the map book, and 🔍 63 “Laboratory”, 📖 33.

If you picked Vault, proceed to page 37 of the adversary book, page 23 of the map book, and 🔍 65 “Vault”, 📖 34.

Place Rovers in 🚩 spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover ❤️, ally character ❤️, ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within 🏹 1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 5 rounds to complete the next floor.

Scattered Petals

Q 62

Reward



Rovers gain one “**Condensed Will**” item.

Special Rules



Second Floor Complete

You climb the broken stairs and come to a T intersection. To the left reads Laboratory, to the right, Vault. Pick a path.

If you picked Laboratory, proceed to page 36 of the adversary book, page 22 of the map book, and Q 63 “**Laboratory**”, 33.

If you picked Vault, proceed to page 37 of the adversary book, page 23 of the map book, and Q 65 “**Vault**”, 34.

Place Rovers in spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ally character , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within 1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 5 rounds to complete the next floor.

Laboratory

Q 63

They knew their life was at risk when crossing the air above the Unsouled Barrens. The tihfur felt it before they saw it—a presence vast and unyielding. It emerged from the shadows of the wastes. A shifting, formless mass of writhing tendrils and membrane, its surface roiling with Morphic haze.

Its many eyes bore into the tihfur's form with a malign curiosity.

“Henzya is lost... but perhaps your essence can serve as a testament,” Bazhar said.

Wailing, spitting, and growling fill the stairwell before you even emerge into the chamber. A strange scene awaits; a powerful-looking tihfur is meditating in the center of a maelstrom of chaos. Monsters chase one another in a circle around their form, thrashing and snapping.



Q 63

The figure's central eye opens and peers at you for a moment. A rasping laugh escapes their mouth. The laughter spilled from their cracked lips, wet and ragged, yet layered with voices that were not entirely their own—a chorus of despair and madness that churned like distant waves, echoed by the broken vessels swirling through the chamber.

Floor Victory Condition



Grab “**Bazhar's Strand**” at space and bring it to space to open the great doors. You don't have to kill the abomination, the Zaghan Nahoot, but slaying it could award you a valuable item.

Terrain



Units that trigger magic traps suffer 3. When a magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of or places an adversary or , respectively.



The hoard tile in space is “**Bazhar's Strand**”. A Rover that enters space picks up the hoard tile. To indicate this, place the hoard tile on your class board. This same Rover must now enter space to open the door and win the encounter.

Codex Links



Q 64

If the Zaghan Nahoot is slain, read “**The Poison Spreads Far**”, 34.

Q 66

When a Rover brings “**Bazhar's Strand**” to space , read “**In the Walls of Henzya**”, 35.

The Poison Spreads Far

64

Reward



Rovers gain one “**Zahgan’s Limb**” item.

Vault

65

*They tickled timid tails, tried tap-dancing too,
tumbling through tall toadstools till the twilight turned blue.
The trio told tall tales beneath a towering tree.
Together they were trouble, so tumultuous, it was true!*

*The triplets were thoroughly tantalized by the tales.
A tower at the heart of the Barrens surely held treasures that none
had tried to thieve.
They would surely earn their ranks by braving such terrifying trails.
There would be no suggestion that the brothers three would strive
to underachieve.*

“In what world does another group of people have the same idea to climb this forsaken tower at the exact same time we do?!” cries a shrill voice as you all pile into the chamber. A zusag with brightly colored ears—ink marking him as a balatronist, an associate that has subverted the expectations of their teachers to the point of belligerence—peeks out from a crumbled pile of brick.

Another zusag at the opposite end of the room—similarly marked to the first—leaps up at the sound of their sibling’s cries. “No, this just makes it all the better! Look at them, they’re Rovers! They’ll surely up the ante on our feat here,” he says, clapping.

A third zusag—a third balatronist—peers out from a large construct in the corner of the room. “You seem to be headed up, and we were frankly wondering how we would head out. I suspect that means you’ve given us a clear shot back down the tower. In that case, let’s make it a friendly competition then! Any of our boxes here you’re free to keep... if you can get to them before we can! LET’S HOP TO IT!” he shouts. After he does, another few zusag appear seemingly out of nowhere, all ready to join in the game they had concocted.



Floor Victory Condition



All Rovers and Ozendyn must occupy an exit space . Try to collect as many hoard tiles as you can before you leave.

Terrain



Units that trigger magic traps suffer 3. When a magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of or places an adversary or , respectively.



Treasure chests in space and are special. Try your best to collect them.

Codex Links



67

If a Rover enters into a space with a hoard tile, remove the tile and read “**Forgotten Treasure**”, 35.

68

If a Rover enters into a space with a treasure chest , remove the tile and read “**Forgotten Treasure A**”, 35.

69

If a Rover enters into a space with a treasure chest , remove the tile and read “**Forgotten Treasure B**”, 35.

70

At the end of the round when all Rovers and Ozendyn occupy exit spaces , read “**In the Vault**”, 35.

In the Walls of Henzya

Q 66

Conclusion

With each creature defeated amidst its halls, the Bonespire quivers and groans. Gargaki, Ozendyn's glowing companion, was more vicious in its post-slaughter monster-consumption here than ever before. Desperation rose in the screams of the broken vessels swirling around the outside of the tower. Only the glowing of Silky's aerios and Gargaki provided any sort of solace from the pulsing waves of incorrigible woe.

The tower itself seemed like a strange monument to a time that had long-passed, so what purpose did maintaining it at all serve? Especially as so little of it seemed connected to the state of the rest of the region. Perhaps not surprisingly, even its architecture seemed mismatched, both inside and out. Whatever the Bonespire had once been, its former glory had been fully bathed in a tide of gore and discontent.

With one last push up the half-rib-half-stairs, your group breaks free of the confines of its walls to an amphitheater upon its peak. At its center stood a massive starling with an amorphous form split between upright and bestial. Its bottom four legs were that of a hooved ungulate, the bulk of its lower half a sheaf of chitin, its upper body somewhat human, but long muscular arms and a coiling tail like that of a rasska. Countless blinking eyes winked in and out of its skin. Bone spines erupted from nearly the entirety of its figure.

It reached one clawed arm forward with a semi-bow.
"Bazhar. Father of Navel. Butcher of Henzya."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 3.5 - "Fathomless Chaos", 52.

Forgotten Treasure

Q 67

Reward



Rovers gain 10 .

Forgotten Treasure

Q 68

Reward



Rovers gain one "Miasma Cope" item.

Forgotten Treasure

Q 69

Reward



Rovers gain one "Coruscant Amblers" item.

In the Vault

Q 70

Conclusion

Eh-heh! Thanks for clearing the way out, Rovers! Don't worry; we won't tell the bards of how pitiful your looting was!" The balatronists jeer, but seem genuinely relieved as they scamper and tumble out of the vault and back down the tower. Shaking his head Ozendyn leads you higher.

With one last push up the half-rib-half-stairs, your group breaks free of the confines of its walls to an amphitheater upon its peak. At its center stands a massive starling with an amorphous form split between upright and bestial. Its bottom four legs are that of a hooved ungulate, the bulk of its lower half a sheaf of chitin, its upper body somewhat human, but long muscular arms and a coiling tail like that of a rasska. Countless blinking eyes wink in and out of its skin. Bone spines erupt from nearly the entirety of its figure.

It reaches one clawed arm forward with a semi-bow.
"Bazhar. Father of Navel. Butcher of Henzya."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 10*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 3.5 - "Fathomless Chaos", 52.

Many Pairs of Legs

71

Bazhar roared, the fury and agony of a century of self-isolation given voice. The ivory claws encircling the peak of the Bonespire undulated wildly. Did they not understand that they were thrashing and flailing inside of him? Every cut a wound in his flesh, every impact a bruise under his skin. Navel was the womb of his children, his siblings, and he would not see these invading pests bring ruin to him.

Bazhar wailed, the guilt and shame of a thousand deaths given voice. The crimson flesh coating the whole of the Bonespire writhed frantically. How could they have let him fester within himself for so long? Each day he re-lived every slaughter, every year he birthed yet more monsters. Navel was a cesspit of vulgarity, and he could only hope his executioners would bring ruin to him.

Special Rules



Bazhar Charger

Bazhar Caller now uses the Bazhar Charger statistic block, recovering its current to maximum. Move the Bazhar Caller ability token to the same ability number on the Bazhar Charger statistic block.

The round limit has been reset. You have 5 rounds to defeat Bazhar Charger.

Spawn one stomaw adjacent to each Rover.

Codex Links



72

Immediately after the turn where Bazhar Charger is defeated, read “Whisperer in the Darkness”, 36.

Whisperer in Darkness

72

It was time for one final journey. Ozendyn appeared especially battered and weary, but he hoped the human could join him. This time he would incorporate his hopeless children and see through their nightmares for himself. Each core of Morph a repository of every fear, every anger, every pain that all of his offspring had produced. Bazhar would take all of this and live the rest of his life as they had—disembodied, frightened, no hope for the future.

Bazhar stilled. Bazhar withdrew two arms, one tail, three torsos, four legs. Bazhar no longer wished to see. Bazhar's tendrils were the chains that bound him to the world. Bazhar's ether was the ash that suffocated his home. Bazhar receded. Bazhar no longer wished to feel. Bazhar was the dying heart of Lalos.

Special Rules



Bazhar Absolute

Bazhar Charger now uses the Bazhar Absolute statistic block, recovering its current to maximum. Move the Bazhar Charger ability token to the same ability number on the Bazhar Absolute statistic block.

Return Bazhar to its starting location. If there are other units occupying Bazhar's starting location, move those units the fewest number of spaces so that they no longer occupy Bazhar's starting location.

The round limit has been reset. You have 5 rounds to defeat Bazhar Absolute.

Special Rules



Ozendyn

Ozendyn has been grievously injured and is out of the fight. Remove Ozendyn from the map, but the encounter is not lost. If Ozendyn did not use the ability found on his “Crucial Sentinel” side, any Rover during their turn may replace one of their ability activations with the ability found on the “Crucial Sentinel” side of Ozendyn's ally card. This special rule can only be used once.

Codex Links



73

Immediately when Bazhar Absolute is slain, read “**One Black Tower**”, 37.

One Black Tower

73

Conclusion

The amorphous coil of tendrils, eyes, flesh and bone expands in shock-gesticulating desperately. As one, every surface in Navel pulses; one heartbeat, two heartbeats. With a final shudder, everything sags, no longer swollen in defiance to a world that wished to see it exterminated.

Bazhar’s flesh sloughed free of his starling core, melting into a pool that bled out across the amphitheater. Unlike any starling core ever recorded, Bazhar’s was both enormous and... wretched. Mottled and pocked across all of its facets, parts of it bubbled as if it were liquid, others torn in a way something solid should not have been able to. The massive core began to vibrate, then in a blur of motion shot itself downward to embed itself within the slowly shrinking Bonespire.

Makaal twists his head back and forth in a panic. “Mo, bag it all now and we can sort the mess later! Ozendyn, it has been an honor to witness your battle alongside the Rovers, but I fear we must escape quickly!”

At last Makaal spots what he was searching for. With practiced ease he collects everyone atop the arkenyn, then turns towards one of the ivory flanges at the edge of the tower. “Hold on!” he shouts, and urges Grandpaw into a charge. As the arkenyn collides with a bone-shaking crash, the ivory breaks free of its connection to the Bonespire and begins to careen toward the ground.

Hanging on for dear life, Grandpaw scrambles along the massive bone and gallops down its length, leaping off at the last moment and landing on the ground with a heavy slam. He lets out a low whine and continues his bounding across the plateau as the full weight of the Bonespire finally begins to collapse upon itself.



Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 25*R and gain one “**Twisted Chargers**” item.

Each Rover gains one prime class trait! Look inside your prime class box and select one of the three traits within, adding it to your class board. This is a permanent choice.

Mark the milestone “**Vanquished the Absolute**” on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



74

Read quest conclusion, “**Creatures in the Walls**”, 37.

Creatures in the Walls

74

Conclusion

The wind carries the fetid stench of meat and decay, freshly dispersed into the air by the collapse of the Bonespire. Ozendyn does not feel the relief he expected. What had he achieved? He had stood against the monsters of the Barrens, had wielded metal and flame against reasonless beasts for years, but for every one felled another rose, each more vile and incomprehensible than the last. Each monster, each nightmare, had only been a reflection of Bazhar’s conscious and unconscious state of growth.

The Wake had never been a large clan. Outcasts, warriors, and few who truly saw the horror for what it could become. Many lost their lives in battle, but still they persisted, until the sudden surge of chaos claimed everyone else. For all of their struggle, all it took was a small party of Rovers to put every bit of it to shame.

“You’re making that face again. I told you before that I simply had a hypothesis, whereas your clan had put all of the pieces together for us,” Silky intones. “Navel is far from safe. Your experience will be necessary



to ensure nothing untoward escapes now that the proverbial harness has been snapped. With the largest threat diminished, I should think you have an excellent opportunity to become a representative of—

“Before you involve me any further in your grand schemes, I ask that you leave me to rest for a time. I’ve had my fill of beings watching me from above,” Ozendyn interrupts. The aerios nods and settles in quietly to watch the last remnant of Henzya be reclaimed.

Deep below, a number of tendrils still squirm noiselessly. Bazhar might have been their progenitor in some fashion, but the ecology of the Barrens had been feeding upon itself for decades. The healing of Navel would take much more time and effort yet.

Campaign Link

Chapter 3 - “A Consequence”,  66.

The Fearless Flight

75

Streak, named by Air-aspected starlings that found themselves regularly harassed on their journeys through the skies, more than lives up to their name. A predatory avian whose entire body has been honed for a singular purpose—building up as much speed as possible and streaking down at, and sometimes through, their prey. Streak lack the endurance for drawn-out conflict and instead rely upon their affinity for Air ether to gain the upper hand in one or two quick exchanges. Entomans (such as the prevalent galeaper) are their preferred targets as both the beak and talon of the streak can fracture their shells with relative ease once they’ve pierced through.

Unusual, then, for these galeaper and streak scattered before you to not be embroiled in a territorial dispute. This isn’t the first time you’ve seen galeaper coordinating with something above or below them on the food chain; perhaps there is a greater force at play?

Perfectly Heartless

76

Transcribed teachings from “Dun,” a Starling scholar.

Urn. A word used to refer to storing the deceased. They used to have many names, but starlings revealed our reverence for these creatures and shared our name for them with the others. This was acknowledged and respected, for it is rare that starlings apply our vision to the world this way.

The corpse of a starling is a crystal. The body of our energy. Energy and memory and identity and legacy. Urns remind us of this. They adapt to the world as we do. They create their bodies from it as we do. They become part of the world as we do. They leave behind crystals when they die as we do.

The difference? They are just energy. There is no identity. There is no legacy. There is no memory. Greed; consuming that which they do not even need to survive.

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that slayed the urn gains one “**Arcana Pigment**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

With A Bitter Look

77

Mo watches as the Rovers draw close to the great wedge of ether. Suddenly, the whinny of a crown echoes from beneath the cliff’s edge. Its hooves clap loudly against the rock as it runs straight up the side of the rock—uncaring of the demands gravity would make of it. The theran easily crests over the cliff with one final leap and crashes into the ground next to the other boulder of ether overlooking the valley.

A peal of thunder shakes the entire cliff and drives the beasts surrounding the ether into a frenzy. The unease Mo had been feeling is sharpened by the commotion. The crown’s eyes widen and its muzzle opens into a soundless shriek; a wave of pure emotion bursts from the ether crystal and pours into every orifice of the crown. Stress, fear, thrill; all bundled inside a massive shell

of Crux ether. Bolts of lightning launch forth from the antlers of the crown, the beast no longer in control of their own body or energies.

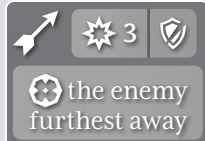
Special Rules

The Screaming Storm

If all Rovers are adjacent to the  ether node cluster, spawn Uzem's Anxiety on the  ether node closest to the Rovers. During the end phase of each round, Uzem's Anxiety performs:



If all Rovers are adjacent to the  ether node cluster, spawn Uzem's Anxiety on the  ether node closest to the Rovers. During the end phase of each round, Uzem's Anxiety performs:



Codex Links



78

Immediately when Uzem's Anxiety is slain, read "A Sunless Garden",  39.

A Sunless Garden

78

Conclusion

Silky gazed upon the darkening sky through his projected vision. The rain and wind were gathering in fervor. Erratic patterns were emerging in the distant flight of the streaks around the addax's shrine. Uzem's condition was clearly growing worse, and he suspected the crown the party just defeated was a contributing factor.

That mass of Crux ether was surely a slice of the addax's power. Conceit was followed by confusion

about how Uzem could manifest power directly over such a massive distance from himself. Conjuring storms was one thing, mostly an application of elemental ether that propagated on its own. Overpowering the energies of an individual entity with one's pure essence in such a manner as just witnessed was... inconceivable. Was it because the crown was Uzem's progeny? The development of a crown to an addax was poorly understood; was this part of that process? Or was it merely an accident?

Too many questions.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 4.2 - "Earth, Food, Raiment",  58.

If Only One Hides It

79

Many of our records of the more esoteric creatures of Lalos come from starlings as they find themselves with experiences in the most varied of environments. A haunt is one such creature. Small, agile therans with a set of dextrous limbs and odd pouches throughout their hide in which they store... well, just about anything they care to. Apparently the creatures have a keen sense for ether and will “haunt” starlings hoping to acquire their potent cores and other treasures.

It's unknown what the therans do with their findings as they're quite adept at escaping observation. Their natural affinity for Crux gives them similar abilities that many young zusag learn to harness—that of creating a natural sort of camouflage. Your best bet for encountering these little miscreants is visiting the sites of destroyed or emigrated clans; they seem fond of the keepsakes left behind. Atop this desolate mycological formation they seem most interested in the gleam of the onisski's mushrooms.

Reward



The Rover that slayed the haunt gains one “**Multifaceted Icon**” item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

With The Grasses Waving

80

As you thrust the spear into the sturdy cap of the fulgurshroom a burst of ether explodes out of the rear of the shaft. After a moment, slow and steady drumbeats can be heard from below. With each beat they grow faster and louder. Soon the fulgurcaps themselves can be felt swaying in rhythm with the noise.

A break in the noise. Then, a body-shaking crash of thunder as the crown, roiling with Uzem's essence, lands atop the great crystal of ether. It glares at each of you, daring you to break its stride. Suddenly, a crack resounds. Not the booming from a storm, but a misstep of the crown bearing Uzem's overwhelming energy. Ignorant of the leg that now sits twisted beneath it, the crown charges forth—each hoofbeat a miniature thunderclap.

First was the wind of the storm; now comes the rumbling thunder.



Special Rules



Uzem's Endurance

Spawn Uzem's Endurance on the earth ether node closest to the nearest Rover.

Codex Links



81

Immediately when Uzem's Endurance is slain, read “**By Each Let This Be Heard**”,  40.

By Each Let This Be Heard

81

Conclusion

Silky does his best to scout around the fulgurcaps as the Rovers finish their bout with the facet of the addax. Despite his initial hypothesis it seems as though the storms briefly abated after the crowns hosting Uzem's energy were defeated. This bolsters his confidence in their current course of action. He is also glad they agreed to this unorthodox route of travel; navigating the valley below seems fraught with far more obstacles and is, somehow, more subject to the effects of the raging storms. Likely something to do with the fulgurcaps being a natural adaptation to Uzem's regular meteorological interference, resulting in them encircling the shrine almost perfectly.

Something else to be thankful for is not having to contend with the human channelers scurrying about the valley. Perhaps the erratic flights of avians surrounding Uzem's Throne were less to do with the storms and more to do with them acting in retaliation for their fellow galeaper-tamer...

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R  and one “**Thundering Hikers**” item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 4.3 - “**Power of Disseminating**”,  60.

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With Many Tears

82

You power your way up and over the torrential waterfall onto the wide node of the bough, aided by the grappling hooks Mo made for each of you. At the center of the node sits both the giant crystal of Water ether, as well as the crown embodying Uzem's aspect. Its fur is damp and matted, almost unrecognizable in comparison to the regal bearing the therans normally hold.

Great streams of fluid pour from its face and antlers, greedily soaked in by the dekaha. The crown staggers and sways, spraying its makeshift tears in a desperate bid to keep you from approaching.

The silvans dotted around the area sway and writhe in motion with the crown. While this progeny of the addax is doomed to its fate one way or another, life will still continue despite the chaos brought about in its wake.

Special Rules



"Seat of Storms" Ascension

Proceed to page 29 of the map book.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 4 rounds to complete the next floor.

Codex Links



83

Immediately when Uzem's Woe is slain, read "The Play Is Badly Cast",  41.

The Play Is Badly Cast

83

Conclusion

With a foul braying, the offspring of Uzem falls to its knees, the power forcibly inhabiting its body casting itself back towards the peak of the shrine. After a few moments Grandpaw clatters his way up to the flat upon which you all rest. He carries Mo and Makaal to the fallen corpse of the crown—this one not completely torn apart by the evacuation of Uzem's power. Mo immediately sets upon the body, wielding a variety of tools.

Silky appears soon after in a flash of wingbeats and cursing. "Good news, bad news, I'll spare you all the choice of which to hear first. The bad news is Uzem's state of unrest is due to Star Hunters sinking their claws into places that they shouldn't. The good news is our path towards the peak of the shrine should be relatively uncontested! And with every turn of fortune is misfortune, for I fear we are not yet finished with these conjurations of the addax."

Victory!



Level Up

Rovers are now level 5! Rovers can now take one prime upgrade card with them into an encounter.



Note: For more information on leveling up, read page 63 of the rule book.

Reward

Rovers gain 15*R  and one "Gallant Crown" item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 4.4 - "Malign and Particular Suspension",  62.

Conclusion

With one last bellow, the crown gripped by the aspect of Uzem bursts into flames, leaving nothing behind but the sounds of rage and a pile of malcontented ash. The Crucial shell holding Uzem's affinity for Fire rushes back down into the heart of the sanctuary, swirling amidst the other three facets you faced prior.

The wildfire is quelled by another surge of rainfall, but the only sound any of you can hear is the braying of the addax under assault by the Star Hunter clan in his sanctum. It's time to descend and put a stop to this chaos—one way or another.

Using leftovers of the silvan reagents collected along the way, Mo refashions your grappling hooks from the climb up into a series of secured ropes that will see you down (as safely as can be hoped) into the inner chamber of the shrine.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 4.5 - "Manifold is Their Kindred",  64.

Never Forgives The Dreamer

Conclusion

With each defeat of a Crucial specter, their form shatters and the residual energy flows back into the slumbering body of Addax Uzem. Every burst of ether restores more life, more color, to Uzem's form. The steadiness of Earth, the ardor of Fire, the impetus of Water, and the excitement of Air. Everything is straining against the invisible currents of power flowing through this shrine. Each of your number prepares themselves for a worst case scenario.

The chamber goes still and your group collects



themselves. Now that all the facets have returned to their natural state within Uzem's body, the great theran—and his domain—seem far calmer than ever before. The King of Storms rises. Shakily at first, but with each leg beneath him, he gains confidence and strength enough to stand with his full bearing. Small arcs of lightning streak between prongs of his antlers, and a slight breeze billows along his mane.

Mo's incoherent shouts pepper their slide along the walls down to the antechamber. Uzem peers up briefly at the starling before turning his gaze back toward your party. They land somewhat clumsily, practically bouncing off of the rope held in their limbs—clearly not used to the same physical feats of a Rover. With an unsteady gait, Mo ambles towards Uzem, tendrils outstretched and drawn towards the great beast. "Fascinating..."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 25*R , and gain one "Uzem's Judgement" item.

Each Rover gains one prime class trait! Look inside your prime class box and select one of the three traits within, adding it to your class board. This is a permanent choice.

Mark the milestone "Rejoined the King of Storms" on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Read quest conclusion, "Uzem Quest Conclusion",  43.

Conclusion

Silky dives as quickly as he can, only now realizing that Mo had quietly slipped down into the shrine. To say he wasn't prepared for what awaited him within would be one of the bigger understatements of his decently-long life. The Rovers are spread out and recuperating from a literal battle against a force of nature. Mo is... communing? The starling's tendrils are almost touching The King of Storms, slowly undulating as both seem to be concentrating. A sudden twitch of movement has Uzem gazing directly at Silky. Not his conjuration, but himself. It was potent enough to remind him of his physical body—a startling lapse in his concentration.

“Even this great beast finds your talents impressive, Silky!” Mo chuckles. “There’s nothing to worry over. With everything that’s happened, something that I failed to learn in my past has been awoken and imparted properly,” they say, waving around the starling core always held in their tendrils. “I struggle to call this creature conscious, as you or my clan might say, but there is surely... intent. He communicates strongly with impressions carried along his ether. I doubt that you want to keep us here to study it further, but I would suggest keeping the thought.”

Silky shakes away his surprise and properly takes in the scene. A wanton spray of elemental power is etched from end to end of the chamber. He is beginning to worry that even his conjuration might not be able to remain safe from harm should battles become more explosive. Loud braying snatches his attention back to The King of Storms. With a wave of crackling antlers, an arc of lightning is sent shooting off. It arcs its way around the chamber and through each of the Rovers in turn. There is no reaction besides their surprise at the burst of energy and shared looks of confusion.

Mo claps and immediately sprints around the chamber, tools wielded in as many limbs as possible as they collect anything that was viable material from what's left after the battle. Something of a makeshift maul is held together loosely with straps of vine and hide. Mo presents it to Uzem, and after holding his gaze for a dangerously long moment, another burst of energy is unleashed into the weapon. “He wanted to thank the beings that fought on his behalf, and I couldn't help but try to see if I could squeeze in my own opportunity.” Mo tilts their

head as they twist their attention to the ether-infused weapon, lost in the process of its refinement.

Campaign Link



Chapter 3 - “A Consequence”, 66.

Unknown Nourishment

Q 87

Bulwauros are a valuable addition to our stables, for sure. Give them something tall to preside over, a steady supply of water, and they'll let you drag them pretty much anywhere! Their shell is practically as hard as a keb's so they'll shrug off a lot of punishment from things trying to attack the livestock in the night.

We find them drifting out of the Thunder Mesa with some frequency. Despite thriving in drier places they seem uncontrollably skittish of the thunderstorms. Likely to do with how the metal in their shells attracts the lightning and their inability to regrow a damaged shell. If you're not trying to rear them, you can just dig a trench and they'll follow any moving water until it stops! They don't tend to pick fights unless it's for the sake of protecting what they consider their source of meals.

Letting Them Devour

Q 88

Sometime shortly after Mo began their travel with Makaal—

"Mo, why is it that we don't just keep an urn for ourselves and harvest the lyst that way?" Makaal asks.

"Because, silly salesmonger, it would consume everything." Mo replies.

"Yes, but isn't that the point? It turns trash into treasure!" Makaal says.

"Makaal, it consumes everything. It cannot be caged, cannot be calmed, cannot be commanded. It will eat its way out of its prison, then eat its prisoner, or worse yet simply eat the hand that it would feed from. Above all, the amount of lyst we could get even if we did successfully tame one is... useless. An entire tree for a grain the size of a speck of sand. No, best not to suffer them to continue eating away at Chorus, fascinating as they are."

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that slayed the urn gains two "**Arcana Pigment**" items. They may equip these items. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Beyond a Certain Point

Q 89

Conclusion

Relentless. That was the only word that accurately described the combatants. Pushed to the brink until their bodies were literally unable to move—each fighter sprawled out where they were defeated as one might view a toy doll with its strings severed. The battle was eerily uncanny as the people and creatures fighting for the "Sovereign" were completely silent. No outbursts of emotion, no attempt at discourse, just unflinching killing intent.

Mo and Makaal quietly banter as they collect the scattered equipment of the soldiers and harvest small bits of the dead beasts. Grandpaw resists coming closer to the mouth of the cavern at first—perhaps with good reason, as when each of you draws close a certain pressure worms its way around your thoughts. Not enough to unbalance you physically, but perhaps enough tension to stop you for a split second were you to allow your vigilance to wane.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 5.2 - "A Cage In Search",  76.

Means of Intoxication

Q 90

Silky and Mo take up a defensive position behind the felled skara and begin to study it, hoping to glean some sort of advantage for the fights ahead. Right away it's obvious that the armor and weapons being used by the clan here are harvested and refined from these massive entoman. Silky offers that while knowledge of these creatures isn't secret, almost no clan other than the one currently trying to kill you has ever concerned themselves with the particulars.

"Ezmen!" he chirps suddenly. "I remember now. This clan was identified as 'Ezmen'—the carapace of these entoman must be the ezmenite they ply."

Mo presses a few tendrils around a small chunk removed from the corpse. "It's... strange. It contains... Morph, but not-Morph? Crux, but not-Crux? It's Anima for sure... It responds well to my own Morphic energy either way. Perhaps this is what's giving the Principles such ready control over other beings?"

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Conclusion

As the last of the controllers and their guards fall, a member of the once-controlled underlings scampers up to you with two limbs raised in surrender. The underling is not accustomed to common speech, but Mo's early life as a clan alchemist means translation of the various signs and vocalizations of the keb rasska languages comes easy. In rushed and exasperated motions, the keb rasska eagerly explains as much as they can, responding to Silky's translated inquiries and Mo's general questioning.

The Ezmen clan is more of a grand army that moves from one subterranean network to another, press ganging any smaller keb rasska clans along their path into service. Fighters serve directly beneath the queens, crafters and alchemists are worked to supply the army, and the entire process is a psychological sieve as the queens identify those who will become the most loyal. Those who are not keb rasska are executed. Those who decline service are executed. Those who try to escape are executed.

Normally each march takes them to a system where they might find the remnants of skara hives. It's apparently rare to encounter a still-living specimen for a variety of reasons. After the queens heard rumors of a living hive in this particular mountain range, the entire clan was immediately mobilized in pursuit of it. That day also marked when the queens began to behave especially erratically. Where before life in the clan could be described as "safe, however difficult," these days it seems only to be "creeping amidst eggshells" before the army finds some reason to grind you under heel.

Victory!**Reward**

Rovers are now level 6! Rovers can now take two upgrade prime cards with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R , plus an additional 10*S , where S equals the number of seks freed from enslavement.

Campaign Link

Encounter 5.3 - "Apathetic, Witless, Fearful",



78.

Kelo wails and grasps at his stomach, the phantom pain of Saras completely wracking his senses. A wound like that—his sister is going to die, surely. He tears his attention from the minds of his entourage and examines Saras. She wears a fierce grin and wraps her tail around his lower body assuringly. He reaches down and squeezes one of her claws in his. Her once powerful limbs now barely hold his grasp.

Time crawls to a stop. Kelo stills his breath, casting his power across his sister's body and probing for every injury. Sovereign Femii taught him how to utilize a body beyond its peak, but this was his sister! HIS SISTER! As his thoughts turn to fury his captive support begins to writhe and hiss—their minds filling with his broadcast emotions.

"Use this body, brother... Always there for support. Always..." Saras's mouth fills with fluid, unable to continue speaking. It's now or never, and Kelo won't let the trust of Saras or Sovereign Femii be lost for nothing. He spreads his senses over her body and begins letting his Morph do the work.

First is obscuring pain. That's simple enough as rasska don't hold on to pain for very long as their bodies recover so quickly. Next is seizing the nervous system. This is far more delicate work—redirecting every single signal in a body to act against its natural course. There are hundreds of reasons for why this is something a mind handles unconsciously. To take control of it himself and function everything consciously... were it not for the ezmenite surrounding them, Kelo is unsure if he could do it. A small part of his thoughts dedicated to his queen become awash in awe. She is able to do this so easily to so many?! Such power Sovereign Femii wields.

The younger brother whispers a small apology to his sister as he wrenches her somatic processes into his own mind. Her last surface thoughts are cloudy, filled with fear and sadness, but his silhouette stands out clearly. She never once stopped thinking about him.

Kelo screeches in rage. How dare these interlopers ruin their lives. This is exactly what Sovereign Femii's great work would put an end to. Kelo would make certain.



Special Rules

Kelo

Saras is dead.

Continue the encounter fighting Kelo using the same standee. Kelo can now be targeted.

Saras still takes turns each round. Perform all of Saras' abilities from the Kelo and Saras standee. You can no longer target Saras as no amount of damage will stop Kelo's control of their body.

Saras gains +2  to all of their attacks."

Codex Links

93

Immediately when Kelo is slain, read "A Grave, Deep and Narrow",  46.

A Grave, Deep and Narrow

93

Conclusion

The powerful morphic controller collapses to the floor in a heap of limbs—his violet carapace now thoroughly fractured and his wounds draining out into the soil of the cave floor. He begins to claw his way towards the rasska who lays sprawled out awkwardly and unmoving—like a toy doll with its strings severed. Without his direct focus on the various creatures under his command they quickly come to their own senses and flee down the network of cavern tunnels.

As he lays a claw atop the dead rasska he turns to face your party. She's capable of it. Changing the world. Fixing it. The keb's thoughts easily pierce your minds as he "speaks" to you and his communication is heavily saturated with feelings of hatred, grief, and remorse. I don't know how the queens discovered it, but the skara are the key to putting a stop to everything. Perhaps Sovereign Femii is better able to handle a new world. All I could do was suffocate the minds of others.

At least I will remain with my sister. I suppose our belongings are yours to claim—corpses can't negotiate. His last missive is tinged with resignation. The severe keb boy folds himself over the rasska woman and breathes his last. Despite his obvious intrusion and sudden departure from your thoughts, your minds are no less burdened after his death. If anything, the pressure

is only building.

Mo tilts their head as they examine the ezmenite crystals surrounding the chamber. "If this material is so effective at allowing Morph in, perhaps it can be used to ward as well..."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R , and one "Serrated Requit" item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 5.4 - "Fearless, Powerful, Surprisng",  80.

No Salvation Should Come

94

Conclusion

For a brief moment, a moment barely long enough to catch your breath in, everything in this darkened recess of Los is still. The tunnels free of subjugated denizens, the walls sturdy and unchallenged by forays, the soldiers' blades poised but motionless. Another moment passes—everything seems to erupt at once.

SUCCESS

TRIUMPH

PRIDE

The walls of the chamber rumble and quake. Silky haphazardly retreats from his perch in a disgraceful flailing of wings. "TAKE COVER, THIS IS NO ILLUSION!" he screams. Each of you scramble to an alcove towards where you entered. Grandpaw disappears into the tunnels entirely, dragging a protesting merchant pair with him.

IT'S HERE I'M HERE IT'S TIME

The thoughts press unbidden against your mind, indiscernible from an inner voice or shouted celebration. In the next moment everything is unadulterated chaos. The back walls of the chamber explode in a shower of boulders and rubble. Mind-bendingly vast claws wrench the rock apart as if it were nothing more than

parchment. Dozens of keb rasska soldiers are crushed, buried, and ripped apart by the gargantuan entity thrashing its way through the rock.

The ezmenite-clad rasska commander stumbles her way over rock and ruin as she reaches a twisted arm up towards the collapsing ceiling. “SISTER, THIS IS—” In a deafening peal of shearing metal and rock, one of the great claws descends upon the rasska woman, obliterating her in an instant.

AMUSEMENT

REVENGE

CONTENT

With the heavy emotional impressions lingering upon your thoughts, the massive crystalline features recede from the chamber. A frozen aperture of massive ezmenite crystals peers back at you as you carefully crawl out from your makeshift shelters. A speck of white chitin rests atop the circle of crystal stalactites—Femii. The entire mountain radiates with the sensation of her emotions.

SATISFACTION

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R , and one “Ezmenite Lance” item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 5.5 - “More Worthless Than Freedom”,  82.

Control Me Without Pause

CONFUSION

ANXIETY

RAGE

Why must every last mote of dust fling itself into my path? **STOP FIGHTING!** You call yourself intelligent beings, and yet every last one of you fails to see the greater whole. Look! Just look! **STOP FIGHTING!** Here we find ourselves leagues above Lalos, all-seeing, all-powerful.

All you have to do is **STOP FIGHTING!** With one great embrace we can bring peace to all!

Wind and clouds are torn by the leviathan's jagged exterior. Your footing grows more precarious as moisture, motion, and misgivings threaten your balance. Silky does his best to stay in formation with you, perching on different vantages as he works to ensure your psychic wardstones remain functional. While the pressure against your minds and bodies remains heavy, the Sovereign is unable to affect you directly. She glares at you from her perch with an expression of pure hatred.

While your focus remains largely on the battle at hand, one can't help but to be at least a little awed by the fantastic sights of Lalos from this high above. Everything can be seen. The northern mountains from where Silky assembled you, the glowing surroundings of Uzem's Throne, the pitch wastes of the Unsouled Barrens, and surprisingly even the floating archipelago of Era has drifted into view.

The Sovereign cannot be allowed to suppress it all under her grip.

Special Rules



Crystal Throne

Proceed to page 63 of the adversary book and page 38 of the map book.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 7 rounds to complete the next area.

Femii controls the Svaraka. There is no chance of victory while she lives. Slay Femii to free the Svaraka of its enthrallment.

Codex Links



At the end of the round where Femii was slain, read “How the Guilty Speak”,  48.

FEAR

You truly seek to condemn Chorus to its fate? **WHY?!** You would follow Chorus to its end? **WHY?!** Everyone of us that lives upon Chorus is bound in fear! **WHY?!**

The Sovereign's hysteria is silenced in an instant under the body-shaking sound of crystal grinding against crystal. A lapse of control, a seizure, an unintentional spasm—whatever the cause, the pure white keb just met her end much the same way her sister did, with a near-thoughtless movement of an immense claw. Her death is felt immediately as the leviathan trembles violently and begins to lose altitude.

It seems you were on a southward flight, as the svaraka is now careening towards the forest which was home to one of your first major trials. Each of you braces as the creature's descent inevitably accelerates, the winds battering around you once more. Having been flung from the creature, Silky's aerios plunges alongside you in a tailspin.

The crash isn't as debilitating as expected. With the leviathan's immense proportions, the fall is cushioned by its jagged shell reaching the trees and soft ground before its actual body—as much as one can claim a veritable mountain can serve as a cushion in a freefall from the skies. Better still is the wave of soil churned by the impact helping to soften your landing as you are catapulted from the creature.

Eventually you are all roused by the sound of grinding rock and wood—along with the worried calls of your glowing minder. “Good, good. Quite the trip! I do believe we now find ourselves somewhere beneath the Taharik. We need to fell the svaraka before it can drag the forest into yet another calamity. No rest for the weary, eh?” he lets out a weary chuckle.

Indeed, even in its damaged state, the simple writhing of the titan sunders trees and is creating an even deeper furrow where you now stand. It seems that the crash also loosed some of the young it was carrying, each capable of destroying great swathes of the surface on their own.



Special Rules



Svaraka

The Svaraka's mind is broken. It will destroy everything in its enraged state. Slay this magnificent creature to preserve the wilds.

Proceed to page 64 of the adversary book and page 39 of the map book.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 7 rounds to complete the next area.

Special Rules



On Advance

Adversaries in this encounter use the On Advance mechanic, which is found on page 47 of the rulebook.

Read Svaraka's abilities carefully. The mighty crystal dragon is terribly strong, but much of the damage it deals can be avoided by careful positioning.

Codex Links



Immediately when Svaraka is slain, read “Disturb Their Balance”,  48.

Disturb their Balance



Conclusion

Piercing squeals emanate from the leviathan, rattling your bodies as easily as the leaves falling from above. Slowly, but surely, the labored motions and sounds coming from the beast reach their crescendo and finally come to a halt altogether. The bubble of quiet is



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Q 97

burst by a rolling howl. Grandpaw!

Silky twirls his way back down into the pit with the merchants in tow. Mo dismounts from the arkenyn and immediately sets about examining and collecting scattered chunks of ezmenite. Makaal simply collapses face-first into the fur on Grandpaw's back and groans a muffled cry of relief. He lifts his head up just enough to speak. "I spend more time worrying about our potential demise than any one man should. After the mountain itself took flight I didn't know if we were going to be able to catch back up! Some of the clan even tried to pin us down, but they gave up the chase after a while. Haven't seen nor heard anything since you crashed back down."

Mo waves a tendril casually, still absorbed in their examination of the svaraka's carapace. "Possible that they're deceased. The ether from the Sovereign was... well, I believe only she could sustain it. With her gone, they'll succumb to psychological break if they haven't already."

Makaal gawks at the starling. Silky simply tilts his head in thought. Mo continues to speak. "Regardless, the corpse is going to seep off its own ether for quite some time. This forest has been subjected to quite the series of events, no?"

Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 7! All Rovers evolve into an apex class.

Rovers gain 30*R  and one "Ezmenite Guard" item.

Mark the milestone "Conquered the Svaraka" on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Q 98

Read quest conclusion, "The Suffering World",  49.

The Suffering World

Q 98

Conclusion

Zeepurah follows the glowing zusag conjuration until it lands overlooking a great chasm at the edge of the woodlands. She rakes a talon through her left wing. It hasn't stopped itching since Hasayon had been pulled from the brink, but out here she can only think of plucking her own feathers in an attempt to calm her hide. While not as potent as when her mate had been violently losing control of himself, something in the air here now leaves her with similar uneasy feelings.

"Forgiveness asked," begins Silky, reminding her with a quick jolt yet again that a zusag had managed to create a speaking puppet from one of their soul-manifestations. The sage speaks at length about their journey through the mountains and how it brought them tumbling back to her forest with quite the audacious show.

Even if this massive creature hadn't been injured in its altercation with the Rovers (what an impressive predator to bring low!), without the keb queen interfering with its natural course of life, it would have only lived a short life after giving birth to its brood. The immense head of the creature has nothing resembling a mouth to consume nutrients with; instead only hosting some of its sensory organs.

After the sage finishes his lecture, Zeepurah turns her attention to the starling that is carrying a chunk of the crystalline material towards her. The avian-manifestation and starling explain that the very skin of the creature is rife with energy that flows between Morph and Crux. Not like the strange azoth tree that bears both energies actively, but something of a dormant energy waiting to be drawn upon. Their words are meant to give her hope for helping along Hasayon's recovery, and perhaps even the Taharik in its entirety.

Zeepurah isn't sure how to thank the zusag and his group of Rovers. She settles on what her clan seems to do best: leave others with a warning.

The Star Hunters are tracking quarry once more.

Campaign Link



Chapter 4 - "A Consequence",  100.

Dipped in Folly

100

Nektari are well-known for being a nuisance when allowed to populate in mass. Their main concerns extend to gathering pollen from silvans and defending their hives from intrusion. Their bodies and hives are tempered by the volatile mixtures of ether they harvest and render into a potent slurry to feed their young. This is also theorized to be the source of their vibrancy and can extend to the smaller flora that benefit from their brooding.

That mixture of ether is dangerous in massive quantities, which is why clans work to keep their populations in check, to allow the ether to harmlessly disperse into the environment at smaller scales. These ebony nektari seem to have somehow collected pure Morph ether rather than the typical eclectic mixture of arcane ether. Morph is inherently chaotic and the mixture wrought from this deviant variety is likely dangerous even in small amounts.

Reward



Reward! Rovers gain 5*R lyst.

The Rover that destroyed the Corrupted Nektari Hive gains one “**Scour Ichor**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Spawn R corrupted nektari swarms within  0-1 of the destroyed hive.

All The Night Tide

101

Conclusion

With a series of groans and ear-splitting cracks, the putrid grovetender collapses into a mound of its own filth. A vile substance seeps from the breaks in its bark, hissing and bubbling as it flows out over the ground and into the soil. Scores of dark nektari burst from its branches, revealing an even more barren and desolate form than previously realized. The smaller dekaha spread throughout the grove immediately wither and shrink in on themselves—they were drawing their nutrients directly from the great silvan.

Mo loiters much longer than usual, their tendrils a wild show of movement as they are completely lost in thought. “Patterns... sharing... application...” and other such



101

terms are given a faint voice by the starling. “If there was a method for redirecting the Morph...” they trail off again. Silky perches on their shoulder as they continue to muse quietly. Makaal and Grandpaw move to usher the starling onward just a bit faster.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R lyst.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.2 - “**Atmosphere of Sorrow**”,  88.

Into The Sepulchre

102

Imposing even in her dying throes, the Yanshif woman refuses to be subdued without one last surprising burst of strength. Her back explodes into a second pair of disfigured wings, her talons separate into heinously curved polydactyl razors, and the feathers along her face fall away in tufts, exposing a twisted visage dripping with Morphic grime. She emits a shrieking keen that leaves you nauseous and dazed. You underestimated this member of the Yanshif—she is much stronger than her kin. The final burst of strength comes at the cost of her remaining life.

The monster attempts to make a dive toward you, completely oblivious to the damage wrought to anything in her way—whether that be the boughs holding the remnants of the village aloft, or her very own limbs. One particularly violent rush results in a partial collision with one of the studier trees, resulting in a leg loudly snapping apart. In an instant she’s sent sprawling, but carries her momentum in a frenzied crawl, relying on the rest of her working limbs. She pulls her entire body along in a blind fury, leading her straight into one of the growing pockets of corrosive Morph. A gurgling shriek is the last thing you hear as her upper torso is eaten away by the particularly destructive collection of ether.

The entire forest falls into a stunned stupor. A few seconds later, roaring erupts through the trees, sending anything even remotely in control of its senses into



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Q 102

a flight for its life. The skies grow dark as everything with wings, including the nektari, scatter into the skies. Small fauna scurry underfoot, desperate to find some escape from the aphotic labyrinth that the Taharik has become.

Tears of slick ichor stream down the tihfur faces. Many of them fall to their knees and scream. Others clutch themselves, tear at the dirt, slash at the trees, sob, and fall to whatever personal form of grief is available to their dilapidated psyche.

Special Rules



Zeepurah Death

Mark the milestone “Zeepurah was slain” on your campaign sheet.

Eulalie

Q 103

Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 6! Rovers can now take two upgrade prime cards with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R

Codex Links



Q 104

If Zeepurah was slain, read “**In Her Tomb**”, 51.

Q 105

If Zeepurah survived the encounter, read, read “**Coveted Her And Me**”, 52.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.3 - “**Like A Shattered Mirror**”, 90.

In Her Tomb

Q 104

Conclusion

Despite the furious inhabitants of this grove being defeated, the forest itself has hardly calmed. The wind, the branches, the ground itself still feels as though it writhes in agony. Distant screeching echoes through the trees, surrounding you in a growing atmosphere of disturbing emotions.

Mo steps forward uneasily and lashes out a few tendrils into the air. “Beyond the trees, something... stirs? The sense is vague but tangible. It almost speaks to me. I can’t say that I am certain, but it’s as if life is struggling against itself. They’re... forlorn.”

Coveted Her And Me

Q 105

Conclusion

After you put to rest the last screeching member of this chaotic exhibition, the frantic woman pulls herself up to gawk at you and the carnage spread throughout the scene. She pants and salivates, working her mouth in various attempts to speak. After a moment of awkward croaking and gagging, she simply shakes her head and launches herself into the shade of the trees beyond the grove, escaping deeper in the forest.

Makaal whispers a quiet command to his companion. Grandpaw slowly lumbers up and presses his snout into the roots of the tree you first saw the woman against, snorting loudly and working to capture her scent for pursuit. Shortly after, the arkenyn rears his head back and bellows out a sneeze, casting a small plume of black spores into the air around the tree. Makaal pulls out a bit of cloth and begins carefully wiping around Grandpaw’s nose and mouth, speaking hushed encouragement.

Mo tilts their head and lashes out a few tendrils against the air. “There’s something further. The ether... *feels*.”

Grains Of Golden Sand

Q 106

It is equal parts surprising and not to see the likes of a haunt amidst the ruins. The small therans are notorious for rooting around in forgotten reaches of clan settlements and stuffing whatever catches their eye into their hidebound pouches. Particularly ravenous ones will even attack starlings to try and harvest their cores—for some reason they don't perceive the rest of the being surrounding it.

"How" they managed to reach the heart of the Taharik isn't so confusing—their affinity for Crux gives them a natural resistance to the effects of the Morph pall surrounding the forest and helps bolster their nascent ability to trick the eyes and ears of would-be predators. Even the broken vessels seem unwilling to pay them attention for longer than a moment.

"Why" they would already know to be here is a lingering question. Worse still is that this one managed to get its hands on a zusag relic—something that should have been well-guarded or otherwise very difficult to both locate and snatch for the furry little annoyance.

Reward



The Rover that slayed the haunt gains one **"Multifaceted Icon"** item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

While I Weep

Q 107

Clattering wood might be a cause for concern were you in less of a hurry. Casting chunks of the dilapidated structure aside, a shockingly pristine artifact is revealed. A wooden sculpture of a Yanshif in majestic, full shift with nary a scratch along its surface. The figure depicted stands with regal bearing, its wings smooth and wrapped snug against its body. Their beak, a long and smooth implement for calling out into the faceless dark. Three wide, gleaming eyes allow for perfect vision in the cover of night. A severe looking crest of smaller feathers emanates from their brow, giving off the appearance of horns.

It churns with a controlled flow of Morph ether. Not the source of the contamination, though a possible tool for controlling it as Mo briefly considered earlier in your foray here.

Reward



Record in your campaign log, "You found a hopeful relic".

How They Creep

Q 108

Your search here reveals nothing useful. The ground is covered in colorless vines and other plant detritus. Much of it is brittle and flakes away at your touch, though some of it is as hard as stone and does not bend under any amount of pressure.

The Major Anima are known to interact strangely with silvan life in general, but this all seems unprecedented.

To The Deep

Q 109

Digging through the soil reveals a partially-buried box; its color and texture extremely timeworn. Cracking the lid reveals a singular massive quill with a sharp tip cushioned in a bed of twine and leather. It radiates with an energy not unlike the distressed emotions circulating through the twisted members of the Yanshif clan.

After seeing the scarified woman before, Makaal recounts how many tihfur clans practiced infusing ether into tattoos for both ceremonial and protective purposes. One of his own tattoos comes from such a "patterning". This quill was likely an implement used in the practice and as such could be valuable.

Reward



Record in your campaign log, "You found an enduring relic".

A Tighter Clasp

Q 110

Nothing to be found in this unsorted refuse... probably. Focusing on the task is made significantly more difficult by the wailing of the broken vessels fluttering throughout the settlement. Occasionally they can even be seen colliding and attempting to wrangle with each other, but whatever they hope to achieve is fruitlessly abandoned after some time and they float away in opposite directions.

Mo's only "advice" for the Rovers is a request to make their demise swift.

Binds Me Still

Q 111

Several scraps of parchment lay scattered close to one another in this pile. Some of the edges fit together, but parts of the scroll are still missing entirely.



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What you can assemble reveals some sort of story. Words written out in some form of the traditional tihfur language along pictures of a tihfur warrior that grows larger each time it appears within the story.

Silky lowers himself to get a better look at the piecemeal ream. “Would that we had more time for me to examine it... Before all of this began, one of the documents I had stumbled upon in the most neglected parts of Tuor’s archives was... something to this effect. An associate took a verbal account from a different tihfur clan far to the north of here. Something about wanting to memorialize a warning about a lack of balance with one’s Haya. I thought it relevant, just not... immediately so. I don’t believe even more scattered pieces of the story are going to help us in the short term—let us move on.”

Of Good And Ill

Your hands grip something far clammier than you expected when sorting through this pile. When you wrest free your finding, you are met with a surprisingly large eyeball staring back. Or, no, not a literal eyeball but something created to appear as one. A round crystal of morph lies suspended in a perfectly polished sphere of amber.

It pulses as you move it to and fro, giving off the illusion of following you in an unblinking gaze. Another relic of the clan that could have some potential in controlling the ambient Morph ether.

Reward



Record in your campaign log, “**You found an admonishing relic**”.

The Stars Never Rise

“GIVE ME YOUR SONG”

With each passing moment she grows more and more monstrous. Her wings shedding rafts of feathers, her talons spiraling around her fingers, the muscles in her body pushing out more and more against her flesh. Whatever is happening, there’s no doubt it must be excruciating.

She looks up at you and tries to gurgel out a few words. “Stop...” is the only intelligible word you can make

out. She eventually turns to limp away, but collapses forward as she reaches the edge of the moat of swirling Morph. Loud hissing and snapping is accompanied by her shrieks. Suddenly she’s cut off as a swarm of broken vessels descend upon her, pushing her fully beneath the effluvial churn.

Moments later, the trees buckle in the wake of a world-shaking roar. More of the broken vessels thrust themselves in and out of the sickly pools of contaminated ether. Miasma streams between the trees and coats the ground of the emptying village.

You can see the Yanshif screaming and sobbing, but the only sound echoing through the forest is an unceasing, elegiac howl.

Special Rules



Zeepurah Death

Mark the milestone “**Zeepurah was slain**” on your campaign sheet.

Can Ever Dissever My Soul

Conclusion

Doing his best to serve as a beacon in the dark, Silky swoops through the village in an effort to guide everyone away from the village. “I can’t say I’m especially familiar with the fashion in which tihfur channel their ether, but what you’ve found looks promising!”

Grandpaw’s heavy galloping can be heard just beyond the moat. As he travels the wider berth around the outside of the village, the rest of you cut through back the way you came to safer grounds. Broken vessels swirl languidly through the canopy of the forest, spasming whenever a tihfur screams, but keeping a healthy distance.

Silky continues leading you on to link back up with the merchants. Grandpaw snorts and swings his saddlebags towards your group, waiting for you to deposit your findings before taking off. Makaal is quietly scanning the forest, squinting fiercely to try and stay vigilant in the gloom. Mo doesn’t seem to notice anything—they are deeply lost in their thoughts.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.4 - “The Pitiless Wave”, 94.

Feel The Bright Eyes

Conclusion

Doing his best to serve as a beacon in the dark, Silky swoops through the village in an effort to guide everyone away from the village. “We’re out of time! Our position here isn’t defensible and we have our less-combative gleaners to protect! Gather what you care to and follow me, follow me!” he cries.

Grandpaw’s heavy galloping can be heard just beyond the moat. As he travels the wider berth around the outside of the village, the rest of you cut through back the way you came to safer grounds. As you turn and look back, a swarm of broken vessels crashes into the remaining tihfur skulking about the edges of the village grounds. They drive their tendrils into the bodies of the monstrous villagers and both entities emit screams of pain and despair during the process.

Silky continues leading you on to link back up with the merchants. Grandpaw lets out a quiet bark and spits out a severed talon; the remnants of a Yanshif that thought to get in the way of a charging arkenyn. Makaal can be heard whispering quiet prayers. Mo is nearly motionless—lost in some thought process.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R , and one “Tifhur Claw” item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.4 - “The Pitiless Wave”, 94.

Dream Within A Dream

Across the waters is the Yanshif woman, still reeling at anything that comes near. She staggers from limb to limb, the weight of her many wings pressing her downward into the muck. She screams and howls at the sky.

“TELL ME IF I’M THE ONLY ONE!

WAKE ME FROM THIS NIGHTMARE!”

Mo snaps to attention as the woman finishes her outcry. “Resonance! I see, I see, I see!” they blurt out suddenly. Silky hops forward and begins battering the starling with questions and jargon. It takes on a surprisingly heated tone, with Mo angrily and simultaneously pointing back towards the village, at the coffer containing the recovered relics, and at the jagged boulders of solidified Morph ether breaching the water as they continue the argument.

After a few minutes of further debate, Silky scoffs but doesn’t immediately work to discredit the starling’s arguments. He lilts from one talon to the other, blissfully free of being subjected to the physical torture even just standing in this marsh is generating. After muttering to himself quietly for either minutes or hours, time has lost meaning in this dreadful place, he slowly turns to Mo and chuckles. “Would that I had a score of more like you to help test the finer points of etheric manipulation. The foundation of your hypothesis is... underdeveloped... I am rather certain it masks an ulterior motive, but if the Rovers think the risk is reasonable, we can try things your way.”

Mo’s posture betrays their satisfaction but the starling turns to face you as if remembering to ask permission. When you give no sign of dissent, they launch into a condensed explanation of their theory. Based on the behavior and sensations coming from the tihfur woman, the clan has likely performed a ritual that “shares” their Morphic affinity between prominent members. Using the implements you discovered in the village, a release of the ether can be triggered into separate receivers—the

large masses of Dim deeper into the marsh are plausible targets.

Victory Condition

Before slaying Zipahudi the Briarbull, place one  dice on each of the drained ether nodes while keeping Zeepurah alive.

Special Rules

Drained Ether Nodes

These drained ether nodes work differently from other ether nodes you have encountered up to this point. When a Rover is within  1 of a Drained Ether node, that Rover can spend 1 movement point to place a  dice from their personal supply on to the node.

Codex Links

 120

Immediately when Zipahudi is slain, if Zeepurah is alive and if  dice have been placed onto each of the drained ether nodes, read “**The Danger Ebbs and Flows**”,  56.

Dissemble no More

 117

Mo strains to track the Rovers as they fight their way through the marsh. Sensing ether throughout the Taharik in its current state has been exceedingly difficult—the Morph hangs like a blinding curtain over virtually everything. Having spent enough time focusing on the differences, a surprising fact becomes apparent as the Rovers unleash another swarm of nektari.

The Morph-addled entoman aren't collecting the ether, they're dispersing it! The Morph accelerates their growth and allows them to spread quickly, discharging their spores and creating an environment that allows them to generate more and more pockets of charged and polluted miasma that leeches into the rest of the environment.

Reward

Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that destroyed the Corrupted Nektari Hive gains one “**Scour Ichor**” item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Then spawn R corrupted nektari swarms within  0-1 of the destroyed hive.

Hope Has Flown Away

 118

“STOP HIM,

NO MORE.”

The monster in front of you is barely recognizable as tihfur at this point. Her form has bloated to grotesque proportions, her face a bleached mess of feather and bone, her talons spiral out from the edges of her phalanges only to curve back and bore through her own limbs in multiple places. A half dozen wings along her back cast a haze of ragged pinions with each flap.

“THIS MUST END,

CLIP OUR WINGS.”

Every blow to the woman is met with a spray of ichor and putrid-smelling fluid. Her body works endlessly to regrow every fracture, laceration, or contusion she suffers. Each time the wound is sealed over with more distorted stretches of flesh and feather. When her body can no longer stitch flesh it begins to protrude naked bone, for lack of anything else to draw upon.

“END HIS DIRGE,

AM I THE WINDER?”

Your foe's movements draw to a weary stillness. Her hulking frame sways in the fetid waters. She tries to take another step towards you, only to find the muscles in her legs have been petrified by her body's unrelenting convalescence. One of her wings has bifurcated completely, seeping an even darker fluid than the brackish waters of the marsh. A final bid of desperation drives her to cleave her own limbs apart with her massive beak. As she severs the branded limbs of her left side the injuries finally overtake her Morphic healing. She topples over with an immense splash of tainted water. The weakening of her pained squawking signals her

eventual demise.

Special Rules

Zeepurah Death

Mark the milestone “**Zeepurah was slain**” on your campaign sheet.

Agony of Desire

Conclusion

“MY LOVE,

LET US SING.”

Piercing shrieks escape the elongating beak of the Yanshif woman. Her form is considerably more monstrous now. Two massive wings envelop a bone-thin frame. Vicious talons extend from her limbs, each the size of her forearms. Eyes wide and rolling about wildly within their sockets, each one streaming with rivulets of foul ichor. Her skin hardens everywhere the substance comes into contact—it petrifies her avian features into a rictus grin.

She launches herself clear across the marsh with a mighty flap of her wings. The putrid fluids of the swamp splash all over her body. A wild cackle escapes her lips as she thrusts her massive talons downward, using the momentum of her launch to let them tear through the trembling blubber of the weakened briarbull and putting it out of its misery on the spot. Her flight takes her further into the swamp, disappearing into the Morphic haze that obscures the region.

For all one would hope that slaying a swollen avatar of putrescence and toxicity would mitigate the foulness of the marsh, if anything the death of the briarbull has just made things even more disgusting. Grandpaw categorically refuses to follow you all across the marsh, leaving Mo to harvest the remnants of the dead broodfather by himself as Makaal does his best to comfort his understandably upset companion.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R  and one “**Thick Briarshawl**” item.

Mark the milestone “**Zeepurah was lost**” on your campaign sheet.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.5 - “**Illimitable Dominion Over All**”,  96.

The Danger Ebbs and Flows

Conclusion

As the blood of the twitching briarbull spills out into the swamp, a wave of Morphic ichor explodes from its stomach, washing out over the marsh. The instant it comes into contact with the Dim nodes on which you transcribed the patterns Mo and Silky devised, the ritual springs to life! Everyone grabs the closest solid object they can as a sudden vortex pulls the entire marsh towards its center.

The first change you notice is that the pall of miasma has lightened considerably. Some amount of peace has cut through the current of filth hanging over the marsh. Said peace is immediately shattered as the Yanshif woman clutches herself and begins to panic. She swings herself around violently before eventually collapsing at the center of the ritual site.

Her shifted features and painful contortions begin to right themselves. The large crystals surge with the dark anima wresting control of her bodily functions. She draws a deep, slow breath, and rises to her feet. The woman's expression is equal parts awe and horror as she examines herself, followed by your party.

She unstrings the bow attached to her tattered outfit and tosses it at you. For several moments she works her jaw as she rediscovers her capacity for speech. “This... temporary. Fly swiftly... kill him. He cannot... be free.” Her broken speech leaves her in fits of sputtering and coughing.



Q 120

In the center of the ritual site she assumes a meditative pose. Her tattoos begin to pulse with energy as she seizes control of some of the ambient ether, drawing more and more of it swirling around and into herself and the crystals she sits between. With enough luck the ether she's gathering will weaken the source, as Mo suggested.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R  and one "Thick Briarshawl" item.

Mark the milestone "Zeepurah was contained" on your campaign sheet.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.5 - "Illimitable Dominion Over All",  96.

They Can Only Shriek

Q 121

Conclusion

The black birds in their sable throng,

Sung dirges where the lost belong.

Their feathers rustled in the fetid breeze,

A mournful wail loosed through gnarled and dead trees.

Uproar grips the marsh. Kifa squeal and begin attacking one another in the sky. Briarwogs groan and start to wade from their brooding pools back into the forest. Grovetenders crash their way through smaller trees without a care to the injuries they suffer to their own bodies. You can hear the screams of the Yanshif clan from within the forest as they call out to the song of their leader.

Mo trembles as they work to separate the hide from the corpse of the briarbull. "I never truly understood. This is what Nu meant. Ether carries emotion no matter what form it takes..." the starling continues musing quietly



Q 120

to herself, likely a distraction to stave off the cloying atmosphere descending upon the region. Makaal quietly tries to calm Grandpaw down, his theran companion clearly fighting every last instinct to literally run for the mountains.

It's time to finish the culling of the Taharik, lest its aberrant beasts spill out across the rest of Lalos.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 10*R , and one "Thick Briarshawl" and one "Zeepurah's Piercer" item.

Campaign Link



Encounter 6.5 - "Illimitable Dominion Over All",  96.

122

123



123

127

Conclusion

Sunlight breaks through the weakening haze surrounding the swamp. Time returns to its usual ebb and flow. Color seeps back into the edges of your vision as the corpse of the behemoth tihfur rattles out its last breath.

“Hasayon, my love... What have you done...” Even at a whisper, you hear the woman’s cries clearly. Muted splashing can be heard as she makes her slow trudge into the waters toward you. Her body looks much less haggard. While she herself looks somewhat gaunt, the rough browns and subtle yellows of her plumage are in full display. A near full recovery from the transformation that she was trapped within.

She finally introduces herself as Zeepurah, one of the two Dominant (and now the one and only) of the Yanshif clan. She asks for you to watch over her as she engages in funerary rites for the abominable tihfur that pulled everything into this mess. He was Hasayon, her mate. Hasayon had endeavored to empower himself enough to become the eternal vanguard of the Taharik without accounting for how it might affect himself, or the rest of the region. Such forward-thinking was apparently a known weakness of his.

Ahma is a legend passed down in some tihfur clans. The circumstances of its appearance are disputed and widely regarded as impossible by the kin; the recipe for such a calamity requires immense amounts of imbalanced ether and control over one’s Haya, the bestial spirit. Hasayon was a talented individual, the Taharik is a region rich in ether, and the binding ritual Zeepurah and her mate had engaged in to share their power as leaders of the clan had given way to a perfect recipe for bringing about the dreaded beast.

The ritual you performed split the binding further between Zeepurah, Hasayon, and the Taharik itself. Zeepurah believes she can use her newly formed connection to the forest to cleanse the taint and bring things back under control. She leaves Silky with a request to return to the forest periodically to ensure the region does not become gripped in chaos ever again.

He agreed easily. “I would be remiss as a farseer to turn a blind eye, believing our work complete. Pests love to multiply beneath unwatched stones, after all.”



Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 7! All Rovers evolve into an apex class.

Rovers gain 30*R and one “Ahma Cowl” item.

Codex Links



127

Read quest conclusion, “A Midnight Dreary”, 60.

A Horror They Outpour

Conclusion

Tendrils fill the sky as the broken vessels cast themselves out of the forest. The fierce, predatory gleam in the monster’s eyes starts to fade, replaced with a hollow and vacant stare. The creature’s wings falter, their heavy flapping becoming weak and erratic. A violent deluge of swamp fluids and gasses wash out one last time as the hulking frame of the tihfur monstrosity collapses forward.

The reaction of the Yanshif scurrying at the edges of the swamp is immediate. Some succumb to sickness, others flee in terror, a few simply stop in place as their eyes gloss over. As the swamp grows quieter, the blanket of miasma seeping to everything begins to slowly, but surely, dissipate, following the trail left by the scattering pseudo-starlings.

Silky’s glistening form is a reprieve from the incessant dank and murk. He takes a few moments to survey the entirety of the swamp from various angles. “I fear to imagine what the outcome of today would have been had we been even one day later in our arrival. I feel I must take some measure of blame; I was aware of a potential threat here in the Taharik, I just didn’t realize it... would spiral so aggressively.”

Your ability to work together to take down greater foes has continued to prove an invaluable boon. The monster

lying broken and battered before you wrought havoc on its home by forcing everything within reach to bend to its will. That arrogance and greed will never serve to protect Chorus.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 7! All Rovers evolve into an apex class.

Rovers gain 30*R  and one “Ahma Cowl” item.

Quest Conclusion



Read quest conclusion, “A Midnight Dreary”,  60.

Evil Is A Consequence Of Good

Conclusion

Blind. Deaf. Senseless. For just a moment, the entire world is nothing but a flowing curtain of pitch. Then the hissing and rattling begin. Faster. Louder. Everything you know is engulfed by a whirlwind of inky black.

You retreat from the battle to discover that an oceanic swarm of nektari have descended upon the swamp. Uncountable myriads of the entoman cover everything that you can see. They flutter and buzz and hiss and bite and sting and slurp and plunge the world into a frenzy of endless consumption.

Broken Vessels stream forth from the dark edges of the forest, involuntarily drawn in by the outrageous concentration of Morph ether. The nascent starling monstrosities throw themselves at the swarms of nektari, only to be swept away in the storm of colorless wings. Their unintelligible screaming can only barely be heard over the fevered buzzing and hissing of the feasting pests.

Suddenly, an odd gushing noise resounds from within the chaos. Then squelching. Plopping. Splattering. The swarm of nektari are literally exploding, one by one, through gorging themselves. Plants, corpses, even some

of the cesspools are desiccated by the ravenous entoman, which then proceed to burst into a moist cloud of Morph ether. It's a gruesome scene to watch play out.

Their numbers dwindle as they continue to overfeed and pop. While the sky and swamp haven't yet taken on their natural hues, the cloying miasma is abating very rapidly. You're just thankful the hysteria is finally over.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 7! All Rovers evolve into an apex class.

Rovers gain 30*R  and one “Ahma Cowl” item.

Codex Links



Read quest conclusion, “A Midnight Dreary”,  60.

A Midnight Dreary

Conclusion

Silky allows his glide to become more of a controlled dive. It has only been a couple of nights since the Rovers contended with the Ahma and were victorious, but time is no longer on their side. The aerios angles itself to descend straight into the valley where his entourage has taken up camp. It is far enough away from the Taharik to be unaffected by the initial spread of Morph and is home to a stream that feeds into the lake further west. In any other situation it would be the perfect place to recuperate over a few more days.

Unfortunately, Silky's descent was less graceful than intended. He crashes headlong into Grandpaw, eliciting a stunned outcry from the arkenyn which rouses the rest of the camp. A bounce and spiral let the conjuration right itself, where he clears his throat loudly. “Apologies! We now find ourselves in a rush. There's movement out of the Thunder Mesa towards the north—it is assuredly the Star Hunter clan.”



Makaal's expression turns stricken, and Mo's tendrils begin to undulate rapidly. The aerios simply nods. "Our paths are bound to cross with us similarly north-bound. This isn't how I expected this part of our journey to develop, but if we don't respond quickly then I fear the worst. We must be off before sunrise!" he exclaims, then launches skyward once more.

The merchant pair exchange looks, turn to regard each of you silently, and begin to pack away the camp without another word.

Campaign Link



Chapter 4 - "A Consequence",  100.



The Thing That Is Hidden

Q 130

Silky regards the haunt with a mix of exasperation and begrudging admiration. To him the creatures are persistent irritants. Small, furry embodiments of mischief that rival even the youngest of associates. Anything that sparkles or shines becomes the object of obsession; the nuisances stop at nothing to make their own. A shame they aren't easy to domesticate—they could make for excellent teaching aids with their innate mastery over using Crux ether to avoid detection.

This one has managed to pilfer a construct matrix from an unknown zusag cache. Silky knows he needs to figure out how a simple theran could outwit so-called masters of the trade, but that is a far less pressing concern to be tackled during a far less stressful future. For now it is more than good enough that the object is back in the clutches of those who would make use of it.

Reward



Reward! The Rover that slayed the haunt gains one **"Multifaceted Icon"** item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

The Poison Of Life

Q 131

The silvans that populate Chorus are a wild and varied assemblage of the hyper-specialized. In most of these cases an adaptation towards a particular blend of ether is at play. More specifically, some aspect of the minor arcana has influenced the development of the flora and helped it find a niche within different environments. The dekaha uses pressurized streams of fluid for both defense and offense, the ashemak uses explosive propulsion to spread its seeds far and wide—one could go on.

What separates the azoth is its affinity for not just one of the major anima (which would already be a highly unusual property to ascribe to a silvan) but both Morph and Crux ether. This combination is unheard of in most life on the planet and lends a particular kind of reverence for the strange silvans. Unfortunately, a result of that combination means that the boughs and fruit it rears take on a kind of half-sentience. Its branches twist and snap in mind-bending displays as it tries to pierce any that draw too close. The zokolat that grow from the azoth behave more like a swarm of aggressive entoman than larger-than-average seed pods (as traditional fruit should)



Q 131

scrambling around the tree and trying to gnaw their way through anything softer than their outer shells.

Rarity and lethality of proximity to the azoth has left many with the opinion that its treasures are not worth the pursuit.

A Dangerous Road

Q 132

Conclusion

In the oppressive gloom of the Unsouled Barrens, the Bonespire stands as a dark sentinel, its malignant aura suffusing the surrounding land with a creeping despair. To gaze upon it is to feel the crushing grip of ancient, and hateful forces—forces that whisper of lost and forbidden history, promising only ruin and madness to those who dare to seek its cursed secrets.

Standing alone against the gloom was Ozendyn, who was potentially moments from being lost to the frenzy before you had arrived. He seems renewed by your appearance and subsequent assistance in his fight. If it wasn't already obvious from the decay spotted on your approach, it's more than obvious now that the Bonespire stirs with activity that is ushering the sudden expansion of the Barrens. While the region is terrifying, its relative isolation within the continent means most were content to simply avoid it entirely, its dangers never reaching beyond its own boundaries.

Ozendyn suggests he has additional fighters—young zusag who had been not-so-subtly trailing him across the wastes—who can help with your investigation of the Barrens and help you find the source of the turmoil at the heart of the Bonespire, but they'll require convincing that until now he had been unable to garner. An elder zusag being followed by his band of Rovers, and merchants besides? Surely an accord could be struck with such a well-loaded die.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 25*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 7.2 - "Flee From The Light", 108.

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Guarantee of Dark Morbidities

Q 133

Nobody is certain when or how the stomaw came to be. Every inch of its bloated, pulsating form is adorned with gnashing teeth and ravenous maws, ever-seeking, ever-hungering. Its birth was not a singular event, but a grotesque process—each mouth sprouting from another, a chain of devouring horrors spawned by the act of consuming flesh. The first whispers of its genesis began with the disappearance of those lost and wandering within the Unsouled Barrens.

As they feed, the Morphic ether they contain reinforces their growth. The mouths multiply, growing and sprawling, an endless cascade of devouring hunger, until it becomes a writhing, slithering mass—no longer a sentient creature, but hunger incarnate. Alive, dead, person, beast, nothing matters but meat to the maw.

A Placid Island Of Ignorance

Q 134

When a nascent starling is found today it is a jubilant affair, but it was once a time for concern and fear. Starlings left on their own, bereft of intelligent guidance, become ineffable reflections of their environments. Beaks, claws, fins, tails, talons, and the ever-present array of tendrils. No two starlings look the same and it's easy to imagine more primitive people laying eyes upon a glowing amalgam of their natural predators and losing all sense of reason.

Ether is the driving force for starlings before they form a consciousness, but there have been arguments that ether is not the true motivator, and instead that the essence of connection is what is truly being sought. Mimicking their surroundings, drifting between locales, and the common appearance of tendrils that reach unbidden to their surroundings—all of it serves said argument.

Tragic, then, that the incorrigible children of the Unsouled Barrens are half-formed reflections of a prison of destitution and despair.

Violation of the Order of Nature

Q 135

Mo was happy to be this far from the fight, but would be happier to be farther still. Regardless, given the concentration of Morph ether within each creature, it wasn't difficult for the starling merchant to track the progress of battle. The pitiful vessels flitting about wailed in desperation and their tendrils flailed in a fog of motion. What was astonishing was watching what happened when these frantic beings collided.

Starlings exist in a state of permanent transience. Energy is gathered and expended, bodies adjusting with each mote of ether, cores solidifying with more and more facets. This allows for a plethora of esoteric events to occur; one of the most notable is when starlings combine. An event that is both rare and poorly understood. How strange, then, to witness these estranged cast-offs manage the process. Not a pure joining, but a tenuous bond created out of their collective desperation for connection. Something to ponder with Silky at a later time, perhaps. Maybe by then Mo wouldn't be so distressed from witnessing the perils of the Unsouled Barrens first-hand.

What Has Sunk May Rise

Q 136

Another surge of ether pours from the Bonespire—this one more potent than the last few. It's enough to grip everyone involved in your fight in a swirl of discomfort and raw torment, even the monsters. All except a lone stomaw gorging itself on a putrid mass of flesh and marrow. Something takes hold within its body and mixes with the ether cast out across the landscape, thrusting it into a sudden transformation. The faint sound of wet tearing permeates from its mound of gristle, followed by an unnerving series of snaps as bones twist unnaturally, lengthening and thickening. The stomaw heaves as though exhaling, and then the transformation begins in earnest.

From the center of the mass, a skeletal form begins to rise—a colossal creature, its protruding bones cracking and reforming with grotesque precision. Its spine elongates, vertebrae snapping into place like the links of some malevolent chain. Ribcages from a dozen corpses merge into a cavernous, distorted thorax, while femurs and other major bones fuse into towering limbs tipped with jagged claws of pure ivory. At the creature's head is a yawning, gaping maw of sharp teeth, dripping with bile.

Its movements are slow at first—stiff, mechanical—but as Morph suffuses its form, the creature becomes more fluid, more aware of its grotesque rebirth. Scour. Mo practically falls over after examining the creature with their senses. “Rovers! I want those bones! I promise the weapon will be worth the trouble!”

Special Rules

Scour

Something terrible in the wastes has awakened. Spawn one Scour at the  icon. Survive.

On Advance

Adversaries in this encounter use the On Advance mechanic, which is found on page 47 of the rulebook.

Codex Links

Q 137

If the Scour is slain, read “Where Did That Come From?”,  64.

Where Did That Come From?

Q 137

A deafening crack rings out as one of the scour’s towering limbs collapses, the bone snapping like brittle twigs beneath an unbearable weight. The creature shrieks, a sound like a thousand voices wailing in unison, as its ribs splinter inward, with shards of ivory protruding from the decayed flesh that had once held them together. Its maw, once dripping with bile and gnashing with hunger, now hangs slack, a grotesque gape of ruin and defeat.

Mo scrambles to slither beneath the scour’s husk, relying on its gargantuan size to shield themselves from the other creatures scattered about. A flurry of rustling, cracking, and hammering echoes from within the pile of bones. “Yes! This is it!” the crafter cries out, overjoyed at the opportunity to work with such rare and esoteric materials nobody else on Lalos would have the chance to.

Reward

Reward! Rovers gain one “Scour Brand” item.

Almost Nobody Dances Sober

Q 138

Conclusion

Ozendyn shudders as his companion animal, Gargaki, cleans the remaining bits of gore from his upper body. He was filled with profound relief that the zusag querists had decided to join them in this particular struggle to help cleave open a route to the Bonespire. It reminds him of his brighter days in The Wake, working alongside his clan to repel the monsters of the Barrens. A grand battle, followed by a night of reverie and learning as they prepared for the next day’s struggle. For a time it seemed like the clan would have eventually succeeded in their goal of containing the monsters to the Bonespire, but... time is rarely so kind.

He hopes whatever they wanted to glean from reviewing the Quire will be satisfactory. Perhaps it would even inspire them to join with his cause in full. Until then, Silky had offered his Rovers for the tasks ahead and Ozendyn would sooner cut off his own limbs than decline such powerful allies.

Victory!

Reward

Rovers gain $10 \times R$ , plus an additional $10 \times Q$ , where Q equals the number of querists that did not flee the fight. If no querists fled the fight, Rovers also gain one “Caucus Thesis” item.

Mark the numbered milestone “Rescued Querists” that corresponds to Q on your campaign sheet.

Campaign Link

Encounter 7.3 - “Practical Consequences”,  110.

The Physiology of Fear

Q 139

The Star Hunter clan was, at one time, just a small scattering of humans separated—or exiled—from their original families. They weren’t known as “Star Hunters” in those days, but the original title has been lost. Their travels led them to take up living in the volcanic reach of the western mountains. A richly fertile

land, but home to such hazardous conditions that it was a wonder a clan could find root at all. It required a well-forged body and razor instinct to eke out a semblance of life. Hazardous conditions tend to mean a source of constant or powerful ether, which leads to eventual visitations by starlings.

Nobody has any idea who the first Star Hunter was. The tradition has been passed down from those descended from the volcanic settlers. While many of the clan view starling cores as a way to bolster their command of ether directly, there is another group within the clan that use the cores to empower their physical strength instead. Those farmers and hunters that toil along the sweltering ridges of their homeland relying on the weapons that serve them best: mud and muscle. The companion animals of those original settlers are fierce predators that both defend their territory and hunt what game can be found. A day's hard work is valued in blood, sweat, and tears.

'Harrow' is a label conjured by starlings to describe the unrelenting stamina of these human predators that pursue their chosen prey.

Inchoate And Rudely Fashioned 140

Conclusion

As the fighting gives way to settling gore, the screaming becomes distant and hollow. Mo shakily rises to their feet and takes slow, ungainly steps towards the dead human hosting the broken vessel cores. They kneel down and let their tendrils reach closer to the exposed chunks of the cores. "The closer we get to the tower, the more... something is happening to the Morph. It's not easy to describe, but I don't think this is going to turn out the way the Star Hunters are hoping it will."

Ozendyn nods and thinks back to how his clan usually handled encounters with the vessels. "The monsters are always drawn to one another. We usually either completely shatter the core or launch them for stomaws to drag back deeper into the Barrens. It never once occurred to us to try and draw ether from them, but perhaps at one point somebody discovered why."

Victory!

Reward

Rovers are now level 8! Rovers can now take one apex upgrade card with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R 

Campaign Link

Encounter 7.4 - "Sleeping Abnormalities",  112.

A Loss Of Identity 141

Conclusion

"ENOUGH," each of the bodies scream in tandem. Far more quickly than they had started their assault, each one crumples to the ground in twisted heaps, limbs splayed in impossible configurations. Sickening cracks sound from each body—some going as far as to emit audible shattering. The stolen cores from the broken vessels are all ruined in a single moment.

Makaal runs a hand over Grandpaw's snout, ensuring the cloth wrapping is secure around the theran's sensitive nose. The merchant does his best to not stare at the carnage, keeping his eyes only on Mo and Ozendyn. Momentary glances betray his senses regardless. The starling produces a small parchment and charred stick and is shakily writing notes as Ozendyn and Silky speak to each other.

One of Mo's tendrils drifts over to Makaal and the starling stops moving entirely for just a moment. A sort of calm washes over their body at the touch—then they turn to join the conversation, motioning toward Grandpaw's saddlebags and mentioning available supplies.

Mo confers with Makaal on what is on hand and what might need scavenging from... the spoils. Ozendyn has a means to empower his weapon with Crux, but requires a series of reagents that are more esoteric than usual. Makaal grins, finally in his element as the always-prepared traveling merchant. He just hopes he is prepared enough.

It's hard to say what one truly needs to travel through the domain of something only imagined in the folktales that form the nightmares of children.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R

Campaign Link



Encounter 7.5 - “Behind Every Masterpiece”,
 114.

Blasphemously Surviving Nightmares 142

Conclusion

Dozens of maws across Bazhar's form are frozen open in livid rictus. His voice, however, is singular for the first time since any of you have heard him speak. “Decay. Entropy. No matter how frequently the pot is stirred, something is always lost. This dream of mine has died a hundred times over, and yet I still found myself clinging to scraps of hope that I might prove my methods.” The tangle of limbs that make up the ancient starling jerk and spasm. One hand reaches toward a face, only to fall away and splatter against the hard material of the Bonespire.

“Star... Hunters? Yes, that tastes right. Some of the more powerful of their number came to this tower. Such... greed. It matched my own, in some ways.” Another limb falls away from the dying mass. Ozendyn grits his teeth loudly. One of the eyes dotting Bazhar's mass rolls in its socket to gaze upon the warrior. “Thank you for performing your duties. I destroyed your family again and again. Your ancestors were some of the only humans to escape my... slaughter. Your new family fell again when the Star Hunters roused me and... fed themselves to Navel.”

More and more of the starling's corpulent body pours away, streaking down his tower as streams of pure Morph to the ground below. What had been channeled to create flesh was quickly returning to its original state. The entirety of the Barrens slows to the faintest hints of movement across the plateau. Bazhar shifts and another large hunk of him melts away. “Apologizing would be... insincere. My body has always worked to repel invaders, after all.”



Another eye rolls to face the stairs descending back into the guts of the spire. “I sense you hiding, young surge. I feel the Morph of your vessel... not fully washed by the thirst for arcana. I will leave you a part of me so that Navel is not forgotten. Perhaps you may even one day deliver my memories to Era.” One final chuckle bubbles its way out of Bazhar. Then the rest of his form finally sloughs away as a river of sludge streaming its way over the lips of the Bonespire.

For the first time in decades, the entirety of the Unsouled Barrens falls deathly quiet.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 30*R , and gain one “**Twisted Chargers**” item.

Each Rover gains one apex class trait! Look inside your apex class box and select one of the three traits within, adding it to your class board. This is a permanent choice.

Mark the milestone “**Vanquished the Progenitor**” on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Read quest conclusion, “**Vestigial Fears and Aversions**”, 66.

Vestigial Fears and Aversions 143



Quest Conclusion

Bazhar's core is much smaller than any would expect of a starling so old and prodigious. Ozendyn braves the churning muck to retrieve it. A solid crystal to the touch, yet it bubbles gently, akin to stew on a low simmer. He lifts it to Gargaki to carry in its small tentacles. Then he turns to descend back through the spire, too lost in his own thoughts to do anything more than avoid the muck slowly trickling down the stairwell.

You follow behind in contemplative silence. Each chamber of the Bonespire is a new portrait of the macabre. Dozens of twisted theran and silvan experiments left to decay in strange rooms, slaughtered Star Hunters



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partially absorbed into walls along the inside of the tower, even some still-twitching bodies of stomaw.

Halfway through your descent, you are briefly deafened by a grotesque crack reverberating through the air. It carries like the splintering of a colossal bone under unimaginable pressure. Ozendyn is the first to react. “The spire! THE SPIRE! WE MUST HURRY!” he shouts, pressing himself against the wall and letting Grandpaw take the lead with the merchant pair secured on their saddles. The scramble to reach the bottom of the tower takes on a new frenzy, resulting in a few slips through the leakage that now seeps from walls rather than just the small stream from above.

Your group spills out into the Unsouled Barrens in a hurried scramble. Bazhar’s tower gives a final immense snap—a sound like the rending of a titanic spine. Its grotesque form buckles inward, segments of flesh and stone shearing apart with wet, visceral popping. A trickle of ichor can still be heard churning through the crumbling ruins, soaking deep into the ground beneath where the Bonespire stood.

Silky’s aerios glides down slowly to inspect the scene, eventually landing on Ozendyn’s shoulder. Ozendyn turns to face the conjuration and a small smile crosses his features. “I feel I owe you a debt,” the human says. With a scoff, the aerios motions a wing at the wreckage of the tower. “Nonsense. If anything, we’ve just provided you with a new sort of headache. I saw the way those young furballs looked up to you. You’ve now got the responsibilities of a new clan leader falling to you, and your first duty will be ensuring nothing escapes these dying lands.”

Before your group strikes northward to pursue the Star Hunter clan, Ozendyn entrusts Mo with the bubbling core harvested from Bazhar. With no more surviving starling members of The Wake, it falls to Mo and Silky to discover its secrets. Now carrying two different starling cores, Mo can’t help but wonder if it is time to finally bring Nu’s core into themselves fully. At least then they would be safe from their future opponents.

Campaign Link



Chapter 5 - “Era Shattered”,  130.

There are many beasts across Lalos that escape the attention of some clans. Streaks are a good example. Fierce, airborne predators that snatch their prey so quickly that you might not even notice when one has attacked! They probably had a few different names when clans were more spread out than they are now. Starlings that fly across the winds alongside them helped us realize we were all talking about the same thing and gave us their own name for them.

Since then, they’ve become a highly desirable companion to rear. Trained for different things but all valued for the same reason: their fearsome speed. Imagine a knife being thrown at you by the strongest fighter you can think of; now imagine it traveled twice as fast and could think for itself. Whether for hunting, carrying messages, or even an extra hand in battle the utility is obvious.

Exhale

Conclusion

The clearing lies in the aftermath of the intense forces of wielded arcana, the air notably still crackling faintly with the residue of charged Air ether. The crown’s lightning-threaded eyes pan over the scene, landing on the jagged remnants of the ether crystals used to siphon its power. The chunks still pulse faintly, holding fragments of the mixed ether the Star Hunters failed to abscond with. Tilting its head downward, the crown aligns its antlers with the shards. A faint crackle erupts, and the shards flare brilliantly, their energy traveling back as erratic tendrils of electricity.

By the time the last shard has surrendered, the crown stands taller, its body more defined, its antlers now festooned with arcs of steady lightning that leap and twirl along invisible currents. It lets out a sound—a sharp, crackling bellow that echoes through the valley below. With a leap that kicks up a powerful gust of wind, the beast leaps away along the fulgurshrooms back towards The Seat of Storms.

Mo tilts their head slightly, letting their tendrils float gently around their body. “While crowns certainly have some measure of power as addax-spawn, this one was deeply unnatural. It felt like looking directly into a stormcloud, not just ether channeled through a living being. Clearly the Star Hunters have found that just as interesting as I do. Let’s not waste time! I sense



another beneath the stalks.”

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 25*R .

Record in your campaign log that, “**The Breath of Uzem Lives**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 8.2 - “**The Desolated Home**”,  120.

It Must Be Wednesday

Conclusion

The woman who had been taunting the empowered crown before looks at you all with nothing but rage and fury spilling across her face. “I’ll kill you I’LL KILL YOU I’LL—” before she can continue her rant, she’s swept away by a subordinate firing themselves across the terrain with powerful bursts of Air. A few other figures also in flight trail behind—other Star Hunters that had been waiting in the wings for a signal to join the fight. Soon after, a bolt of lightning impacts the fallen body of the crown... or more accurately, a pillar of lightning bursts out from the body. Beasts that had floated away from the fight happening across the fulgurcaps are suddenly struck by the branching cracks of the discharged energy. While one or two are unable to contend with the surge of energy and fall to the ground below in a paralyzed heap, many seem newly energized by the ether and retreat with renewed speed granted to them by their boons.

As Grandpaw approaches with Mo and Makaal in tow, the starling slides limply from their perch to inspect the crown. Several of their tendrils fold in around the core they always carry. In an instant, Mo is swinging wildly at the corpse with clenched fists. “How many? How many more will they harvest?!” After a few minutes of venting their frustration, Makaal pulls the starling away. Mo shakes himself free and points down toward the valley. “There’s... another, down below. Please, let’s travel swiftly.”



Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 25*R .

Record in your campaign log that, “**The Breath of Uzem was slain**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 8.2 - “**The Desolated Home**”,  120.

Not Through Ether

Harrow have earned their label from starlings with every bit of prejudice they deserve. Instead of using their stolen ether cores to more effectively bend the elements to their whims, they push all of that raw energy directly into their bodies instead. Human bodies are far from malleable; compared to starlings, one might say “entirely unchanging.” Which makes it all the more disturbing how their bodies grow disfigured as they draw the ether into their physiques, more interested in the raw savagery of brute strength.

With unlimited stamina, humans still find themselves lacking in celerity when compared to the beasts of Laos. Their brutish method of core absorption often emphasizes this particular deficit, so a harrow’s chosen companion often serves as a swifter complement to their prodigious strength.

All of this has led to the Star Hunter clan using them as vanguards for most operations and hunting excursions, letting the harrow revel in their personal strength, but claiming the spoils for the higher ranked members.

Mineral Shell

What ecological purpose does the urn serve? Scavengers are a natural part of any cycle, but urns seem to appear in droves anywhere around the continent and often destabilize the environment more than anything.



Victory!**Reward**

Rovers gain 5*R .

The Rover that slayed the Urn gains one “**Arcana Pigment**” item. They may equip this item. If they don’t have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Rock On**Conclusion**

Staggering forward with an expression of utter disbelief, the harrow who has drawn upon the ether suddenly finds himself unable to balance his disproportionate frame. With a final, rasping exhale, he falls—his immense body striking the ground with a dull, resounding thud. Before any of you can approach, a streak storms through the valley. A muffled popping and tearing is the only sign anything at all happened. Already above the caps of the fulgurshrooms, the avian has the Star Hunter’s entire intact arm gripped in its talons—complete with embedded starling core hosting all of his stolen ether. A beat later, the rest of the clan members scattered throughout this understory realize their objective was still successful and flee with all due haste, some even cheering loudly.

Mo continues looking at the sky in disbelief. In an eerie display, the starling begins collecting their tools from Grandpaw without moving their head at all. Stifled movements carry them towards the fallen crown, where they begin to harvest the body in the otherwise usual fashion you’ve grown accustomed to after your battles, but the starling’s attention never fully leaves the sky, focused almost entirely upon The Seat of Storms. After some time, the crafter’s work is complete, having fashioned equipment from the residual ether of the crown.

“Is this how it’s going to be? Chasing the dying souls left behind?” Mo finally asks. Silky lands atop the starling’s head, causing their tendrils to writhe in surprise. “Focus. I understand how you see your own plight mirrored in these creatures, but we need to ensure Addax Uzem—or

his pursuants—aren’t the cause of a catastrophe. We move forward and reflect later,” he says, motioning towards the great shrine with one wing.

Victory!**Reward**

Rovers gain 20*R , plus one “**Thundering Hikers**” item.

Campaign Link

Encounter 8.3 - “**Excess Of Their Thirst**”,  122.

Hope Floats**Conclusion**

As the stormcaller falls, the crown lets out a deep bellow that brings to mind the sound of a distant, rolling storm. In a blink the creature has launched itself using streams of water, goring clan member after clan member with the force of a raging river. It gallops back to the center of the outcropping and raises its antlers, drawing in the ether from each of the felled Star Hunters as swirling streams of liquid that splash along its antlers.

Once it finishes, it turns to stare at your group, its gleaming eyes boring through you. When it notices Mo, it blasts forth, seemingly intent on collecting every bit of Water ether it can. It takes two of you to halt the wild theran’s charge, but you’re able to do so as Mo stumbles back. After a distressingly still moment, Mo unfurls the tendril that grasps the core they’ve kept close, and holds it before the trembling crown. It sniffs once and instantly seems to lose all interest. It shakes its head once, shedding a large, frozen chunk of its antlers. Then it leaps backwards and turns to stream its way up the outer walls of the shrine along gouts of water.

Mo climbs shakily to a standing position and pulls the extended tendril back to their head. “It’s... there’s nothing there, just ether and intent. His power is far too great and has burned away the mind and body. These crowns were

dead the instant the Star Hunters struck their opening blow..." the starling says.

Makaal sweeps a hand through his hair and turns to look upward. "I hope we have enough rope for this climb."

Victory!

Reward

Rovers are now level 8! Rovers can now take one apex upgrade card with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R , and gain one "Gallant Crown" item.

Record in your campaign log that, "The Tears of Uzem Lives".

Campaign Link

Encounter 8.4 - "The Ancient Glimmer Burn",  124.

Flotsam 151

Conclusion

Before the crown's body can even hit the ground, a massive bolt of lightning bursts out of its body, like a river breaching its banks. The lightning streaks towards The Seat of Storms and the Star Hunters stretch out their limbs to absorb as much of the Air ether as they can. As soon as the stream of electricity passes by them, they flee with a burst of Air sending them skyward.

Mo approaches the fallen aspect as usual, but as they kneel before the corpse their movements slow, a tendrill unconsciously drifting around Nu's core. The crown's body is small and cracked, less like an empty waterskin and more like ground left too long without rain. Mo remarks, "If the Star Hunters gain control of all of Uzem's power, will they leave us like this, too? Merely an ether sponge, squeezed dry..."

Victory!

Reward

Rovers are now level 8! Rovers can now take one apex upgrade card with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R , and gain one "Gallant Crown" item.

Record in your campaign log that, "The Tears of Uzem was slain."

Campaign Link

Encounter 8.4 - "The Ancient Glimmer Burn",  124.

Quenched Rage 152

Conclusion

The Embercaller sees her end coming. In a flash her wicked smile turns to a rictus grimace, but just as she is slain she manages to strike one of the ether node's, cracking it. Her body falls limply onto the stone in death, the starling cores embedded in her torso pressed against it. You see the ether from the cores drift into the node, only for it to immediately leak out of the cracks. The node is ruined, and it will take someone with greater power than even that of your party to free the crown now.

While you all are distracted by the breaking of the node, the remaining Star Hunters quickly siphon what ether they can from the crown before quietly slipping out of the hollow to rejoin their clan.

Silky's aerios soon joins you all in the hollow and quickly assesses the swirling flames caging Uzem's aspect. The construct shakes its head, "There's nothing we can do for now. The cage will slowly lose power on its own, though I suspect that Uzem's discomfort will be reflected in his storms for some time. For now, we absolutely must ensure the Star Hunter clan doesn't continue to make things worse!"

Makaal examines the 'cage' as you prepare to exit

the hollow. “So near to home, I can’t but imagine that The King of Storms will find a way to reclaim this power, so long as he survives. I have faith in you, Rovers, that you will show the Star Hunters the error of their ways.”

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Record in your campaign log that, “**The Rage of Uzem is still sealed**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 8.5 - “Nurse in Wavering Memories”,  126.

Rage Unleashed

Conclusion

With a gasp the Embercaller is defeated, that wicked smile finally slipping from her face. What Star Hunters remain quickly flee, leaving their fallen behind. The crown prances about the hollow triumphantly, ether streaming from the fallen Star Hunters in long wisps forming a cloud around the aspect’s antlers. The crown stands tall, bellowing out its victory call as the ether collapses into its flame-shaped horns. The air suddenly feels lighter, the intense heat rolling off the aspect changes from the air-stealing heat of a wildfire, to the soul-healing warmth of a sunny day.

Sparing you all a bare glance, the crown launches itself out of the hollow to rejoin The King of Storms waiting below. “It’s good, what you did,” Mo comments, waving a tendril at the retreating form. “The aspects are unbalanced on their own, their Crux seeks the whole. This region will fare better the more... symmetrical Uzem is.”

Silky’s aerios appears at the entrance to the hollow. “Indeed! Addax Uzem’s wellbeing will be reflected in the Thunder Mesa for years to come. Your deeds serve a second purpose as well; the aspects are a part of Uzem,

meaning that he experiences what they experience. Hopefully this means that as we approach his shrine he remembers us as friends.”

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Record in your campaign log that, “**The Rage of Uzem was unsealed**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 8.5 - “Nurse in Wavering Memories”,  126.

Smothered Flame

Conclusion

Bruise-colored clouds rush across the sky, lightning dashing down all around you as the storm above whips to a frenzy. The Firecaller finally breathes her last, that wicked grin still stretched across her face in death. The other Star Hunters are clustered around the fallen crown, shouting and whooping in a crazed celebration as they harvest the immense ether contained in the aspect.

Mo looks on, their tendrils unusually still and their mouth agape in horror. Makaal takes their shoulder and guides Mo over to Grandpaw, urging the group to leave, now. “There’s nothing more we can do; save this fight for another day, we have more pressing issues to attend to.”

Grandpaw presses his head against Mo’s side, their tendrils curling through his fur. The comfort seems to break their reverie, “Makaal’s right. The Crux emanating from the crown is steeped in grief, I shudder to think what effect it is having on Uzem.”

The Seat of Storms shakes beneath your feet as the place’s lord demonstrates his rage and pain with an explosion of lightning down in his inner sanctum. Silky’s aerios dives into the hollow with the speed of a streak. “Good work with the Firecaller, Rovers, but I’m afraid rest remains

out of reach for you just yet. We must reach the inner sanctum, post-haste! The King of Storms has awoken and is going to grant us an audience, with consequences for all of Lalos if we are late!”

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Record in your campaign log that, “**Rage of Uzem was slain**”.

Campaign Link



Encounter 8.5 - “Nurse in Wavering Memories”,  126.

Equipoise Regent

Conclusion

All of you gasp as the final ether node harmonizes with The King of Storms. You hadn’t even realized how difficult it was to breathe, the immense pressure of the ether making the Seat of Storms feel like the bottom of the ocean. Yet now, as you watch you can see ether of all kinds flowing between Uzem and the nodes, rapidly equalizing as the loose ether around you concentrates into the great Addax.

The King of Storms slows to a canter, then trot, before calming completely, the ether washing over him and restoring his form. It starts with his majestic antlers, the cracks filling with golden flames before sealing shut, then flows down his mane which suffuses with a cool blue light before settling back to its regal sky-blue color. Air ether streaks down his form cleaning the dirt, blood, and sweat from his coat, the splotches of color quickly knitting back together to that of a perfect, pillowy cloud. At last he stomps his hooves with the rumble of an earthquake, shattering their outermost layer and revealing shiny new keratin beneath.

Before they can stop themselves, Mo steps forward offering a tendril to Uzem. With a snort the Addax presses his snout

to Mo’s tendril. Lightning seems to step from Uzem’s antlers to Mo’s arm before completely surrounding the starling in crackling electricity. In a burst the lightning streaks out to connect to all of you, and feel incredible power flowing through your nerves deep into your bones.

“For once, I’m jealous not to be there in person!” Silky quips through his aerios. “It seems Addax Uzem has given all of you a portion of his immense power.” As Uzem steps away and moves deeper into the inner sanctum, Makaal reaches out for his friend.

“That felt startlingly like when I first developed awareness. Like floating on a great ether ocean, my core lifted by the gentle waves. I felt connected to my siblings; for a second I could have even sworn that Uzem himself has some sort of core...” They trail off, cradling Nu’s core in a pair of tendrils.

Makaal goes to pat Mo on the back, only to stop short, his eyes going wide. He unsheathes the weapon Mo had strapped to their back, lifting it for you to see. The surface seems to swirl with ether, like glass over dancing mists. It has been deeply infused with ether, giving it newfound power to match your own advancement.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 30*R , and gain one “Uzem’s Judgment” item.

Each Rover gains one apex class trait! Look inside your apex class box and select one of the three traits within, adding it to your class board. This is a permanent choice.

Mark the milestone “**Galvanized The King of Storms**” on your campaign sheet.

Codex Links



Read quest conclusion, “The King of Storms”,  73.

Quest Conclusion

Before leaving Makaal asks to revisit the hollow where your first real test as a team took place. Your entrance spooks a small nest of streak which flee past you, cawing their annoyance at being disturbed. It is shocking to see how quickly time seems to have moved on from you not-too-far past battle.

The hollow looks like the Thunder Mesa in miniature, with streams flowing full of rain water, plants and fungi feeding on the final scraps of the galeaper queen's chitin, and fingernail-sized creatures feasting on the latent ether, all derived from Uzem and his storms.

Makaal enters, holding the weapon crafted from the galeaper queen's wing. "Back where it all began, and because of the Star Hunters again! Despite all the hardship this journey has brought, Rovers, I can truly say that I am awed by the progress and knowledge we have gained." He holds the weapon aloft, "How much of my own craft I have needed to learn since this was wrought, to properly outfit such warriors as you!"

Silky chimes in, "I never imagined the Star Hunters would be so bold as to confront Uzem on his throne, and yet here you stand, able to stare down the storm itself! This act alone shall keep your names in the history scrolls for generations to come, Rovers!"

The aerios flies to the entrance of the hollow, "And yet, the threat persists. The Star Hunter clan must be dealt with, root and stem." He laughs at a sudden realization, "I do not believe that first stormcaller and her clan expected the 'storm' to be you, the champions of Uzem!"

Campaign Link

Chapter 5 - "Era Shattered",  130.

Conclusion

With a gasp your foe falls, ether expended and limbs failing. The last of their beasts screech and flee. Before you can even let out the breath you've been holding, you hear it. A faint cry, "Rovers..."

There in huddle beside a mound of fur lies Makaal, one hand pressed to his bloody leg. Grandpaw whimpers piteously, his snout pressed against Makaal's side. You rush over to tend to their wounds as Makaal shakily recounts what happened.

That entire bloody battle was a mere distraction. "A few minutes after you went into battle they appeared." Makaal pauses to cough, his chest wheezing. "Star Hunters, but stealthier than a hintersshade, never heard them coming. They got me in the leg, and Grandpaw in his side, and Mo..." He tears up as he describes Mo's kidnapping.

"I'm sorry Rovers, I won't be able to properly equip you for a while. Especially not without Mo. Grandpaw won't be in fighting shape any time soon, but he's well enough to track. We have to hurry, you know what they do to starlings!"

As the party gets Makaal and Grandpaw cared for and ready to move, one of you goes back to check the battlefield. As expected, a frustrated voice calls out curses in languages you've never heard of from beneath the corpse of a fallen beast. You push it aside and free Silky's embarrassed-looking aerios. He nods to you before you rejoin Grandpaw carefully making his way north after his missing caretaker.

Victory!

Reward

Rovers gain 30*R .

Mo has been taken! The only items available for purchase from your traveling merchant are  items.

Campaign Link

Encounter 9.2 - "The Amber of This Moment",  140.

Cage Master

Q 161

With a careful chop to the neck the harrow sends his opponent to the cold mat on the floor. A few others whoop at his skill as he raises a fist in victory. Thin for a Star Hunter, let alone a harrow, his continued advancement confuses some of the newer recruits, but they can't deny his effectiveness. After basking in success for another few seconds he leans over the courslayer on the ground, only just waking back up. That one, he thinks, the water core in their thigh. In a flash he wrenches the core free, sending an arc of blood through the air. Holding it aloft the room erupts in cheers.

Mo can't help but to cheer as you slay the warden, their tendrils wrapped around the bars of the cage as they eagerly await your rescue. After you free them, they'll have to figure out some counter to the Earth infusion; this can never happen to them again.

Reward



Make a note that the Rover that slew the Warden has the "Cage Key".

Codex Links



Q 162

At the end of the round, if the Rover with the "Cage Key" is within  1 of cage , read "Let's Get You Out of Here",  74.

Let's Get You Out Of Here

Q 162

Conclusion

Half a day's retreat further north Silky directs the group to a hidden divot in the mountainside as a place to rest and regroup. Without the pressing worry of escape everyone also takes a moment to finally welcome Mo back home, especially Grandpaw who is busy giving the starling an olfactory pat-down, in between gentle licks. Makaal embraces his friend for a long while before jokingly reprimanding Mo for missing work.

In the quiet of the night everyone finds a chance to relax around the campfire, if only for a moment. Mo, sitting at the edge of the camp to be beneath the open sky, is



Q 162

holding Nu while looking at the stars. Makaal has been talking to them about being captured, but also about the ups and downs of the entire journey so far. Just before the human heads to bed Mo remarks, "I think, after all this, it's about time I find somewhere for Nu to rest. After everything that's happened, I think I'd rather stay as myself, and let Nu remain who they once were."

The night passes peacefully. In the morning, however, you awake as the world seems to be coming to an end.

Victory!



Reward

Rovers are now level 9! Rovers can now take two upgrade apex cards with them into an encounter.

Rovers gain 15*R .

Mo has been rescued! Your traveling merchant shop is reopened, and all items may be purchased again.

Campaign Link



Encounter 9.3 - "What do the Birds Say",  142.

Trained Killer

Q 163

In the cavern base of the Star Hunters the only natural light filters in through a small hole in the roof, about the length of a person. Even that is blocked currently, as The Eclipse dangles from the ceiling carefully attaching and aligning ether crystals.

"Those thrice-cursed Rovers are getting in the Chief's way," the courslayer captain hisses. "We are to capture one of their companions to draw them away from the Chief's work. Playing to our strengths, yes, but do not think this a simple task; these Rovers are strong, we likely will not all survive. But, we only need buy time for a day or two. Then, it will be too late for them anyway!"

The courslayers call their companions from the shadows and feed them wogberries to strengthen their venom. Time for a new hunt to begin.

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Conclusion

All of the worst thoughts and fears crowd Silky's mind as he considers the implications of the power to rend the sky, in the hands of a single person! And a Star Hunter no less. As a proper authority on the history of Lalos, and of Chorus more broadly, given the number of first-hand accounts scattered throughout his library, Silky is uniquely qualified to definitively state the world has only faced such an all-encompassing danger twice before, and those had resulted in the reshaping of entire continents.

But then, was it not in considering exactly such broad-range, unforeseen disasters that Silky had first envisioned this current project, of bringing Rovers together to similarly expand the scope of their abilities? He had hoped to have years to train and test the group before approaching anything of this scale, but such conflict is now unavoidable. At least the Rovers have also advanced far quicker than Silky had even hoped. As intimidating as the Star Hunter problem has become, it would be foolish to discount the Rovers who stared down Addax Uzem in his seat of power!

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 9.4 - "Feet of Lead, Wings of Tin",  144.

We Better Move Quickly

Conclusion

"Andiron, leave it. We've wasted enough time. Let them stew in their fear, we shall deal with them later," The Eclipse's orders rumble throughout the ruins of the sunken island. Even from the small hollow you've escaped to you can hear the whoops and shouts of the Star Hunters spreading out across the fragment of Era.

Once the clan seems to have passed Mo explains their



plan. "The Eclipse wields an immense amount of ether, yes, but it is not his own. He understands the flow ether from an intellectual perspective, but lacks the instinctual understanding of my kind. There exist on Era a number of objects infused with a great amount of ether using a technique practiced only by masters after decades of learning. We call these objects shards, and I believe they hold a power to enable you to contend with The Eclipse."

Silky's aerios leans forward in interest. "What's the catch?" Mo nods, "I can't be sure until I have one in hand, and we'll need all three I sense on this fallen island for it to work regardless. It isn't perfect, but it's the only plan I can think of to let us meet The Eclipse at his current level."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Campaign Link



Encounter 9.5 - "Requirements of Chaos",  146.

Collected An Echo of the Past

"I sense there's something more to these imbued shards that just their ether, considerable though that sum may be," Silky comments, his aerios peering at the recovered artifact. "There is," Mo responds with a nod. "They were formed using a similar, though modified, process to that which we use in building our archives. As such they contain not only infused ether—"

"—they also contain the knowledge of how to wield said ether?" Silky cuts in. Mo nods, contemplating the shard. It will work, they are now sure of it. Two more shards and they can make it happen. It only makes sense, after all, the Eclipse is using starling techniques as the source of his power, so it is by starling techniques he can be defeated.

Conclusion

As soon as the immediate threat is dealt with, Mo takes the final shard and mounts Grandpaw. You quickly seek out a defensible little crevice in the destroyed fragment and let Mo and Makaal set to work. Watching the pair work is as mesmerizing as ever, with the use of both mundane and ether-infused tools making quick work of the artifacts.

After about half an hour of non-stop work Mo tells the party, "The important work of shaping and maintaining the shards' ether channels is done, but their final shape remains undetermined. As it stands, I can fashion the shards into one of two shapes: an ethereal Catena of almost pure ether, or a stalwart Aegis of true protection. Either will grant you the necessary understanding to manipulate ether at an intrinsic level, like a starling, but you must decide which you would prefer."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 20*R .

Rovers may choose one of two items, the "Ethereal Catena" or the "Ethereal Aegis". These are unique party items. They do not take up an equipment slot and all Rovers benefit from their passive effect.

Campaign Link



Encounter 9.6 - "Something Worth Wishing For",
 156.

The starling cores along Andiron's left flank dim as you successfully begin to poison the lodestone. With a choked yelp the beast crashes down as its legs give out. The Eclipse gracefully sails over Andiron's twin heads and lands in a crouch. He glances back at Andiron's twitching form as his face slowly contorts into a snarl.

"Do not think yourselves accomplished just yet. Andiron is but one tool in my arsenal," he spreads out his arms as ether starts streaming into every one of his stolen cores. **"I have others,"** he continues as the Morph begins to separate from him and streak towards Andiron, **"and I shall soon have Andiron by my side once more, after I have crafted him anew."**

Special Rules



Addiction

You have blown The Eclipse from off the back of Andiron. They are desperate to regain what they have lost.

Remove Eclipse Mounted from the map. Spawn Eclipse, at maximum  and using a normal one hex base, as close to space  as possible.

If an ether node has had its ether dice removed, replace that ether dice. If a unit occupies the space of an inactive ether node, move that unit out of the space, but as close as possible to the now active ether node.

If Eclipse ends their turn within  1 of an active ether node, take the ether dice from that node and place it on their statistic block.

Limitless Rage

Eclipse can not be slain, not yet. If their  is brought to 0, they are not slain and are not removed from the map. There must be a way to defeat them. Keep fighting and look for an opportunity to win.

Codex Links



169

At the end of the round, if the eclipse is at 10*R  or less, read "Loyal to the End",

 77.

"Get down!" Silky's aerios cries out across the battlefield. You drop to the ground almost too late as a howling Andiron lunges back into action, dual heads snapping right where your neck was just a moment ago. The beastly companion being back in the fight exacerbates just how hopeless the situation feels. No matter the attack, no matter the strategy, The Eclipse never even seems effected, as though the damage never actually reaches him.

"Take heart, Rovers!" Silky reassures, anticipating your thoughts. "He would not concern himself with us if he were truly invulnerable!"

The Eclipse's laugh rumbles through the air. **"By all means, neutralize all the ether you like, I have plenty to spare!"** Despite his haughty self-certainty you can't help but notice that Andiron still favors his left side, that a few of his own embedded cores have gone dim, that seat is beading on his face. The plan is working, however slowly.

You've faced down the enduring emblem of the Storm itself, a seemingly immortal aspect of the world! Compared to that, despite the intimidating appearance, an Eclipse is but a passing dark moment, nothing that Rovers of your caliber can't handle.

Special Rules

Revenge

Andiron has recovered and is back in the fight. Spawn Andiron, at maximum ♥ and using the large base adapter, as close to space B as possible.

Addiction

Eclipse still follows the rules for addiction, grabbing ether dice from ether nodes around the map.

Limitless Rage

Eclipse and Andiron can not be slain, not yet. If either of their ♥ is brought to 0, they are not slain and are not removed from the map. There must be a way to defeat both of them. Keep fighting and look for an opportunity to win.

Codex Links

170

At the end of the round, if both Eclipse and Andiron individually are at R or less ♥, read **"Take the Ether"**, 77.

Take The Ether

170

The Eclipse's skin radiates with swirls of color as his captured ether threatens to rend his very flesh. His eyes dart from threat to threat, sweat dripping from his face. He looks to Andiron, panting with both heads hanging low, and his breath calms as he draws upon his last cache of energy.

"You have exhausted my mercy, whelps! Chorus cries out for help and here you are, leaning on one another just to stand up! You think you can end this strife, this suffering? It was people like you that let things fall this far! I pulled down the sky itself, I hold power no one else can even comprehend! I alone have the strength to set the world to right!"

He reaches both hands to the lodestone and pulls towards himself. Light shoots out the stone as the crack propagates along its many faces, fracturing smaller and smaller as ever wisp of ether is rapidly sucked out and absorbed by the vibrating core shards of The Eclipse.

You've never felt this pressure, this vacuum of missing ether before. There's none left anywhere nearby. It's terrifying, until suddenly the thought clicks in your mind. There's no more, anywhere nearby! The Eclipse has no further reserves, no more outside strength to rely upon. Once you neutralize the ether contained in his body he will be left with only his own weak faculties.

Special Rules

Eclipse

Eclipse realizes their power is fading and is growing desperate. They leap back onto Andiron. This is your chance, the shards of ether in their body are radiating extraordinary power. If you can take them, Eclipse should be weak enough to be defeated.

Remove Eclipse and Andiron from the map. Spawn Eclipse Ether Ascended, at maximum ♥ and using the large base adapter, as close to space ☞ as you can. Place ether dice onto the statistic block of Eclipse Ether Ascended until there is one of each ether type 🔥, 💧, 🌱, 🌀, 🏠, and 🌀.

Once each round, one Rover may perform the following ability:

Take Ether

If you are within ↗ 1 of Eclipse (Ether Ascended), take one ether dice of your choice from their statistic block and add it to your personal pool.

Note: Take Ether is an ability and requires an ability activation to use.

Remove all ether dice from Eclipse Ether Ascended and reduce their hit points to 0 to slay them.

Codex Links

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At the end of the round, if The Eclipse Ether Ascended is at 0 ♥ and has no ether dice on their statistic block, read “Eclipsed”, 📖 78.

Eclipsed

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The echoes fade from The Eclipse's voice as he speaks, slowly shrinking back to that of a single human. **“I can't believe it. By you! You who seem the most vulnerable.”** His breaths come shallow and fast. “I see how you require each other, how you hurt when your companions do. How? How does it not drag you down, deplete you? No...” he trails off and looks over at Andiron's still form. “No, perhaps it was me. I was vulnerable, even at the end. Can it not be, then? Can no one stand tall enough, gather enough strength, to live, assured of their own peace? Why could I not protect them?”

His head lolls over and his eyes land on Makaal, Grandpaw, and Mo approaching now that the fighting is over. His voice falls to a whisper, “And yet you could.” He looks down at his body, at the shattered and dim cores embedded therein. His tears fall onto the cold stone beneath as draws one last raspy gasp before growing still.

Suddenly, the sky darkens almost to night. A second passes, less, a heartbeat, and then it brightens again. Era, drifting overhead, had passed in front of the sun for a moment.

Mo holds Nu's core aloft, aligned perfectly with the island flying away towards the horizon. “Be at peace, my sibling, my friend. I'm sorry you couldn't be here to witness it, but our people have one less worry in the world.” Makaal wraps an arm around their shoulders, pulling them into a tight hug as Grandpaw nudges his wide head against their chest.

Silky's aerios flutters down in front of you all, unusually solemn as it considers each of you in turn. “I can say, with the utmost honesty and sincerity Rovers, that you have met and exceeded even my wildest expectations— no, my wildest hopes for the success of our little experiment. I've never encountered another Rover, either in my own travels nor even in my extensive little library, who could even approach the accomplishments you all have wrought.”

The aerios spread its wings and approaches, awkwardly wrapping its limbs around each of you in a rough approximation of a hug. “I have one final request of you all: when you return to your clans and homes, make sure to spread the knowledge of all that you have learned these past weeks. We stand at the precipice of a new age, Rovers, and you must ensure that the next generation of



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adventurers to follow you knows what is possible; that they can find friends and compatriots among the Rovers of other clans. You can't see it through the construct, but I'm shivering in excitement thinking of the future you've just won for us all!"

Victory!



Reward

Congratulations, you have won! The campaign is over.

Remove the party items "**Ethereal Catena**" and "**Ethereal Aegis**". Their power is spent and can no longer be used.

Campaign Conclusion



Read campaign conclusion, "**A New Age Dawns**",



79.

A New Age Dawns

173

A letter from "Silky," Fundamentalist of the Mist clan to the clan leaders of Lalos.

Dear Friends,

I trust you have received my previous missives detailing the unparalleled journey and successes of the group of Apex Rovers, now known as the Defenders of the Yanshif, the Liberators of the Ezmen, the Champions of Uzem, the Cleansers of the Unsouled Barrens, etc., etc. Further, I trust that you have not discarded them out of hand as the ramblings of a mad Zusag and have actually read them and taken the time to consider their contents.

While I would like to believe my earlier writings to be so persuasive and self-validating that you have already been convinced of my views, I will instead reiterate a point that some may have missed or ignored: the techniques of which I speak, specifically of cultivating a new modus operandi of cooperation between Rovers, have not only proven exceedingly successful at addressing challenges which would ordinarily be far beyond our ability to meet, but that in adopting them and the mindset which they accompany all of these monumental, continent-threatening catastrophes could have been prevented in the first place.



In a wide clearing, under the sun, in the Tolkhin:

“Keenah, my heart, why are you weeding the seedlings alone?”

“If I am to be the Dominant, mother, I must have the strength to work great acts of the clan!”

With a sigh and slight shake of her head, the cervine Tihfur addresses her daughter, “The Dominant’s job is not to live life for the clan, but to help the clan lead a good life from within. Do not forget, the Dominant sets an example for the clan as well! What would you say if your younger brothers determined to retrieve ice from the mountains alone?”

The young doeling laughs, “I would say they are far too young for such a journey and it would be foolish for them to even attempt so alone!”

With an impish, knowing smile the mother responds, “And yet you seek to mind the entire field yourself, knowing full well you have an entire herd of friends and siblings who could help?”

Keenah abashedly looks at the ground. Her mother puts an arm around her and leads her back to their home. “I’m not trying to reprimand you, heart, but do not think it weakness to ask for help when it is needed; that sort of thinking leads to an unbalanced Haya. Think of it as an opportunity to grow closer to your friends; besides, most people actually enjoy helping! It makes them feel useful.”

In a rocky crevice, in the shadows in Kifkyos:

“I told you couldn’t do it! You need to faster!” a young Keb Rasska screeches as they run from their friends to the chaperone of their Sekya game. Embarrassment, Shame, Frustration echo from the keb. The child chitters at the chaperone, “Can we be on other team? Other team faster...” The chaperone keb and rasska look at each other and shake their heads.

Reassurance, Sympathy, Authority radiate from the chaperone keb. “Do you like other team?” the ask. The rasska child shakes her head. “Do you like friends? Friends on team?” Friendship, Fun, responds the keb girl. “Then play with friends! Teach friends faster, have fun, worry less!” The rasska chaperone guides the pair back to the playing area while the keb intones Understanding, Growth, Contentment.

After the frustrated children apologize to their friends, the chaperone tosses the grub back into play, watching to see if they actually participate this time. In the first match the children were so busy looking for opportunities to criticize they completely failed to help their team play. Satisfied the children actually trying this match, the chaperones return to their internal conversation about the recent earthquakes nearby.

Far to the west, in a small wooden hovel on a hill:

In a shower of splinters the young casteling raises their tendrils and directs the small cloud of ether into a caged bird. The bird's wings start to beat against the cage as it caws louder and louder, eventually attracting the young starling's guardian.

The older castor Zusag enters the room, sees the broken timepiece on the floor and scrambles to gather the pieces with a screech. "No, no, Klo, why did you do this?!" The casteling looks confused at the Zusag's strong reaction.

"It was infused with Air, but it wasn't using it. Ikki has trouble flying with her wing, so I thought the Air would help her." The Zusag groans before flipping over a large chunk of the decorative cap of the timepiece and letting out a relieved sigh.

"Oh, stars above, thank goodness the core is intact! Klo! This timepiece was the resting place for my partner Uhr. When they reached the end of their life they asked for their core to be fashioned into a timepiece. Partly to poke fun at my tendency to be late, and partly for their resting place to be something practical, but that's besides the point."

The Zusag gently holds the core in front of the starling and places one of the child's hands on the faceted surface. "Klo, this wasn't infused as a timepiece, it was infused with the last of Uhr's ether as a memento. I know you were trying to help Ikki, and I appreciate the thought, but just because something is there doesn't mean that it's there for you, understand?" The child nods, suitably chagrined. "You have to remember that sometimes when you break something, you can't put it back together. Come talk to me when you have an idea like that and I'll talk it through with you, okay? We can make a plan together."



Deep in the desert, in the shadow of a dune:

"What a strike, Melyn! I never thought we'd get an Armoroll all by ourselves!" A short, cheery human calls to his brother, offering his hands for a celebratory clap that, sadly, doesn't come. Azjer drops his hands with a "Tsk!" His brother is staring at the Armoroll's body, stroking the few thin hairs on his chin (as he has started to do ever since they first came in).

"Azjer, what do you think we could get for it if we brought it to the market?" he finally asks, dropping his hand.

The younger brother looks shocked. "I don't know, more than we've ever seen in one place probably. But, Melyn, what a boon it would be for the clan!"

The older brother nods, sizing up the armored plates with his hand. "Sure, but some lyst in our pockets would also serve the clan well. With some new weapons and tools for ourselves, we'd be able to catch bigger prey like this more often."

Azjer reluctantly grunts in understanding before adding, "Sure, but don't you think the clan should at least get a say? The meat alone could feed us for weeks; besides, we don't even know enough to tell whether gear is any good or not!"

Melyn groans, but admits defeat. "Fine, you're right. The plating can probably already be made into some armor for us, and the meat should help get some of the others back into fighting shape. At least, I really hope so, because I don't know if you and I could deal with those wrathbones in the canyon on our own, even with the priciest weapons at the bazaar."



Let it not slip from your minds that there are still plenty of threats across Lalos that could quite quickly grow to match the challenge of those my Rovers have only just finished managing. All I ask is that you consider it. If you need a demonstration, the victorious Apex are still hard at work and I do not doubt they provide near miraculous proof of these strategies almost daily!

As always, I remain at your service. If you have any questions, please respond to my letter poste-haste and I shall endeavor to address you directly (through an ether construct).

In peace,

Silky, Mist-clan Fundamentalist



Mo stands before a wrist-thick sapling growing on a windswept hill. Far in the distance, though easily visible to the naked “eye” lies the, only somewhat, shrunken Unsouled Barrens. This land speaks to the starling though, as the retreat of the foul corruption of the Barrens has still left this border area strangely empty as the surrounding silvans, therans, entomans, and just about everything else still seems cautious about extending back into that once-claimed clay.

Everything except this tree, which has boldly claimed this bald hilltop and declared its intentions to make it a home. Ever so gently, Mo places an object right in the cleft of the tree’s first two branches. With careful movements, and a bit of ether coaching, the starling uses the tree’s own twigs to secure the object in place, ensuring that it catches the sunlight just so.

After a moment, they step back to examine their work. Nu’s core shatters the sunlight into a thousand-thousand colored rays, looking like some sort of mythical fruit grown by this fledgling tree. Satisfied that Nu is sufficiently settled in this peaceful place of new beginnings, Mo spares a final still moment for their sibling before turning to rejoin Makaal and Grandpaw slowly making their way south to explore the southern deserts.

The rays cast by Nu’s core dapple the ground even as it starts to shiver, then shake, then rumble as far in the distance a fissure begins to split the profane ground of the Unsouled Barrens. But Mo chose well, and Nu and their little sapling will stand unbothered on their little hilltop as Silky’s new age of Lalos faces its first new challenge.



Zydero Reef

Q 175

Mo had tried to warn you all to watch your footing on the reef's famous ferrorsands, but nothing could have prepared you to feel your feet being moved out from under you. According to Mo, local beliefs state that the magnetic "currents" of the sands mimic those of the waters in the lagoon nearby. Perhaps, then, the sand pulling you towards the jagged exposed coral nearby mimics the current that beached and stranded the abandoned ship on the shore before you.

The ship's exterior looks almost new, excusing the few gaping holes gouged out by the metallic corals of the reef. Makaal's curiosity gets the better of him (again) and he pokes his head in through the largest opening. Just as quickly he withdraws, falling in the tugging sands in his haste to return to you. "It's like a piece of the Unsouled Barrens in there! Blood and flesh strung across the walls!"

You cautiously approach to investigate. Indeed, looking inside the walls are festooned with semi-dismembered dyads, their flesh pale and beginning to rot. But this was not done as some unusual hunting tactic; some of them bare stitching as though someone attempted to sew them back closed, or in some cases together. You can only guess the bloody lower half of a torso must have once belonged to the deranged butcher.

As you turn to leave a damaged board snaps beneath your feet, the crunch of wood reverberating through the ship. The immediate cries, screams, and roars encourage your swift exit and egress down the beach. The ferrorsands impede your movement, and before you can get out of sight a wretched unholy abomination emerges from the ship, flanked by a cadre of dyads covered in scars and stitches.

The hydra before you hisses at the sunlight before focusing its many, many eyes upon you. Perhaps a dozen dyads all haphazardly assembled together, the many mouths gnashing and drooling as they all struggle to snap closed around your flesh. A small herd of scavenger bulwauros emerge behind it and quickly spread out across the sands. There's nothing for it, you'll have to fight your way out of this.

Mineral Shell

Q 176

Western urns don't technically have shells, though the crystalline growths upon their backs are often mistaken for them. A minor distinction which only matters to alchemists and the western starling clans who collect them to make into the finest prismatic dyes. After several rounds of burning, boiling, crushing, and ether filtering the crystalline substance turns to a fine powder used to color bolts of cloth a vibrant, shimmering wine-red. While garments of such cloth are prohibitively expensive, they also shine brighter, and more beautifully than the best-made sequins or finest-cut gems.

Reward



Rovers gain 5*R . The Rover that slayed the urn gains one "Arcana Pigment" item. They may equip this item. If they don't have the required item slot(s) available, they may unequip items as needed.

Gathering Sands

Q 177

Conclusion

Blessedly, your efforts finally put a merciful end to the hydra's strained screeches and cries. The other creatures of the beach flee, finally deciding that making a meal of you requires too much effort. As you rest to clean your equipment and recover your stamina Mo wanders over to a patch of the ferrorsands where you had been fighting. They retrieve a small sieve from atop Grandpaw and begin to sift the magnetic sands, saving only the finest grains in a small bottle.

After a few hours of recovery for the party and manual labor for Mo and Makaal, the two return with a flask full of glittering sand. Some of the rejected grains stick to the side of bottle in strange arcing spikes. "With this," Mo says, swirling the bottle to show the outer spikes shifting and reforming, "I believe we can make quite the unique piece of armor for you Rovers. I wasn't expecting such a fight, and for that I do apologize, but thank you, friends; it has been too long since I last smelled the salt of the sea mixed with the unique tinge of Zyderos reef."



Q 177

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain one “Zyderos Cuirass” item.

Campaign Link



Return to Chapter 2 - “A Choice”,  39, skipping directly to campaign link.

The Arena

Q 178

The small stone chamber is unassuming in its lack of adornment, excluding the thick, plush carpets covering the floor. The Keb Rasska Thought Caser leads you all to the center of the room and helps you to lie down and get comfortable. You feel strangely naked, going into battle without any armor or weapons. The Thought Caser insisted all weapons be left outside, just in case your bodies manage to move while you dream.

A thin, heavily infused string is wrapped around part of each of you, tying you all to the Keb Rasska sitting in the very center of the room. An attendant lights a cloying incense that quickly fills the room and before you can even realize it you find yourself asleep.

Another unsettling feeling, finding one’s self asleep, as your consciousness, so to speak, never wavered for even a moment. In an instant the gray subterranean chamber became an arena of immense proportions. Each pillar, among dozens, holding aloft the skybound roof seems a small mountain. Or perhaps there isn’t even a true roof all the way up there, as the space seems filled with a pale yellow morning light.

A mezzanine floats not far overhead, the oneiric crowd cheering as your names appear written across a hill-sized tournament board. A phalanx of trumpets sounds as the thin mists drifting along the floor start to coalesce into your first wave of opponents.

One Down, Two To Go

Q 179

The imaginary crowd goes wild as you secure your first victory. Petals from exotic flowers and color-changing confetti rain down as the tournament board is quickly rewritten to display your advancement. From the central observation booth steps a towering keb rasska, the Thought Caser creating the illusion for you, though they seem at least three times as large as in reality.

The Thought Caser spreads their arms as the keb transmits a feeling of exultation. An unusual quirk, perhaps benefit, of the dream space is that all of you get the full experience of Keb Rasska thought communication, though your physical forms might lack the necessary organs for such experiences normally. Regardless, you aren’t given long to revel in victory before the god-rays filtering from the sky suddenly shift to transmit the bright white light of midday, and the mists once again form into vortices. It seems wave two is to begin immediately.

Reward



Rovers gain 10*R .

Special Rules



More To Go

Congratulations, you’ve defeated the first wave of adversaries! Follow the rules of Mind Palace (determine the next wave the same way you did the first wave) and spawn the next wave of enemies.

The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete this wave.

Two Down, One To Go

180

Were your ears physically present they would be set ringing by the raucous cheering of the crowd as you secure your second, and penultimate victory. Whole flowers, their shapes quite impossible in a physical realm, soon blanket the arena's floor.

Each of you seems to meet the eye of a particular attendee who tosses you a small favor for you to adorn for the final round. Probably as a result of the Thought Caser's talent you can each feel the admiration, and desire, of your chosen supporter. The resulting full-body flush you experience must also be a result of the dream's manipulation, surely. You could never be so easily manipulated by a dream... right?

Your speculation is cut short by the light shifting to a rich brown reminiscent of the most picturesque sunset. This time the mists seem to roil into clouds, the watching crowd quieting in anticipation. Your final challenge approaches; but the Thought Caser adjudicator wordlessly assures you that you should view this as an opportunity to truly display your mettle and ability, as an opportunity for glory, without the dirt and grime of real combat.

Reward



Rovers gain 20*R .

Special Rules



More To Go

Congratulations, you've defeated the second wave of adversaries! Follow the rules of Mind Palace (determine the next wave the same way you did the first wave) and spawn the next wave of enemies.

The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete this wave.

Victory!

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The final foe takes a suitably dramatic moment to fall to the ground, with an out-sized thud. The hazy reaches of the arena shift into night, stars unobstructed except for sudden flashes of light and color. A cacophony of cheers, shouts, and thundering applause rings out from the crowd. The dazzling multi-colored sparks filling the sky quickly spell out each of your names before fading away.

Each of you receives a wink and blown kiss from your favored supporter before the trumpets start back up with a triumphant tune. Entire bouquets fly through the air, though they also manage to just miss striking you. The Thought Caser steps from their booth, the railing breaking to mist as they walk through it, before dashing downwards to form a staircase.

Your keb rasska guide congratulates you all, somehow managing to shake only one of your limbs with all of theirs, the keb on their back expressing concentrated glory. And then you are looking at the back of your eyelids, the plush of the carpet beneath you molded to your sleeping form.

You open your eyes to see the incense quickly dispersing from the room, your host gathering up the ether twine from around you. They congratulate each of you again before handing you a bag burgeoning with your well-earned lyst. "Excellent fighting," your host praises. "I hope you don't find reality too 'mundane' after the splendor of the dream."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 30*R . All  items that were consumed during this encounter are returned to their owners.

Campaign Link



Return to Chapter 3 - "A Consequence",  66, skipping directly to campaign link.

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We Were So Close

182

Your enemies fade to mist as the distraught crowd loudly complains of your loss. There are scattered applause for your efforts, but the overarching response seems to be one of genuine disappointment, and commiseration. At least this battle hasn't left you with any aches, pains, or actual injuries.

The crowd and mezzanine disperse back to pale mist, though the noise of the crowd still fills the space. Standing between two of the arena's pillars you see your keb rasska hosts who roll their two heads in the ilk's version of a shrug. They approach you, their dream form towering over you, and bend down to thank each of you for your efforts and congratulate you on lasting as long as you did.

And then you are looking at the back of your eyelids, the plush of the carpet beneath you molded to your sleeping form.

You open your eyes to see the incense quickly dispersing from the room, your host gathering up the ether twine from around you. They thank each of you again before beginning to return your belongings. "Our burrow will always welcome you, Rovers, and your next attempt when you seek it."

Defeat!



Reward

All  items that were consumed during this encounter are returned to their owners.

Campaign Link



Return to Chapter 3 - "A Consequence",  66, skipping directly to campaign link.

Kaleido Caldera

183

After several days of arduous tracking, you've finally followed the Kaleido to her temporary burrow. When you come upon her only the top portion of her shell is visible above the waters of the small underground lake. Thankfully you have the opportunity to scope out the room before the fighting begins; she is slowly absorbing the water to refill her stores in her shell, a time-consuming process for an urn so absurdly overgrown as the Kaleido.

The walls of the cave are covered in natural-forming crystals. Likely your quarry is saving them for a midnight snack, but thankfully in the meantime they provide ample light for the cramped quarters.

At least, that's all you see until setting a single foot inside. Immediately the beast senses your intrusion and lifts her bulk from the water to confront you. Water streams down from the massive crystals adorning her shell, each larger than a grown person. Even worse, as the water clears you can see that her shell is actually many layers thick, grown over time and again like a pearl forming its iridescent layers. You'll have to carefully chip away at the covering before you stand any chance of damaging the beast.

The Tihfur are known for saying, "Harms come in threes," which is proved true once again as massive, slimy tentacles emerge from small holes in the floor of the cavern. The Kaleido has truly infested the entire cave. This is the urn's territory now, and you'll have to take it from her inch by inch.

Fractured

184

The **CRACK** that resounds through the cave as you finally manage to fracture the Kaleido's encrusted shell more closely resembles the beginning of a cave-in than the simple breaking of a mollusk's shell. While she doesn't have the means to scream, she makes her displeasure more than known as her thrashing shakes the entire cavern.

For a moment she seems to be shedding her outermost layer but as the floors finally settle back to stationary you can see it's actually a small swarm of urnlettes crawling over their mother before jumping to the floor to join the fray. Silky remarks, "Who knew that urns carry their young within them! Never the matter, you've got her on the back foot now, Rovers! See it through!"

Special Rules



Fractured Shell

The Kaleido's ethereal shell has been damaged but not destroyed.

Spawn R urnlettes adjacent to the Kaleido.

If this is the first time the Kaleido's shell has been fractured, place a on their statistic block.

If this is the second time the Kaleido's shell has been fractured, place an on their statistic block.

If this is the third time the Kaleido's shell has been fractured, place a on their statistic block.

If this is the fourth time the Kaleido's shell has been fractured, place a on their statistic block.

Remove all damage from the Kaleido's shell. Treat this shell as having 3*R and 3-X, where X equals the number of ether fields on the Kaleido's statistic block.

Shattered

185

The tension holding the loose, grating sections of the Kaleido shell together finally gives way, sending a head-sized bit of crystal flying away to collide with the ceiling. The beast shivers for a moment before more and more of her crystal-studded shell falls away revealing tender flesh, bruised from its tight confinement within the shell. Kaleido's tentacles crazily whip throughout the cave, now desperate to keep you away from her vulnerable, exposed form.

Special Rules



Shattered

The Kaleido's ethereal shell has been completely shattered.

The Ethereal Shell rule is no longer active. When you target the Kaleido with attacks, you now attack the monstrosity directly damaging its as normal.

Codex Links



186

Immediately when the Kaleido is slain, read "**Land Squid**", 89.

Land Squid

186

"I'm sorry, chief, I failed." Silky stands before the Tihfur Dominant, head hung in shame, ears and tail unusually still and drained of all mirth. This Silky, whiskers still taught with youth, is experiencing his first ever failure to affect an entire clan, though, sadly, not his last.

The Tihfur Dominant bows to Silky, surprising the young Zusag. "Thank you, Querist Silky. You have saved our clan from utter annihilation." Silky shakes his head in confusion. "But I was wrong! People died!" The Dominant raises his hands, brushing off the Zusag's words.

"Yes, you were wrong as to exactly where the monstrosity would appear, and a few, tragically, lost their lives. But if you had not come to warn us, our entire clan would have been camped right where the sinkhole opened up! Please, just promise me that you won't let this beast continue to go unchallenged!"

"At last, I kept my promise, chief," Silky remarks, wing going to wipe his tears before remembering to disconnect from the construct to do so. "Thank you, Rovers. Not only have you rid the lands of a constant worry and threat, but you have brought me no small peace."

Mo holds aloft a section of the Kaleido's shattered shell saying, "Not to mention the large pieces!" Makaal chuckles but also slaps the starling on the shoulder.

Victory!



Reward

Add the Secret Stash item deck to the shop.

Campaign Link



Return to Chapter 4 - "A Consequence", 100, skipping directly to campaign link.

Hey There Big Guy

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As soon as it is safe to do so, Mo jogs over to the Earth starling, "Might we have your name, friend?" In response they hold out a branch, or, rather, an arm. A thin vine, the bright green of fresh growth, snakes out from the end of the arm tangling itself into a mess in the air. Mo starts to ask again as the vine twitches, the tangled mess soon resolving itself into perfectly legible script spelling "Hra."

Mo grins up at your new acquaintance, "Pleasure to meet you, Hra! I'm sorry you were attacked by those Star Hunters; we're actually just on our way to confront them more directly. What brings you out to these parts, friend?"

Hra spells out his answer one word at a time, "Looking for a nice place to take root, preferably by a stream. I must continue now, but thank you for saving me." With that the starling lifts a leg and holds it out to Mo who, confused, extends their hands. Some of the roots of Hra's leg retract, loosing a stone into Mo's hand as well as a short stream of lyst.

By the time Mo processes the events to look back up Hra is already halfway to the next hill, waving an enormous hand in parting. "I feel partly that we should go after him to make sure the rest of the road is safe," Mo starts, walking over to hand the pile of lyst to you all, "but to be honest, his ether was giving me quite the migraine. I'm sure he'll be fine."

Victory!



Reward

Rovers gain 15*R . The mysterious Hra has blessed you. Each Rover begins the next encounter with one additional dice in their personal pool.

Mark the milestone "**Intervened in an ambush**" on your campaign sheet.

Campaign Link



Return to Chapter 5 - "Era Shattered", 130, skipping directly to campaign link.

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